ΒΗΣΣΑΡΙΩΝΟΣ

ΕΓΚΩΜΙΟΝ ΕΙΣ ΤΡΑΠΕΖΟΥΝΤΑ

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BESSARION

Encomium on Trebizond

Original Polytonic Greek Text & Parallel English Translation

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Βησσαρίωνος Εἰς Τραπεζοῦντα · Bessarion's Encomium on Trebizond

Parallel Greek Text and English Translation

§ 1. [σ. 4] Ἀπάρχεσθαι μὲν τῶν αὑτοῖς τιμιωτάτων ἑκάστους καὶ πατράσι καὶ ἄρχουσι καὶ τοῖς ὁτουοῦν ἄλλως ἀγαθοῦ σφίσιν ὑπάρξασι νενόμισταί γε καὶ πάνυ δικαίως· δεῖ γάρ, ἄνθρωπον ὄντα, τὸ μόνον τῶν ζῴων ἐλεύθερον καὶ φιλότιμον καὶ φιλόδωρον, μὴ μόνον εὖ πάσχειν, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἀντευποιεῖν ἐν τῷ μέρει, καὶ πρός γε τοῦ πλέον τι δυναμένου νικώμενον τῷ φθάσαι παρασχεῖν ἂν ἐκεῖνον, τοῖς ἀμοιβαίοις γοῦν καὶ δευτέροις αὐτὸν μὴ ὑστερῆσαι, μηδὲ χείρω καὶ κατὰ τοῦτο φανῆναι, οὐδὲ τὰς δυνατάς οἱ χάριτας ἐκτιννύντα καὶ οἷς ἂν ἐνδείξαιτο πρὸς ἀξίαν εὐηργετημένος καὶ πεπονθὼς τἀγαθά. Τοσούτῳ δὲ δικαιότερον πατρίδα τιμᾶν καὶ τὴν ἐνεγκαμένην ἀσπάζεσθαι καὶ ταύτην οἷς ἄν τις ἔχοι δωρεῖσθαι, ὅσῳ γῆ μὲν καὶ πατέρων πατήρ, ταύτης δὲ μὴ φερούσης τὰ παρ' αὐτῆς, οὔτ' ἂν ἄρχοντες ἦ ὦν ἂν ἄρξαιεν εἶχον, οὐκ ὄντων οἷς ἂν τρέφοιτο τὸ ἀρχόμενον καὶ ὅλως συνίσταιτο ἢ οἷς εὖ ἐποίουν τοὺς ὑπὸ χεῖρα, μὴ οὔσης ἑτέρωθεν εὐπορίας, οὔτ' ἂν ὅπως ἦ ὅτων ἐγίγνοντ' ἂν οἱ τεκόντες πατέρες, μᾶλλον δ' οὐδ' ἂν αὐτοὶ πρῶτον οἱ μὲν οὔθ' ὅλως ἦσαν μὴ ὅτι γ' ἑτέρων πατέρες, οἱ δ' οὐδὲ ἄρχοντες. Ἐοίκασι γοῦν οἱ μὲν διδόναι λαμβάνοντες, ἡ δὲ μόνον διδόναι καὶ μόνη προῖκα τὰ παρὰ τῶν οἰκείων χαρίτων εἰσφέρειν τῷ γένει, οὔτ' οὐδενὸς αὐτῇ προϋπάρξαντι, οὔτ' ἂν μετὰ ταῦτα δεομένη διδομένου, ὥστ' οὐχ ὧν εὖ ὑπ' αὐτῆς πάσχομεν μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ ὧν πατέρες φιλοτιμοῦνται καὶ χαρίζονται βασιλεῖς καὶ φίλοι φίλοις δωροῦνται τὴν αἰτίαν φέροιτ' ἂν μόνη δικαίως καὶ τὰς παρὰ πάντων εὐφημίας καὶ χάριτας δέχοιτο. Οὕτω μετὰ παντὸς τοῦ δικαίου καὶ γιγνομένου καὶ πολλῆς τῆς ἀνάγκης ἀπάρχοιτ' ἄν τις τῶν ἑαυτοῦ τῇ πατρίδι καὶ οἷς ἂν ἐνείη ταύτην ἀμείβοιτο, ὅθεν τὸ εἶναι τὸ ζῆν ἔσχομεν αὐτὸ τὸ ἔχειν οἷς ἂν τὸν εὐγνώμονα δείξαιμεν.

§ 1. [p. 4] To offer the first-fruits of what one holds most precious to fathers, to rulers, and to those who in any other way have been the authors of some good to us is an established custom, and most justly so. For it behooves a human being—the only creature that is free, honorable, and generous—not merely to receive benefits, but also to return kindness in his turn; and though surpassed by one of greater power inasmuch as that benefactor was first to bestow his favor, he must at least not fall short in making a reciprocal and secondary return, nor prove inferior in this respect as well by failing to render even such gratitude as lies within his power, whereby he might show that he has been worthily benefited and treated well. Yet it is all the more just to honor one's fatherland, to cherish the land that bore us, and to present her with whatever gifts one may possess, inasmuch as our native earth is the father even of our fathers. Were she not to yield her bounty, rulers would have neither subjects to rule—since nothing would exist whereby the governed might be nourished and sustained at all—nor means wherewith to benefit those under their authority, there being no abundance from any other source; nor would our own sires have had either the means or children of whom to become fathers—nay rather, in the first place, neither would the former have existed at all, let alone become fathers of others, nor would the latter even be rulers. Thus, whereas those others clearly give only after having first received, she alone merely gives, and she alone freely contributes the gifts of her own graces to our race, neither in return for anything previously bestowed upon her, nor with anything given to her thereafter as though she stood in need. Consequently, not only for the benefits we receive directly at her hands, but also for the lavish generosity of fathers, the favors of kings, and the gifts that friends bestow on friends, she alone would justly bear the credit and receive praises and thanksgiving from all. With every claim of justice and due propriety, therefore, and under powerful necessity, should a man offer the first-fruits of what is his to his fatherland and requite her by whatever means he can—her from whom we have

derived our being, our living, and our very possession of the wherewithal to show ourselves grateful.

§ 2. [σ. 4–5] Ἄλλοι μὲν οὖν ἄλλο τι τῶν ἢ μικρὸν ἢ μεῖζον δυναμένων τῇ πατρίδι συνεισφερέτωσαν, οἱ μὲν χορηγοῦντες, ἄλλοι τριηραρχοῦντες, τοὺς πολίτας ἕτεροι λαμπρῶς ἑστιῶντες, οἱ δ' ἐπισκευάζοντες πεπονηκότα τὰ τείχη καὶ νεὼς ἀνιστάντες καὶ ἱερὰ καὶ κατασκευάζοντες θέατρα, τὰ μὲν πρὸς κόσμον, τὰ δὲ πρὸς ἀσφάλειαν, τὰ δ' εἰς αὔξησιν αὐτῇ καὶ ἐπίδοσιν, αὐτὴν αὑτῆς ἐκ παντὸς τρόπου βελτίω μηχανωμένων εἰσαεὶ γίνεσθαι, ὡς μὴ τὸ τὰ πέρυσι βελτίω εἶναι κρατεῖν ἐπ' αὐτῆς, τὸ δ' ἐς νέωτα πλουσιωτέραν ἑαυτῆς ἀεὶ καὶ φαιδροτέραν οὐκ ἐλπίζεσθαι μόνον, ἀλλ' ἤδη καὶ φαίνεσθαι γινομένην, ὥστ' ἐπ' αὐτοὺς τἀγαθὸν πάλιν ἀντιστραφῆναι, οὐδενὸς δεομένης ἐκείνης, εὐδαίμονας αὐτοὺς ὄντας καὶ καλουμένους. Οἱ μὲν δὴ ταῦτα, καὶ πάντως αὐτῶν ἕκαστος, οὔθ' ἧττον ἢ δύνανται οὔτ' ἀποδιδοῖεν ἂν ὅσον ὀφείλουσι· τὸ μὲν γὰρ ἀδύνατον, εἴπερ οὐκ ἐκεῖθεν εἰλήφασι τὸ δύνασθαι μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ σφίσιν αὐτοῖς ταῦτα πορίζονται, τὸ δὲ παντελῶς ἄγνωμον.

§ 2. [p. 4–5] Let others, then, contribute to their fatherland one or another of those services that avail in lesser or greater degree—some defraying public choruses, others equipping triremes, others magnificently feasting their fellow citizens, and others repairing dilapidated walls, erecting temples and sanctuaries, and constructing theaters—some for her adornment, some for her security, and others for her growth and advancement, as men contrive by every means that she may forever surpass herself: so that the proverb "last year's things were better" may never prevail in her case, but rather that with each coming year she may not merely be hoped, but already be seen to grow wealthier and more radiant than her former self, with the result that the good rebounds once more upon the givers themselves, since she stands in need of nothing while they both are and are called blessed. Let them, then, offer such gifts, and by all means let each of them render neither less than they are able, nor yet all that they owe; for the latter is impossible—seeing that they have not only received their very ability from her, but are also procuring these benefits for themselves—while the former would be utterly ungrateful.

Ἡμεῖς δὲ τῶν ἄλλων ἀποροῦντες ἁπάντων καὶ πρὸς οὐδὲν ἂν ἕτερον οὔτε ὄντες οὔτ' ἐσόμενοι χρήσιμοι τῇ πατρίδι καὶ τοῦ μὲν πρὸς αὐτὴν γιγνομένου κατὰ ταὐτὰ τοῖς ἄλλοις πολίταις ἡμῖν ὄντες ὑπόχρεω, τοῦ δέ γε ταὐτὰ δύνασθαι καὶ πάνυ λειπόμενοι, οἷς ἔχομεν μόνοις ἀποδώσομεν αὐτῇ τὰ τροφεῖα καὶ τὴν δυνατὴν ἐκτίνοντες τῇ τροφῷ χάριν, τῷ καλλίστῳ μὲν ἂν τῶν σφετέρων, οὐδενὸς δὲ λειπομένῳ τῶν ἄλλων ταύτην ἀγήλαιμεν, λόγοις κοσμοῦντες οἷς ἡμᾶς ἀντὶ πάντων ὁ λόγιος ἐδοκίμασε θεὸς ἀγαπᾶν, τὴν οὐ θρεψαμένην μόνον παραγαγοῦσαν, ἀλλὰ καὶ τούτων ἡμῖν γενομένην αἰτίαν τὰ μὲν οἷς οἴκοθεν αὐτῇ προσπαρέσχετο δαψιλῶς, τὰ δ' οἷς τὰ παρ' ἑτέρων οἵους τ' ἀπέφηνε δέξασθαι. Εἰ δ' οὐ τὸ πρὸς αὐτὴν ταύτῃ χρέος ἀφοσιωσόμεθα μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ τῶν ἄλλως ἂν γενομένων ἐπιτυχῶν τῶν δικαίων τῶν πρὸς αὐτὴν οὐδὲν ἧττον, χάρις μὲν τῷ θεῷ μὴ παντάπασιν ἀσυντελεῖς ἡμᾶς ἀνασχομένῳ φανῆναι, χάρις δὲ καὶ τοῖς λόγοις αὐτοῖς, δυναμένοις τοσοῦτον καὶ οὕτω

We, however, who lack all those other resources, and neither are nor ever shall be useful to our fatherland in any other way—though we owe her what is due on precisely the same terms as our fellow citizens, while falling very far short of possessing the same means—shall repay her the debt of our nurture with the sole gift we possess. Discharging to our nurse such gratitude as lies in our power, let us honor her with what is fairest among our own possessions and inferior to none belonging to others, adorning with eloquence—which the God of Eloquence [cf. Hermes Logios] judged fit that we should cherish above all else—her who not only brought us forth and nourished us, but also became for us the cause of these very studies, partly through what she generously supplied in addition from her own home, and partly by rendering us capable of receiving what came from others. And if in this way we shall not merely acquit ourselves of our debt to her, but do so no less successfully than those who fulfill their just obligations toward her by other means, thanks be to God, who has

λαχοῦσι τάξεως ἐν τοῖς οὖσιν, ὡς οὐδενὸς μὲν ἡττᾶσθαι, ἀλλὰ πλεονεκτεῖν μὲν τῶν πλείστων, τοῖς δ' ἐς ἴσον ἀκριβῶς ἔρχεσθαι. Καίτοι λόγον ἀσκοῦσι καὶ τοῦτον τοῦ καθ' αὑτοὺς βίου προστησαμένοις παντός, οὐδ' ἄλλως ἐνῆν ἂν οὐδὲ πολλὰ βουλομένοις ποιεῖν, εἴπερ ἡμᾶς μὲν ἀνάγκη μᾶλλον τῶν ἄλλων τοῖς φαινομένοις εὐλόγοις ἐκ παντὸς ἕπεσθαι τρόπου, τὴν δ' ἐνεγκαμένην ἀγάλλειν τοῖς δυνατοῖς, ὡς οὐχ ἕτερον εὔλογον ὂν ὁ λόγος ἀπέδειξεν. Εἰ γὰρ αὐτοὶ λόγον ἄγοντες περὶ πλείστου τοῖς ἐκ τούτων προφαινομένοις τὴν ἐναντίαν βαδίσαιμεν, σχολῇ γ' ἂν ἑτέροις πιθανὰ συμβουλεύσαιμεν, κατὰ λόγον καὶ τὸ εἰκὸς τὰ σφῶν αὐτῶν πείθοντες ἄγειν. Οὕτω καὶ μετὰ μείζονος ἀνάγκης ἐπὶ τὸν λόγον ἡμεῖς ἴοιμεν, καὶ πρὸς τοῦτον ἀποδυσαίμεθ' ἂν τὸν ἀγῶνα ἢ οἱ τῶν ὄντων ἄλλως ἀπαρχόμενοι τῇ σφετέρᾳ.

not suffered us to appear altogether unprofitable, and thanks be also to eloquence itself, which possesses such power and has been allotted such a rank among existing things as to yield to nothing, surpassing most things and matching the rest on strictly equal terms. Indeed, for men who cultivate reason and discourse and have set it at the head of their entire way of life, it would not be possible to act otherwise even were they ever so willing, seeing that we above all others are bound in every way to follow what appears reasonable, and reason itself has demonstrated that nothing is so reasonable as to honor the land that bore us to the best of our ability. For if we ourselves, who prize reason above all else, were to walk contrary to the conclusions clearly set forth by these principles, hardly could we offer persuasive counsel to others when urging them to conduct their own affairs in accordance with reason and propriety. Thus under an even greater necessity than those who offer first-fruits to their homeland from their material wealth should we embark upon this speech and strip for this contest.

§ 3. [σ. 6–7] Παραιτεῖσθαι δὴ νόμιμον ὂν τοῖς ἐκ τοῦ προφανοῦς μάλιστα σχῆμα τοῦ λόγου προστησαμένοις σεμνὸν καὶ σφᾶς μὲν αὐτοὺς ταπεινοῦντας, ἐξαίροντας δὲ τὰ πράγματα, τοὺς ἀκροατὰς οὕτω καταπραΰνειν, ὡς ἂν ἀμφοτέρως εὐδοκιμήσειαν, ἐφικόμενοί τε τῆς ἀξίας καὶ κατόπιν ἐλθόντες, τὸ μὲν τῆς σφῶν αὐτῷ λέγειν δεινότητος, τὸ δ' ἀποφερομένης τῶν ἐπαινουμένων τῆς φύσεως, αὐτὸς οὔτε κατὰ ταὐτὰ τοῖς ἄλλοις τόνδε διαθήσω τὸν λόγον, καὶ τοσούτῳ δέω χρήσεσθαι τοῖς τοιούτοις, ὥστ' ὅτι μὲν ὁ λόγος ἐργώδης τε καὶ λαμπρὸς καὶ δυσχερὴς ἀνῦσαι, μηδὲν διδαχθῆναι δεόμενος, μήτ' ἴσως διδάξαι· κρατεῖ γὰρ ἐν ταῖς ἁπάντων ψυχαῖς· ὅτι δὲ καὶ αὐτὸς φαύλως πρὸς τοὺς τοιούσδε τῶν λόγων καὶ οὐχ ἱκανῶς παρεσκεύασται παντὸς μᾶλλον εἰδώς, ὅμως οὔτε ἀποκνῶ, καὶ θαρρούντως ἐπ' αὐτὸ τρέψομαι τὸ ἐγκώμιον, τὸ μὲν εὖ τε καὶ καλῶς περὶ τῶν τῇ πατρίδι προσόντων εἰπεῖν καὶ τῇ 'κείνης ἀξίᾳ τὸν λόγον ἀποδοῦναι συμβαίνοντα, εὐκτὸν μὲν εὐχόμενος εἶναι καὶ οἷον ἀντὶ πολλῶν ἂν ἀλλάξασθαι, οὐ ῥᾴδιον δέ, ἀγαπῶν δ' ἂν εἰ καὶ ὁπωσοῦν τὰ τοῦ χρέους ἀφοσιώσομαι καὶ μὴ πάνυ τοι πόρρω τοῦ σκοποῦ βάλλοιμι.

§ 3. [p. 6–7] Although it is customary for those especially who overtly adopt a solemn style of discourse to beg indulgence, and, by humbling themselves while magnifying their subject, thus to mollify their hearers so that they may win renown either way—whether they attain to the dignity of their theme or fall behind it, their own skill in speaking claiming credit for the former, and the surpassing nature of the things praised accounting for the latter—I myself shall neither arrange this oration in the same manner as others, nor have any recourse whatever to such artifices. Indeed, so far am I from employing them that, as to this discourse being arduous, splendid, and difficult to accomplish, I have no need to be taught, nor perhaps to teach anyone else, for that conviction already prevails in the souls of all; and though knowing better than anyone how poorly and inadequately I myself am equipped for speeches of this kind, nevertheless I do not shrink back, and I shall turn boldly to the encomium itself. To speak finely and nobly of the excellences that belong to my fatherland, and to render an oration commensurate with her worth, I account a blessing devoutly to be wished and one that a man would exchange for many treasures, yet far from easy; rather, I should be content if in any measure at all I

Οἶμαι δὲ καὶ τῶν νῦν τε παρόντων καὶ μετέπειτα συνεσομένων τοῖσδε τοῖς λόγοις ταύτη τοὺς πλείστους κρινεῖν καὶ τῶν τοιούτων κριτὰς ἀξιόχρεως. Τῶν γὰρ μείζοσιν ἢ καθ' αὑτοὺς ἐγχειρούντων, μή τινος μὲν συνωθούσης ἀνάγκης, οὐκ ἄν τις ἐλλελοιπότων τῆς ἀξίας ἀνάσχοιτο· ἐνὸν γὰρ ἔξω τῶν κινδύνων ἑστῶτας ἀπηλλάχθαι πραγμάτων, οἴδ' ὑπὸ τῆς ἄγαν φιλοτιμίας, ὡς ἔοικεν, ἀποδύονται τὸν ἀγῶνα καὶ τὸ στάδιον ὑπεισέρχονται καὶ σφᾶς αὐτοὺς ἐν τοῖς ἀθληταῖς ἀπογράφονται. Ὥστ' ἂν εἰκότως ἀντὶ θαύματος ἀποφέροιντο γέλωτα, μὴ διὰ πάντων διήκοντες καὶ πᾶσιν ἀρκούντως ἐπεξελθόντες. Εἰ δέ τις ἑκὼν ἄκων κατατολμᾷ τῶν μεγίστων, καὶ σφόδρα μὲν ἂν βουλόμενος ἐνεῖναί οἱ μὴ παρακινδυνεύειν, οὐκ ἔχων δ' ὅπως, τοῦτον οὐχ ὁρῶ πῶς ἄν τις εὐλόγως τὴν διὰ πάντων ἀπαιτοίη ἀκρίβειαν ἢ πῶς δικαίως ἂν μέμψαιτο, τῆς ὑποθέσεως ἡττηθέντα, τοῦτο δὴ τοὐμὸν καὶ ὃ πᾶσα παθεῖν ἀνάγκη τοὺς Τραπεζοῦντα καὶ τὴν αὐτῆς εὐφημίαν τῷ λόγῳ ποιουμένους ὑπόθεσιν, οὐ μόνον ὅτι πολλῶν ὄντων αὐτῇ τῶν ἐς εὔκλειαν καὶ πολλῶν ἂν ἀπομεριζομένων ἕκαστα δέοι γλωσσῶν, ἀλλ' ὅτι καὶ πρεσβυτάτης εἴπερ ἄλλη τις ὑπαρχούσης, ἐν ἀφανεῖ γε τὰ πλείω τῶν αὐτῆς κεῖσθαι συμβέβηκεν, οὐ τὴν ἀρχὴν μόνην εἰς τὸ πλέον ἀνήκειν τοῦ φανεροῦ καὶ προχείρου λαβεῖν, ὃ περὶ τῆς μητρὸς αὐτῆς πόλεως εἴρηται καὶ πρὸς ἣν εἰ καὶ διὰ μέσων ἑτέρων ἑαυτὴν ἀναφέρει. Ὥστ' οὐκ ὀλίγων ὄντων τῶν ἡμᾶς διαφευξουμένων καὶ οἷς ὁ λόγος ἐλλιπὴς ἔσται, τὸ μηδὲ τοῖς φαινομένοις αὖ ἐξαρκεῖν ἔχειν ἀφαιρεῖται τοῦ παντὸς ἐγκωμίου τῆς πόλεως, οὐ μὴν ὥστε καὶ τὴν οὖσαν αὐτῇ δόξαν συναφαιρεθεῖσαν οἴχεσθαι, ὅτι μὴ προσαυξηθῆναι μᾶλλον, ἔργῳ φανέντος τοῦ κατ' αὐτὴν ὑπερέχοντος.

acquit myself of my debt and do not shoot altogether wide of the mark.

And I believe that most of those both present now and hereafter conversant with these words—and competent judges of such matters—will judge in this way. For when men lay hands on undertakings beyond their powers without any compelling necessity pushing them forward, no one could bear with them if they fall short of what is worthy; for when they might have stood clear of danger and been free of trouble, out of excessive ambition, so it seems, they strip for the contest, enter the stadium, and enroll themselves among the athletes. Reasonably, therefore, would they carry off ridicule instead of admiration when they fail to traverse the whole course and treat every point adequately. Yet if a man ventures, willing yet unwilling, upon the greatest themes—earnestly wishing it were open to him not to run the risk, yet having no way to avoid it—I do not see how anyone could reasonably demand of him exhaustive exactness in every detail, or justly blame him when he is vanquished by his subject: which is my very case, and what all who make Trebizond and her praise the theme of their speech must inevitably experience. This is so not only because the titles she possesses to glory are many and would require many tongues apportioning her several praises among themselves, but also because, since she is as ancient as any city that exists, the greater part of her history has come to lie in obscurity, and not merely her origin reaches back beyond what is manifest and ready at hand to grasp—as has been said of her mother-city, to which, albeit through intermediate cities, she traces herself back. Consequently, while not a few of her glories will escape us and leave our speech incomplete, our inability to suffice even for those that are manifest detracts from the full encomium of the city—yet not so that the glory actually hers is taken away and vanishes along with it, but rather that it is augmented all the more, once her transcendent greatness has been revealed in very deed.

§ 4. [σ. 7–8] Ἡ γὰρ δὴ πόλις ἡμῖν γεγένηται μὲν οὐκ οὖσα, γενομένη δ' οὐκ ἀπεγένετο, τὸ μὲν πάσαις σχοῦσα κοινόν, τὸ δ' οὐ πάνυ πολλαῖς. Τῶν γὰρ ἐκ τοῦ παντὸς αἰῶνος συνοικισθεισῶν αἱ μέν, οὐδ' αὐτὸ τοῦτο συνοικισθεῖσαι καλῶς, εἰς ὃ ἦσαν ἀνέδραμον αὖθις, ὡς μηδὲ τὴν ἀρχὴν γεγονυῖαι, αἱ δέ, καὶ τύχης

§ 4. [p. 7–8] For our city came into being when once she was not, yet having come into being she has never passed away—sharing the former lot in common with all cities, the latter with very few indeed. For among all the cities founded throughout the whole of time, some, not even well founded at the outset, reverted straightway to

ἀγαθῆς ἀπολαύσασαι καὶ πρὸς μέγα δυνάμεως καὶ δόξης ἠρμέναι, αἱ μὲν ὁμαλῶς τε καὶ συνεχῶς, αἱ δ' αὖ κατ' ἀμοιβὴν καὶ ἀντιπερίστασιν, τοτὲ μὲν ἄρχουσαι, τοτὲ δὲ δουλεύουσαι, ὅμως ἅπασαι τελευτῶσαι αἱ μὲν οὐδὲ λείψανον ἑαυτῶν γνώρισμα τῆς πάλαι ποτὲ κατέλιπον τύχης, αἱ δ' ὅσον τὸ τῆς φύσεως ἀνώμαλον καὶ ἀνόμοιον ἀπελέγξαι τὸν χρόνον νικήσασαι τοῖς ἄλλοις ἡττῶνται, πολλὰς ἐν τῷ μέσῳ μεταβολὰς ἀμειψάμεναι καὶ μετὰ τῆς χείρονος ἱστάμεναι μοίρας, παρὰ τοσοῦτον τῆς παντελοῦς γενόμεναι κρείττους φθορᾶς παρ' ὅσον τοῦτ' ἦν αὐταῖς βέλτιον ἢ νῦν ὑπὸ τῆς τοῦ χρόνου περιπετείας εἰλήφασι τάξεώς τε καὶ καταστάσεως.

Ταυτηνὶ δὲ τὴν ἡμετέραν, ὥσπερ τινὶ θείᾳ μοίρᾳ συστᾶσαν ὡς ἀληθῶς καὶ θείων ἀνδρῶν ἔργον γεγενημένην, ἐνδιδόντος θεοῦ, οὐ χρόνου πλῆθος ἠμαύρωσεν, οὐκ ἤμβλυνεν ὁ τοσοῦτος αἰών, οὐχ αἱ κυβεῖαι τῆς τύχης, οὐ τὸ τῶν πραγμάτων ἀνώμαλον καὶ ὁπωσοῦν ἔσχον λυμήνασθαι, ἀλλ' ἅπαξ τὸ εἶναι λαχοῦσα καὶ ὑπὲρ τὰ μέτρα τῆς τῶν ὄντων φιλονεικεῖ φύσεως, ἀρξαμένη μὲν ἐξ ὅτου σχεδὸν ἐπέδωκαν Ἕλληνες, εἴξασα δὲ οὐδέπω τῷ χρόνῳ καὶ ταῖς ἐκεῖθεν μυρίαις μεταβολαῖς, ἀλλ' ἦν τε καὶ ἔστιν ἡμῖν ἡ αὐτὴ ὡς ἂν χθές τε καὶ πρότριτα συνῳκισμένη, κακῶν ἀπαθὴς καὶ τῶν τοῦ βίου κυμάτων ἀνώτερος, καὶ εἴη γε, σῶτερ θεὲ πολιοῦχε καὶ ἡγεμόνιε, μηδὲ πρότερον παύσαιτο πρὶν ἂν ὕδωρ τε νάον καὶ δένδρεα μακρὰ τεθηλότα, σοῦ συνέχοντος ἄνωθεν καὶ τῇ κραταιᾷ χειρὶ περιέποντος καὶ τοῦ οἰκείου μεταδιδόντος ὡς ἐνὸν ἀγαθοῦ, τῆς διαμονῆς τε καὶ διαρκείας. Τὸ δὲ μεῖζον καὶ ὃ μόνης αὐτῆς ἴδιον καὶ μάλιστα πρὸς ἐπαίνου καὶ θαύματος, ὅτι καὶ βελτίων ἑαυτῆς ἀεὶ καὶ τιμιωτέρα καθίσταται, ἐπιδιδοῦσα, τοῦ χρόνου προβαίνοντος, εἰσαεὶ καὶ κατὰ τοσοῦτον τοῦ εὖ εἶναι πλεονεκτοῦσα, καθόσον αὐτῇ πλεονάζεται καὶ τὸ ἁπλῶς εἶναι καὶ ὄν τι καὶ εἶναι καὶ λέγεσθαι, ὡς ὁ λόγος προϊὼν δηλώσει σαφέστερον καὶ τοῖς ἀγνοοῦσιν ἀνθρώπων, εἴπερ τινές εἰσι, παραστήσει.

what they were before, as though they had never come into existence at all; others, even after enjoying good fortune and rising to a great height of power and glory—some evenly and continuously, others by turns and reversals, now ruling and now enslaved—have nonetheless all ended either by leaving behind not so much as a remnant of themselves as a token of their ancient fortune, or else, having conquered time only enough to expose the unevenness and inconsistency of nature, are defeated in all other respects: having passed through many changes in the meantime and standing now on the side of the worse lot, prevailing over utter destruction only to the extent that this was better for them than the rank and condition they have now received through the reversals of time.

Yet this city of ours, truly established as though by some divine dispensation and wrought as the work of godlike men with God's own favor, neither length of time has dimmed, nor so vast an age blunted, nor have the dice-throws of fortune or the instability of human affairs been able in any way whatever to mar her. Once allotted her existence, she contends even beyond the measures of the nature of created things: having begun almost from the very time when the Greeks first rose to prominence, she has never yet yielded to time and the myriad changes it brings, but both was and remains for us the selfsame city, as though founded only yesterday or the day before, unscathed by ills and superior to the billows of life. And so may she ever remain, O Savior God, Guardian of our city and Leader, nor may she cease to be until flowing water and tall flourishing trees themselves shall cease, while Thou dost sustain her from on high, cherishing her with Thy mighty hand and imparting to her, so far as may be, Thine own proper good—permanence and enduring continuance! Greater still—and what belongs to her alone and is most worthy of praise and wonder—is that she grows ever better and more honorable than her former self, advancing continually as time goes on, and gaining in well-being in the very measure in which her sheer existence—her both being and being spoken of as an existing reality—is prolonged, as our discourse in its progress will show more clearly and set before any among mankind, if indeed any there be, who are ignorant of it.

§ 5. [σ. 8] Αὕτη πρώτην τοῦ γένους ἀρχὴν καὶ μητρόπολιν, εἰ δεῖ τὰ πρεσβύτερα πρότερα λέγειν, ἀττικὴν καὶ τὴν Ἀθηναίων αὐχεῖ πόλιν, τὴν τροφὸν τῶν Ἑλλήνων, τὴν μητέρα τῶν λόγων, τῆς καλλίστης ταύτης φωνῆς τὴν διδάσκαλον. Ἀπῴκισαν μὲν γὰρ αὐτὴν Σινωπεῖς, τοὺς δ' αὖ, οἰκισθέντες ὑπ' Ἀθηναίων, Μιλήσιοι, τὰ κράτιστα τῆς Ἀσίας, τὸ πρόσχημα τῶν Ἰώνων, οἱ τῆς παραλίου ταύτης Ἑλλάδος ἡγούμενοι, οὐκ ἄλκιμοι μόνον γεγενημένοι πάλαι ποτέ, τοῦτο δὴ τὸ λεγόμενον, ἀλλὰ καὶ μεθ' ὑπερβολῆς ὅσης ἂν εἴποις.

§ 5. [p. 8] As the first origin of her race and her mother-city—if one must speak first of what is oldest—she boasts Attica and the city of the Athenians: the nurse of the Greeks, the mother of letters, the teacher of this fairest of tongues. For the Sinopeans colonized her, and the Sinopeans in turn were colonized by the Milesians, themselves settled by the Athenians—the Milesians, the flower of Asia, the ornament of the Ionians, the leaders of that maritime Hellas, who not merely "were valiant once long ago," as the famous saying goes, but were so to the highest degree that words could express.

§ 6. [σ. 8] Ἀθηναίων μὲν οὖν πέρι διεξιέναι καὶ τῆς αὐτῶν ἀλκῆς καὶ δυνάμεως καὶ ὡς πάσης ἐπελάβοντο γῆς τὰ μὲν ἀποικίαις, τὰ δ' ἰδίαις τε καὶ κοιναῖς φιλανθρωπίαις, ἀντὶ φυλακτηρίου κοινῇ καθιστάμενοι πᾶσιν, ἐνίοις μὲν δεομένοις αὐτῶν, τῶν δὲ καὶ μόνης τῆς χρείας ἱκανῆς παρακλήσεως γινομένης, ὅσους τε πολέμους διενεγκόντες πρὸς Ἕλληνας καὶ βαρβάρους τοὺς μὲν πρὸς ὃν ἂν ἑκάστοτε τύχοι, ἔστι δ' οὓς καὶ πρὸς τοὺς ἀπὸ πάσης τῆς οἰκουμένης σχεδόν, ὅσον ἐν πᾶσι τῶν ἐναντίων ἐκράτησαν καὶ κρείττους ἐγένοντο καὶ ὅσα ἄν τις περὶ τούτων εἰπεῖν ἔχοι, ταῦτα μὲν οὖν ἐάσω· Ἑλλήνων τε γὰρ εἶναι οὐδένα ὅστις τὰ κατ' αὐτὴν ἀγνοεῖ οὐ μᾶλλόν γε ἢ τὰ τῆς γεννησαμένης αὐτὸν ἕκαστος καὶ ἄλλως οὐ τὸ τυχὸν ἔργον, οὐδὲ δέκα μόνον ἢ δὶς τοσούτων γλωσσῶν, οὐχ ὅτι γε πάντα τὰ 'κείνης, ἀλλ' οὐδ' ἕν τι τῶν προσόντων καὶ μίαν αὐτῆς πρᾶξιν ἀπολαβόντα κατ' ἀξίαν εἰπεῖν.

§ 6. [p. 8] Now to recount at length the story of the Athenians, their valor and power, and how they laid hold of every land partly through colonies and partly through acts of benevolence both private and public, establishing themselves as a common bulwark for all—sometimes when men petitioned them, while for others their mere need sufficed as an appeal—and how many wars they waged against Greeks and barbarians, some against whichever adversary happened to confront them on each occasion, and some against foes gathered from well-nigh the entire inhabited world, and how decisively in every one they vanquished and triumphed over their opponents, together with all that one might have to say on these matters: all this, then, I shall pass over. For I suppose there is no Greek who is ignorant of Athens's history, any more than each man is ignorant of that of the mother who bore him; and besides, it would be no ordinary task—nor one for merely ten tongues, or twice as many—not to say to recount all that belongs to her, but even to single out one of her virtues and a single deed of hers and speak of it according to its worth.

§ 7. [σ. 8–9] Μιλήτου δὲ καὶ τῆς Μιλησίων δυνάμεως ὀλίγα μνησθεὶς ὅσον τῇ τε μητρὶ τὰ εἰκότα χαρίσασθαι καὶ δεῖξαι μὴ τὸ πορρωτέρω μόνον καὶ πρεσβύτερον ἡμῖν γένος οὕτως ἐπαίνου παντὸς κρεῖττον ὑπάρχον, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὸ προσεχὲς καὶ ἐγγύτερον οὐδὲν ἀποδέον ἐκείνου καὶ οἷον ἂν ἐφάμιλλον γένοιτο καὶ τῆς προαγαγούσης ἐπάξιον καὶ μάλα συμβαῖνον, ἐπ' αὐτὴν εἶμι τὴν ὑμνουμένην καὶ ἣν ἐνεστησάμην ὑπόθεσιν.

Μίλητον τοίνυν, οἰκισάντων τῶν Ἀθηναίων, ἐς μέγα προβῆναι δυνάμεως Ἰωνίας τε πάσης

§ 7. [p. 8–9] After making brief mention of Miletus and the power of the Milesians—just enough both to pay fitting tribute to our mother-city and to show that not only is our remoter and more ancient lineage thus beyond all praise, but our immediate and nearer ancestry as well falls in no way short of it, being such as to rival it and prove altogether worthy of and consonant with the city that brought it forth—I shall proceed directly to the city we celebrate and the theme I have undertaken.

That Miletus, then, once settled by the Athenians, advanced to great power, exercised hegemony over all

ἡγεμονεῦσαι καὶ τῶν ταύτῃ κατῳκημένων Ἑλλήνων προστῆναι μαρτυροῦσι μὲν λογογράφοι καὶ συγγραφεῖς ἅπαντες, μαρτυρεῖ δὲ καὶ ἃ ἐν τῷ παντὶ διεπράξατο χρόνῳ ὑπέρ τε σφῶν αὐτῶν καὶ Ἑλλήνων τῶν Ἀσιανῶν, πρὸς ὁμόρους τε καὶ ἅμα πλήθει καὶ πλούτῳ ἰσχύοντας διαμαχομένη βαρβάρους καὶ ὅμως ἀντέχουσα. Οἱ γὰρ Ἀσίας καὶ τῶν ἐντὸς Ἅλυος ποταμοῦ πολλῶν ὄντες ἐθνῶν ἄρχοντες βάρβαροι, ἀπὸ Γύγου τοῦ τὸν δεσπότην ἀπεκτονότος Κανδαύλην ἀρξάμενοι καὶ τὴν Λυδῶν οὕτως ἡγεμονίαν περιζωσαμένου, ἀεὶ μέν τι προσεπικτώμενοι, ἀεὶ δ' ἔλαττον νομίζοντες ἔχειν καὶ τὸ μηδέν, εἴ τινες τὴν αὑτῶν μὲν οἰκοῖεν, ἐλεύθεροι δ' εἶεν ἀπὸ τοῦ ἴσου τε καὶ ὁμοίου σφίσι διαλεγόμενοι, ἐπεὶ πᾶν μὲν αὐτοῖς ἔθνος κατέστραπται, Φρύγες δὲ καὶ Μυσοὶ δουλείαν ὁμολογήσαντες ὑπετάγησαν, Βιθυνοί τε καὶ Παφλαγόνες καὶ Χάλυβες μετὰ τῶν ἡττημένων γεγένηνται, Πάμφυλοί τε καὶ Κᾶρες καὶ πᾶν γένος ὑπεῖξαν, ὥσπερ ἀστραπῆς προσιούσης ὑπεξιστάμενοι, ἀδούλωτον δ' αὐτοῖς ὑπῆρχεν οὐδὲν οὐδ' ἐλεύθερον. Ἕλληνες δὲ μόνοι καὶ μάλιστα Ἴωνες καὶ τούτων αὖθις τὰ κράτιστα, Μίλητος, ἀπρίξ τε τῆς ἐλευθερίας ἀντείχοντο καὶ οὐδὲν ὅπερ οὐκ ἄσμενοι ὑπὲρ ταύτης ἠροῦντο, δεινὸν μὲν ἐποιοῦντο εἰ μόνοι πάντων ἀνθρώπων ὑπεξαιροῖντο τῆς αὑτῶν δυναστείας, σφοδρὸς δ' αὐτοῖς ἔρως ἐνσκήπτει καὶ τούτους καταδουλώσασθαι.

Ionia, and stood as champion of the Greeks dwelling in that region is attested by all chroniclers and historians alike, and attested too by all that she accomplished throughout the whole course of time on behalf of her own citizens and the Asian Greeks, fighting stubbornly against neighboring barbarians formidable at once in numbers and in wealth, and yet holding out against them. For the barbarian rulers of Asia and of the many nations on this side of the Halys River—beginning with Gyges, who slew his master Candaules and thus girded himself with the sovereignty of the Lydians—were forever annexing fresh territory, yet forever counting what they held too little, nay nothing at all, so long as any people dwelt in their own land while remaining free and conversing with them on equal and level terms. And when every other nation had been subdued by them—when Phrygians and Mysians had acknowledged servitude and submitted, Bithynians, Paphlagonians, and Chalybes had been numbered among the vanquished, Pamphylians and Carians and every race had yielded, giving way as though before an oncoming thunderbolt, and nothing remained unenslaved or free before them—whereas the Greeks alone, and above all the Ionians, and among these again their noblest part, Miletus, clung tenaciously to freedom and shrank from nothing that they would not gladly endure on its behalf, the barbarians counted it intolerable that these alone of all mankind should be exempt from their dominion, and a fierce passion descended upon them to reduce these also to slavery.

§ 8. [σ. 9–10] Ὥσπερ δὴ χορευτῶν τοῦ κορυφαίου σφαλέντος οὐδὲν ὄφελος, καὶ στρατιᾶς ἐκ μέσου γενομένου τοῦ στρατηγοῦ ῥᾳδία ἡ χείρωσις, ἀθλητῶν τε τὸν μάλιστα εὐδόκιμον ἂν τοῦ σταδίου ἐξέλοις τὸ πᾶν συγκαθεῖλες, οὕτω καὶ βάρβαροι πεποιήκεσαν. Δόξαν γὰρ αὐτοῖς Ἰωνίαν χειρώσασθαι, ἐπὶ τὴν ἡγεμονικὴν καὶ στρατηγίδα πόλιν εὐθὺς ἔβλεψαν, καὶ πᾶν ἦν αὐτοῖς Μίλητος, καί, ὅ φησιν ὁ συγγραφεύς, τἄλλα πολίσματα περὶ ἐλάττονος ποιησάμενοι, ἐπ' αὐτὴν ἤλαυνον πανστρατί, καὶ ταύτην ἑλεῖν ἐποιοῦντο μέγα ἀγώνισμα, οὐχ ὅτι μόνον καὶ καθ' αὑτὴν ἐσομένην οὐ τὴν τυχοῦσαν προσθήκην, οἷα δ' ἂν γένοιτο καὶ τοῦ παντὸς ἀνταξία, ἀλλ' ὅτι καὶ τὸ τῶν ἄλλων Ἑλλήνων κοινῇ φρόνημά τε καὶ ἀξίωμα Μιλήτῳ καὶ τῇ Μιλησίων ἂν συγκαθηρεῖτο δυνάμει,

§ 8. [p. 9–10] Just as there is no avail in chorus-dancers once their leader has fallen, and an army is easily subdued once its general has been removed, and if among athletes you take the most renowned champion out of the stadium you bring down the whole contest with him, so too did the barbarians act. Having resolved to subdue Ionia, they looked straightway toward her ruling and commanding city: Miletus was everything to them, and, as the historian says, counting the other towns of lesser moment, they marched against her in full force and made her capture their supreme object—not only because in and of herself she would prove no ordinary accession, nay one worth everything else combined, but also because the collective spirit and prestige of all the other Greeks would have been brought

καὶ λοιπὸν ἦν ἂν οὐδὲν ἔργον οὐδὲ λόγος τῆς ἄλλης Ἑλλάδος, ἀλλ' ἤρκει μόνον αὐτὴν ὁμολογῆσαι τὴν δεσποτείαν καὶ τὰς ἄλλας εὐθὺς ἀναιμωτὶ προσχωρῆσαι. Γύγης τε οὖν καὶ Ἄρδυς ὁ Γύγου οὐ μικρὸν μέν, ὅμως δ' ἀνήνυτον ἔργον πεποιημένοι τὸ ταύτης κρατῆσαι, τέλος ἀπειρηκότες καὶ γνόντες ἀέρα δαίροντες καὶ τὸ ἐκ τῆς ψάμμου σχοινίον πλέκοντες, ἐσπείσαντο, καὶ Κολοφῶνα μὲν εἷλον καὶ Σμύρνην ἐκάκωσαν καὶ Πριήνην ὑπέταξαν καὶ Κλαζομενὰς παρεστήσαντο, ὑπὸ δὲ Μιλησίων παθόντες τι μᾶλλον ἢ δεδρακότες ἀπήλλαξαν, νῷ διοικουμένοις ἐντυχόντες ἀνθρώποις καὶ ἡγεμονικοῖς τὰ πολέμια. Οἵ τε τούτοις διαδεξάμενοι Σαδυάττης ὁ Ἄρδυος καὶ Ἀλυάττης ὁ Σαδυάττου, καταγνόντες αὐτῶν ὡς οὐχ ἱκανῶς παρεσκευασμένων, ἐφ' ἕνδεκα μὲν αὐτοὶ τῇ πολιορκίᾳ προσεῖχον ἐνιαυτούς, τὰ μὲν ἓξ Σαδυάττης, Ἀλυάττης δὲ τὰ ἑπόμενα πέντε. Πολλάκις δὲ ἐσβαλόντες καὶ πλειστάκις συρράξαντες πόλεμον καὶ συστάδην ἀγωνισάμενοι, οὐδὲν ὅμως ἔσχον οὐδ' αὐτοὶ πλέον μετὰ τοσαύτης παρασκευῆς καὶ δυνάμεως ἐπιόντες καὶ Μιλησίοις ἀντικαθιστάμενοι, μόνοις τὸν τοσοῦτον διενεγκοῦσιν ἀγῶνα συμμαχίας ἐπήλυδος ἄνευ ἁπάσης. Οὐδεὶς γὰρ Ἰώνων αὐτοῖς τόνδε συνεπελάφρυνε τὸν ἀγῶνα, τὸ μὲν οὐ προσδεομένοις, τὸ δὲ καὶ τοῦ καιροῦ κατεπείγοντος πρὸς ἑαυτοὺς ἕκαστον βλέπειν καὶ τὴν ἰδίαν ἀσφάλειαν, ἀγαπητὸν ἂν οἰομένους ἑαυτὸν ἕκαστον σώζειν καὶ τὰ οἰκεῖα φυλάττειν.

Οὕτως οἱ μέν, αὐτὴν ἄγοντες ἀντὶ πάντων ἐδήλουν οἷς ὡς πρὸς σκοπόν τε καὶ τέλος ἐφέροντο ταύτην πᾶν μηχανώμενοι. Ἡ δ' ἕως ἐνῆν ἀγωνισαμένη πλεῖστα καὶ μέγιστα, μέγα μαρτύριον ἐξενήνοχεν ἀνδρείας, μεγαλοπρεπείας, φρονήσεως· ἀνδρείας μέν, εἰ, τοσούτοις ἀντιπαλαμωμένη κἀπὶ τοσοῦτον χρόνον, περιεγένετο· μεγαλοπρεπείας δὲ οἷς οὐδὲν τοῦ φρονήματος καθυφῆκεν, οὐδ' ἀνάξιόν τι καὶ ταπεινὸν ἢ ἐνενόησεν ἢ ἐφθέγξατο, δουλείαν ἀκίνδυνον τῆς μετὰ κινδύνων ἐλευθερίας ἀλλαξαμένη. Ἀλλὰ μὴν πῶς ἄν τις μᾶλλον μετὸν αὐτῇ δείξειε καὶ φρονήσεως καὶ σοφίας ἢ εἰ πᾶσι μὲν αὐτὴ συμμαχοῦσα, μηδ' ἑνὸς δ' ἑτέρου προσδεηθεῖσα, αὐτὴ ἑαυτῇ ἤρκεσεν εὐβουλίᾳ τὴν πολυχειρίαν νικήσασα ἔργῳ τε δείξασα μάταιον οὖσαν τὴν δύναμιν, ἀπούσης φρονήσεως.

down along with Miletus and the Milesians' power. Thereafter the rest of Hellas would have been no trouble or account at all; it would have sufficed merely for her to acknowledge their mastery, and the other cities would at once have come over without bloodshed. Accordingly, both Gyges and Ardys son of Gyges made the conquest of Miletus their great yet unavailing labor, until at last, exhausted and realizing that they were beating the air and twisting a rope of sand, they made peace; and while they captured Colophon, ravaged Smyrna, subjugated Priene, and reduced Clazomenae, from the Milesians they came away having suffered harm rather than inflicted it, having met with men governed by intelligence and masterly in the art of war. Their successors, too, Sadyattes son of Ardys and Alyattes son of Sadyattes, faulting their predecessors as inadequately prepared, devoted themselves for eleven years to the siege—Sadyattes for six of those years, and Alyattes for the following five. Yet though they invaded many times, clashed repeatedly in battle, and fought hand to hand, neither did they gain any advantage when advancing with such vast preparation and might to confront the Milesians, who bore so great a struggle all alone without any foreign alliance whatever. For none of the Ionians helped to lighten this struggle for them—partly because the Milesians stood in no need of aid, and partly because the crisis pressed each state to look to itself and its own safety, every man counting himself fortunate if he could save himself and guard what was his own.

Thus the barbarians clearly showed that they valued her equivalent to all the rest, inasmuch as they directed every stratagem toward her as their single mark and goal. She, for her part, having contended as long as was possible in the most numerous and greatest struggles, has set forth a mighty testimony of courage, magnanimity, and prudence: of courage, in that while grappling with so many foes and for so long a time, she prevailed; and of magnanimity, in that she abated nothing of her proud spirit, nor ever conceived or uttered anything unworthy or base by trading freedom fraught with peril for a peril-free servitude. And how indeed could anyone better demonstrate that prudence and wisdom belonged to her than by the fact that, while she herself fought as an ally to all yet stood in need of not a single other, she sufficed unto herself, overcoming

multitude of hands by sound counsel and proving in very deed that force is vain when prudence is absent?

§ 9. [σ. 10–11] Ἆρ' οὖν ἐν μὲν τοῖς ἄνω καὶ τότε καιροῖς οὕτω διηγωνίσατο καὶ παρὰ πάντων εἶχε τὸ συγκεχωρηκός, ἐχθρῶν τε καὶ φίλων ἐνσπόνδων καὶ πολεμίων, τῶν μὲν οἷς τῶν ἄλλων ὑπεριδόντες ταύτην ἀρχήν τε καὶ τέλος τῶν ἑλληνικῶν ἡγοῦντο πραγμάτων, τῶν δ' οἷς αὐτὴν σφῶν αὐτῶν προεστήσατο τὴν οἰκείαν αὐτῇ πιστεύσαντες σωτηρίαν. Ἐπεὶ δὲ τῶν πραγμάτων αὐξομένων βαρβάροις ἔδει ποτὲ καὶ Μιλησίους ἀνθρώπους ὄντας φανῆναι καὶ τῷ κύκλῳ περιενεχθέντας τοῦ βίου μὴ τὴν κρείττονα μοῖραν ἔχειν ἀεί, ἔστιν οὕς τινας μᾶλλον ἐτίμων οἱ καταδουλωσάμενοι βάρβαροι καὶ βασιλεὺς ὁ μέγας αὐτός, οὗ τὰ τέρματα τῆς ἀρχῆς ἀνατέλλων ὁρίζει καὶ δύνων ὁ ἥλιος, ἢ ἐτίμα μὲν διαφερόντως, τὰ δὲ πολεμικὰ κρείττους ἑτέρων ἐνόμιζεν, ἢ τοῦτο μὲν οὐδὲ μαθεῖν ἔχρηζεν, ἑαυτὸν δ' ἑτέροις μᾶλλον καὶ τὴν οἰκείαν σωτηρίαν ἐν τῷ παρισταμένῳ τῆς χρείας ἐπίστευεν; Οὐδαμῶς· ἀλλ' ὡς ἐλευθέρων ἐλευθέροις, εἰ οἷόν τ' εἰπεῖν, προσφερόμενος, ἠδεῖτο μὲν τὸ ἀρχαῖον αὐτῶν πρόσχημα καὶ ἣν περιεζώννυντό ποτε τῶν Ἰώνων ἡγεμονίαν, τῆς δὲ καρτερίας αὐτῶν καὶ τῆς ἐν πολέμῳ δεινότητος ἔργῳ πεπειραμένος, οὔτ' ἐξεστράτευε, Μιλησίων ἀπόντων, παρόντες τε τοῦ βασιλέως σωτῆρες καὶ τῶν βασιλέως πραγμάτων, ἕως οὐκ ἦν ἄλλως ποιεῖν, διετέλουν γιγνόμενοι καὶ καλούμενοι. Ἐπεί τε τὴν ἐλευθερίαν ὠδίνοντες καταδουλουμένους τοὺς Ἕλληνας ὁρᾶν οὐκ ἠνείχοντο, πρῶτοί τε τῆς ἀποστάσεως ἦρξαν, τοῦ καιροῦ παρασχόντος, καί, τοὺς ἄλλους ἐπισπασάμενοι, αὐτοὶ παντὸς ἄρχοντες ἀγαθοῦ καὶ τῳόντι τὸν ἡγεμόνα δεικνύντες μέχρι τε Σάρδεων ἀνῆλθον αὐτῶν καὶ τὰ Περσῶν ἐκάκωσαν πράγματα καὶ τὴν δυνατὴν ὑπὲρ Ἑλλήνων παρὰ βαρβάρων Ἕλληνες ἔλαβον δίκην, ἡγουμένων τε καὶ ἐνδιδόντων τῶν Μιλησίων, σφόδρα καὶ τοῦτο ποιούντων ἑλληνικὸν καὶ σοφόν, τῶν μὲν πραγμάτων ἀντικρουόντων ὑπείκειν, ἁρπάζειν δὲ τὸν καιρὸν παραστάντα, ὡς μήτε τοῖς ἀδυνάτοις ἐπιχειρεῖν, ἀναισθησίας ἐπιφερομένους ἔγκλημα, μήτε τοῦ καιροῦ παρασχόντος καθεύδειν.

§ 9. [p. 10–11] Did she, then, contend thus only in those ancient and bygone times, winning undisputed preeminence from all—foes and friends, allies and enemies alike: the former inasmuch as they overlooked all others and accounted her the beginning and end of Greek affairs, and the latter inasmuch as they set her at their head, entrusting their own safety to her—whereas later, when barbarian power grew and the Milesians too had at last to show themselves mortal men and, swept round by the wheel of human life, could not forever hold the upper hand, were there any whom the conquering barbarians and the Great King himself, the bounds of whose empire the rising and setting sun defines, honored more? Or did he honor the Milesians preeminently, yet in warfare deem others superior; or did he not even need to learn their martial worth, yet when need arose entrust himself and his own safety rather to others? By no means! On the contrary, comporting himself toward them, if one may so speak, as toward free men among the free, he revered their ancient dignity and the hegemony over the Ionians wherewith they had once been invested; and having experienced in very deed their endurance and prowess in war, he never marched out on campaign when Milesians were absent, while by their presence—so long as no other course was possible—they continued both to be and to be called saviors of the King and of the King's realm. Yet when, travailing with freedom, they could no longer bear to see the Greeks enslaved, they were the first to initiate the revolt as soon as opportunity offered; and drawing the rest after them, themselves leading every noble enterprise and truly showing the part of a leader, they marched right up to Sardis itself, ravaged the affairs of the Persians, and as Greeks exacted on behalf of Greeks such vengeance as was possible from the barbarians, with the Milesians leading and giving the signal—acting in this too in a manner thoroughly Greek and wise: yielding when circumstances are adverse, yet seizing opportunity the moment it arrives, so as neither to attempt the impossible and incur the charge of folly, nor to sleep when opportunity presents itself.

§ 10. [σ. 11–13] Τοιαύτη μὲν δή τις ἡ Μίλητος καὶ τοσαύτη, καὶ οὕτως ἡ πρὸς μητρὸς ἡμῖν εἶπεν ἄν τις μήτηρ διὰ παντὸς ἥκει θαύματος, ὃ περὶ Εὐρώπην Ἀθῆναι καὶ τὸ τῆς Ἀττικῆς ἔδαφος, τοῦτο περὶ τὴν Ἀσίαν αὐτὴ καὶ ἀρχῆς ἕνεκα καὶ εὐδαιμονίας ἀναφανεῖσα. Τοιαύτη δὲ οὖσα καὶ σφόδρα τῶν Ἀθηνῶν ἐπαξία ἑτέραν ἑαυτὴν ἐν τῷ τοῦ Εὐξείνου Πόντου καλλίστῳ τὴν Σινώπην οἰκίζει, ἀνθρώπων τε πλήθει στενοχωρουμένη καὶ δυνάμεως ἱκανῶς ἔχουσα. Οὐ γὰρ ἦν ἀπὸ τῆς ἑτέρας ἐπὶ τὴν ἄλλην θάλασσαν μεταβαίνειν, μὴ περιουσίᾳ χρωμένην δυνάμεως καὶ τῶν ἐν μέσῳ πάντων ἢ τελέως ἐπικρατήσασαν ἢ λόγον ποιουμένην οὐδένα. Ἅτε δὲ καὶ δυνάμει καὶ πλούτῳ ἀνθρώπων τε πλήθει τὸ συγκεχωρηκὸς ἔχουσα παρὰ πάντων, πρός τε τὴν ἀποικίαν ἀπεῖδε, καί, κατ' ἐξουσίαν ἑαυτῇ τὸν κάλλιστον χῶρον ἐκλεξαμένη, τοὺς παρ' ἑαυτῆς ᾤκισε φέρουσα ἔνθα συνοίσειν τε αὐτοῖς ἔμελλε μάλιστα καὶ κατῳκημένους ἀσφαλές τε εἶναι καὶ πρὸς τὰς χρείας εὐπόριστον αἷς ὁ τῶν ἀνθρώπων συνέχεται βίος. Ἐν καλῷ μὲν γὰρ τῆς θαλάσσης κειμένη, ἐν ἀσφαλεῖ δὲ καὶ τῆς ἠπείρου, ἠπειρῶτίς τε καὶ θαλάσσιος οὖσα, οὐδέτερον αὖ ἀκριβῶς εἶναι δοκεῖ, καὶ τοιαύτη δοκοῦσα τὰ παρ' ἑκατέρων ὅμως, ἠπείρου τε καὶ θαλάσσης, δέχεται δαψιλῶς, ἅτε καὶ πρὸς ἀμφοτέρας εὖ ἔχουσα θέσεως ἕνεκα.

Προβέβληται μὲν γὰρ ἐς τὸ πέλαγος ὁ τῇδε χῶρος, μέχρι πολλοῦ προτεινόμενος, τὴν θάλασσαν ἡμερῶν καὶ τοὺς ἐνταῦθα καταίροντας ὑποδεχόμενος καὶ χεῖρα προτείνων καὶ μεταδιδοὺς ἀναπαύλης καὶ ἀσφαλείας οἷς ἐν κύκλῳ λιμέσι καὶ ὅρμοις διείληπται, μᾶλλον δ' οἷς λιμὴν ὅλος ἐστὶ καὶ σύμπας ὁ πρὸς ἥλιον ἀνίσχοντα κόλπος εἰσέχων, εἰς νήσου δ' ἀποτορνευόμενος σχῆμα, καὶ περιηγμένος ἐν κύκλῳ ἰσθμῷ τινι μίγνυται τῇ ἠπείρῳ ἀπὸ θαλάσσης εἰς θάλασσαν οὐ μάλα πολλῷ διέχοντι διαστήματι, καὶ χερρόνησος γίνεται. Ἡ δὲ πόλις ἐπ' αὐτῷ τῷ ἰσθμῷ, ἐπὶ μὲν μῆκος παρατεταμένη μέχρις οὗ πλείστου ἠδύνατο, κατιοῦσα δ' ἐπ' εὖρος ἑκατέρωθεν μέχρι θαλάσσης καὶ καθαρῶς ἤδη νῆσον τὴν χερρόνησον ἀποδείξασα οἷς, αὐτῆς τε κειμένη μέσον καὶ τῆς ἠπείρου, διέστησεν αὐτὰς ἀπ' ἀλλήλων. Καὶ γοῦν ἀκριβῶς οὖσαν θαλάσσιον οὐδὲν ἧττον αὐτὴν καὶ θαλάττης οὐχ ὀλίγον ἀπέχουσαν ἠπειρῶτιν καλέσαις, ἐκ τοῦ εἴσω καὶ πρὸς θάλατταν αὐτῆς μέρους ἤπειρον

§ 10. [p. 11–13] Such, then, and so great was Miletus, and thus does our maternal grandmother, as one might call her, attain to every height of wonder, having proved in Asia—both in dominion and in prosperity—what Athens and the soil of Attica were in Europe. Being such, and thoroughly worthy of Athens, she founded another self in the fairest part of the Euxine Pontus, namely Sinope, when pressed for room by the multitude of her people and amply endowed with power. For it would not have been possible to cross over from the one sea to the other had she not possessed a superabundance of power, having either completely mastered all who lay between or else held them of no account. Enjoying undisputed preeminence from all in power, wealth, and multitude of inhabitants, she looked toward colonization and, freely choosing the fairest site at her pleasure, conveyed her colonists thither and settled them where it would profit them most, and where, once settled, they would enjoy both security and ready abundance for the needs whereby human life is sustained. Situated advantageously upon the sea and securely too upon the mainland, being at once continental and maritime, Sinope seems on the other hand to be strictly neither; yet seeming so, she nonetheless receives in rich abundance the bounties of both mainland and sea, so favorably is she placed toward each alike by virtue of her site.

For the land there juts out into the open sea, stretching far forward, taming the waters, welcoming those who put in to shore, extending a helping hand, and affording rest and safety through the harbors and anchorages wherewith it is indented all around—nay rather, inasmuch as the entire gulf curving inward toward the rising sun is one unbroken harbor. Rounded off as though turned on a lathe into the shape of an island and swept round in a circle, the headland joins the mainland by an isthmus stretching no very great distance from sea to sea, and thus becomes a peninsula. The city stands upon the isthmus itself, extending in length as far as it could reach and descending in breadth on either side down to the sea, thereby turning the peninsula cleanly into an island inasmuch as, lying midway between it and the mainland, she has parted them from one another. Accordingly, though she is strictly maritime, you might nonetheless equally call her an inland city set no small distance from the sea, since on her inner, seaward side

περιβεβλημένην τοσαύτην, ὡς καὶ προαστείων λόγον ἐπέχειν καὶ ἀμπελῶνας ἀποπληροῦν καὶ βουσὶ καὶ ἀρότροις ἀνεῖσθαι καὶ πρὸς καρπῶν φορὰν ἐξαρκεῖν. Οὕτω δὲ ἔχουσα καὶ ποταμῶν δύο μεγίστων τε καὶ καλλίστων τῶν ἀνὰ πᾶσαν τὴν γῆν τὴν μέσην εἴληχε θέσιν καὶ ἐναντίαν, ἔνθεν μὲν Νείλου τοῦ τὴν Αἴγυπτον ἄρδοντος, ὑδάτων ἀρίστου καὶ γονιμωτάτου, ἀπ' ἄρκτων δέ γε τοῦ Ἴστρου, πρὸς τὰς ἀμφοτέρων ἐκβολὰς βλέπουσα καὶ ἀμφοῖν ἐναντίον κειμένη, Ἴστρου τοῦ πηγάζοντος μὲν ἐκ Κελτῶν καὶ Πειρήνης πόλεως, μέσον δὲ σχίζοντος ἅπασαν τὴν Εὐρώπην καὶ πρὸς τὸν Εὔξεινον ἐκβαίνοντος Πόντον, τῆσδε τῆς πόλεως ἔναντι, ἀφ' ἧς ἄν τέ τις ἐπὶ τὴν ὀρεινὴν ἴοι Κιλικίαν ἄν τ' ἐκεῖθεν ἐς Αἴγυπτον, ὅπου ῥέων Νεῖλος ἐκβάλλει, εὐθεῖά τε αὐτῷ ἡ ὁδὸς ἔσται καὶ ἀπαρέγκλιτος καὶ τὸ ὅλον εἰπεῖν ἀτραπός.

Οὕτως ἐν καλῷ τε κεῖται τῆς γῆς τόδε τὸ μέρος αὐτῆς, καὶ τοῖς ἁπανταχόθεν δορυφορεῖται καλοῖς, οἷς αὐτούς τε Μιλησίους πρὸς τὸν οἰκεῖον ἐπηγάγετο ἔρωτα καὶ πρότερόν ποτε Κιμμερίοις τὴν πολλὴν ἔστησε πλάνην. Οὗτοι γάρ, ὑπὸ Σκυθῶν τῶν νομάδων ἐκ τῶν ὑπὲρ τὸν Καύκασον καὶ Ἀράξην ποταμὸν τόπων ἐξαναστάντες καὶ εἰς τὸ πρόσθεν ἀεὶ καταδιωκόμενοι, οὐ πρότερον τῆς φυγῆς ἔληξαν, οὐδὲ τῆς τῶν διωκόντων ἔσχον ὠμότητός τε καὶ τυραννίδος ἀπαλλαγῆναι, πρὶν ἐπ' αὐτὴν τήνδε τὴν χερρόνησον ἐξικέσθαι καὶ ταύτην οἰκίσαι, οὕτω μὲν θέσεως εὖ, οὕτω δ' ἀσφαλείας καλῶς ἔχουσαν γνόντες, ὥστ' εἰ μὴ τοῖς Ἕλλησι τῶν τῆς οἰκουμένης τιμιωτάτων πεπρωμένων καὶ τοῦτον αὐτοὺς ἔδει τὸν χῶρον κοσμῆσαι Ἑλληνίδα τε πόλιν ἐνταῦθα συστῆναι, κἂν ἐς τόδε Κιμμερίων ἦν ἔθνη τῇδε οἰκοῦντα καὶ τῆς ἐνταῦθα γῆς ἄρχοντα. Νῦν δ' οὐδ' ἐς δύο που γενεὰς διατετριφότας ἐκεῖσε Λυδοὶ μὲν ἀνέστησαν, Ἕλληνες δὲ καὶ οἱ ἀπὸ Μιλήτου πεμφθέντες, Λυδῶν οὐκ ἐπιστρεφόμενοι, τῆς τε γῆς ἐπελάβοντο καὶ τείχεσι τὸν ἰσθμὸν περιέλαβον, ὡς τὴν τοιάνδε τῆς γῆς ἀπόμοιραν τοὺς τοιούσδε τῶν ἀνδρῶν οἰκεῖν δέον, ᾗ, τούτων τε καὶ πολλῶν ἄλλων ὄντων τῶν ἐν ἐπαίνου καὶ θαύματος, οὐδὲν ἧττον καὶ Διογένης ὁ Σινωπεὺς εἰς κόσμον τε καὶ δόξαν αὐτῇ συντελεῖ, ἐνταῦθα μὲν καὶ γεννηθεὶς καὶ τραφείς, ἐν δὲ πάσῃ σχεδὸν οἰκουμένῃ πολιτευσάμενος καὶ γῆς ἁπάσης πολίτης γενόμενος, σοφίας μὲν ἐπ' ἄκρον ἐληλακὼς ὅση τε θεωρίας ἔχεται καὶ λόγων ἅπτεται θειοτέρων ὅση τε πρακτικὴ καὶ ἠθική, κοσμοῦσα τὸν ἄνθρωπον καὶ

she is encompassed by dry land so extensive as to serve for suburbs, suffice for vineyards, lie open to oxen and plows, and prove ample for the bearing of crops. Thus situated, she has also been allotted the central and facing position between the two greatest and fairest rivers in all the earth: on the one hand the Nile, which waters Egypt, best and most fertile of streams, and on the north the Ister, looking toward the mouths of both and lying directly opposite each—the Ister, which rises among the Celts and by the city of Pyrene, cleaves all Europe through the midst, and empties into the Euxine Pontus opposite this very city; from which, whether one travels to Rough Cilicia or thence to Egypt where the flowing Nile empties into the sea, one's road will be straight and unswerving—in a word, a direct path.

So nobly situated is this portion of the earth, and so attended on every side by fair advantages, wherewith it both drew the Milesians themselves to fall in love with it and in earlier times stayed the long wandering of the Cimmerians. For when these latter were driven from the regions beyond the Caucasus and the Araxes River by the nomadic Scythians and pursued ever onward, they neither ceased from flight nor were able to rid themselves of the cruelty and tyranny of their pursuers until they reached this very peninsula and settled it, recognizing it to be so well favored in position and so admirably endowed with security that—had the most precious places of the inhabited world not been destined for the Greeks, making it needful that they should adorn this spot too and that a Greek city should arise here—tribes of Cimmerians would even to this day be dwelling there and ruling the land. As it was, after they had tarried there scarcely two generations, the Lydians drove them out, while Greeks—those sent forth from Miletus—paying no heed to the Lydians, took possession of the land and enclosed the isthmus with walls, inasmuch as it was fitting that such a portion of the earth should be inhabited by such men. And to this city, alongside these and many other things worthy of praise and wonder, Diogenes of Sinope contributes no less ornament and renown: born and bred there, he lived as a citizen in well-nigh the whole inhabited world and became a citizen of all the earth, having attained the summit of wisdom—both that which cleaves to contemplation and touches upon more divine truths, and that which is

ῥυθμίζουσα τὴν ψυχὴν καὶ τὰς αὐτῆς ἀτάκτους ὁρμὰς ἀναστέλλουσα, κοινὸς δ' εὐεργέτης ἀναφανεὶς ἅπασι καὶ τυράννους ἐλέγχων καὶ νουθετῶν τοὺς πολλοὺς αὐτῶν τε καθαπτόμενος βασιλέων καὶ ἰδιώτας διδάσκων καὶ πᾶσι κοινὸν ἑαυτὸν εἰς μέσον ἀγαθὸν προτιθέμενος.

§ 11. [σ. 13–14] Αὕτη μὲν οὖν, Μιλησίων ἄποικος οὖσα κἀκείνους αὐχοῦσα πατέρας, ἐπείπερ τῶν προαγαγόντων ἀξίως καὶ ὡς ἂν εἰκὸς ἦν ἐκ ῥίζης ἀνασχοῦσαν τοιαύτης εἰς αὔξησιν ἐπιδοῦσαν καὶ τῶν καθ' αὑτὴν μηδεμιᾶς ἔλαττον ἔχουσαν κατ' οὐδέν, ἔδει μηδ' ἀποικίαις ἐνδεῖν μηδὲ ταύτῃ τῶν ἄλλων ἡττᾶσθαι, μοίρας αὐτῇ θείας συλλαβομένης, καὶ τοῦτο δεδύνηται. Δεδύνηται δὲ βέλτιον μὲν ἢ κατὰ τὰς ἄλλας, μεῖζον δὲ ἢ καθ' αὑτήν, αὑτήν τε καὶ τὰς ἁπανταχοῦ πόλεις ἐν τούτῳ νικήσασα, συνοικίσασα μὲν τὴν Τραπεζοῦντα καὶ ἡμετέραν ταυτηνὶ πόλιν, ἡττηθεῖσα δ' αὐτῆς οὐδ' ὅσον ἂν ηὔξατο· καὶ ὃ τοῖς ἄλλοις πατράσιν εὐκτὸν μέν, οὐ ῥᾴδιον δ' ἴσως, τῶν παίδων ἡττᾶσθαι, τούτου καὶ τετύχηκεν αὕτη, καὶ σφόδρα νενίκηται, καὶ τὰ δευτερεῖα φέρουσα χαίρει ὡς ἂν οὕτω λαμπρότερον κοσμουμένη. Οὐ γὰρ ὅσον αὐτήν τε ταύτην τὴν ἀποικισαμένην ἡ καθ' ἡμᾶς ὑπερεβάλλετο πόλις, ἀλλὰ καὶ τῶν ἄλλων οὐκ ἄν τις εὕροι τὴν νικῶσαν ῥᾳδίως. Ταῖς τε γὰρ τῶν ἀρίστων ἀρίσταις ἐφάμιλλον παρέχεται ἑαυτὴν καὶ πρὸς τὴν Ἀττικὴν καὶ τὴν πόλιν τῶν Ἀθηνῶν ἐξεικασμένη τοῖς πλείοσιν ἐκείνης εἰκὼν καὶ ἀκριβὲς ὡς ἐνῆν ἀπείργασται μίμημα.

Ὃ γὰρ ἐφ' ἡμῶν καὶ τῆς φύσεως αὐτῇ δεδιδάγμεθα πείρᾳ καὶ τῷ παθεῖν, ὡς ἄρα στίγματά τινα καὶ οὐλὰς ἐν βραχίοσι καὶ προσώπῳ φερόντων τινῶν, ἐν μὲν παισὶ καὶ παίδων ἴσως παισὶν οὐκ ἂν ἴδοις τὴν ὁμοιότητα, ἐς δὲ τρίτην γενεὰν καὶ τετάρτην ἐπισημαίνει τά γε τοιαῦτα, καὶ τὴν ἴσην οὐλὴν ἐπὶ ταὐτοῦ τόπου τῷ πάππῳ ἢ ἐπιπάππῳ τὸν υἱωνὸν ἢ υἱὸν υἱωνοῦ εὕροις ἂν φέροντα, τοῦτο κἀνταῦθα κρείττονα τρόπον συμβέβηκεν. Οὐ γὰρ οὐλῶν δή τινων καὶ στιγμάτων οὐδ' ἀγεννῶν τινῶν καὶ φαύλων ἡμῖν ἡ πόλις παραδειγμάτων εἰκόνα σώζει καὶ τύπον, ἀλλὰ τὴν Ἀθηνῶν κοινότητα καὶ φιλανθρωπίαν καί τινα τρόπον ἕτερον τὸ αὐτόχθον ἐκεῖνο καὶ τῆς δυνάμεως τὴν περιουσίαν καὶ κράτος ἐν πολέμοις καὶ μάχαις καὶ ὅσα κόσμος Ἀττικῆς καὶ ταύτης μόνης

practical and ethical, adorning a man, bringing harmony to the soul, and restraining its disorderly impulses—while proving himself a common benefactor to all: rebuking tyrants, admonishing the multitude, assailing kings themselves, instructing private citizens, and setting himself forth in public as a common good to all.

§ 11. [p. 13–14] Sinope, then, being a colony of the Milesians and boasting them as her fathers—since it behooved a city that had grown and flourished worthily of her founders, as was natural for one sprung from such a root, and that was in no respect inferior to any city of her rank, not to be wanting in colonies either nor to yield to others in this regard—with divine providence lending her aid, achieved this as well. Nay, she achieved it better than other cities and on a scale greater than herself, surpassing in this both herself and cities everywhere: for she founded Trebizond, this city of ours, and was outdone by her beyond even what she might have prayed for. That very thing which to other fathers is devoutly wished for, though perhaps not easy—to be surpassed by their own children—she has attained: she has been thoroughly outdone, and rejoices to take second place, seeing herself all the more brilliantly adorned thereby. For our city has not merely excelled the mother-city that colonized her, but among all other cities too one could not easily find any that surpasses her. Indeed, she shows herself a rival to the very best of the best, and, modeled in most respects after Attica and the city of the Athenians, she has been wrought into her image and, so far as was possible, her exact likeness.

For what we have been taught in our own case and that of nature through actual experience and observation—namely, that when certain men bear marks and scars upon their arms and face, in their children and perhaps their children's children you might not see the resemblance, yet in the third and fourth generation such traits reappear, and you may find the grandson or great-grandson bearing the selfsame scar on the selfsame spot as his grandfather or great-grandfather—this very thing has come to pass here too, though in a nobler way. For our city preserves the image and stamp not of scars and brands, nor of any ignoble and paltry models; rather, Athens's public-spiritedness and benevolence, and in another way that famous autochthony of hers, her superabundance of power, her might in wars and battles,

καθέστηκεν οὐ παντελῶς ἐν τοῖς ὑπ' αὐτῆς οἰκισθεῖσι σωθέντος ἀκριβῶς ἡμεῖς μεμιμήμεθα, καίτοι διὰ τρίτης πρὸς αὐτὴν ἀναφέροντες καὶ παίδων αὐτῇ παῖδες ὄντες καὶ πρὸς αὐτὴν ἀπεικάσμεθα τρίτον καὶ τοῦ παραδείγματος οὐκ ἐκπίπτομεν, ὥστ' ἄν τις ἐκείνοις τὰ ἡμέτερα παραβάλλοι, καὶ σφόδρ' ἂν τοῦ σκοποῦ τύχοι καὶ πολλῶν συλληψομένων καὶ συνοισόντων αὐτῷ τῶν ἐπαίνων τὸν ἔρανον.

and all that has constituted the glory of Attica and of her alone—though not preserved in its entirety among those directly colonized by her—we ourselves have imitated with precision. Even though we trace our lineage back to her at the third remove and are her children's children, even in the third degree we have been fashioned in her likeness and do not fall short of the archetype; so that should anyone compare our qualities with hers, he would hit the mark full well, with many ready to join him and contribute their share to the feast of praises.

§ 12. [σ. 14] Τοῦ μὲν γὰρ παντὸς μέση καὶ γῆς τῆς καθόλου οὔτ' αὐτὴ κεῖται ἡ ἡμετέρα, οὔτ' ἂν αὐτὸς φαίην. Μάλιστα μὲν γὰρ μιᾶς τοῦτο γίνεται καὶ τόπου ἑνὸς καὶ τὰς ἄλλας οὐκ ἔστι ταὐτοῦ τούτου τυχεῖν, οὐδ' ἂν πολλὰ ἀγωνίσωνται, ὥσθ' ὅταν τις ἁπασῶν ταύτῃ καταψηφίσηται, καὶ τούτου χωρὶς οὐκ ἂν ἔχοιμεν οἷς αὑτοὺς τῆς μέμψεως ἐξελοίμεθα καὶ μετὰ τῶν ἐπαινουμένων ἂν θείημεν, τότε καὶ ταύτην ἢ μέσην δεκτέον ἢ μὴ ἔχοντας ἐγκαλύπτεσθαι καὶ μετ' αἰσχύνης περιιέναι, τὸ μεῖζον εἰς δόξαν ὑφαιρεθέντας. Ἔπειτα, εἰ μὲν τῷ μέσην εἶναι καὶ τὸ πάντων εὐθὺς ἀρίστην πεφυκέναι συνηκολούθει, εἶχεν ἂν λόγον περιεργάζεσθαι· εἰ δὲ τοῦτο μὲν οὐδ' ἄν τις καὶ τοῖς οὖσιν ἀπομαχόμενος εἴποι, πολλαὶ δὲ διαφοραὶ γῆς βελτίους τε καὶ κρείττους, μείους τε καὶ μείζους, αὐτῆς ἑαυτῆς ὡς ἐπὶ τὸ πολὺ βελτίονος οὔσης τοῖς πλείοσιν αὐτῆς μέρεσιν, ἔνθα τὸ μέσον χώραν οὐκ ἔχει, τί ἄν τις ἡν ἐπαινεῖ ἀπό τε τῶν οὐκ ὄντων καὶ ὧν οὐ μέγα τὸ θαῦμα κοσμοίη, τὰ ὄντα οἱ παρ' οὐδὲν θέμενος καὶ τὸν ἀληθῆ κόσμον αὐτῆς παριδὼν καὶ κατ' ἄμφω τοῦ πρέποντος ἁμαρτών; Τὸ μὲν οὖν τῆς γῆς μέσον οὐκ ἂν ἡμῖν ἡ πόλις ἐπέχοι, τὸ δ' αὐτῆς κάλλιστον ὄψις τε μαρτυρεῖ καὶ πεῖρα παρέστησε καὶ ὁ λόγος προϊὼν ἀποδείξει.

§ 12. [p. 14] That our city lies at the center of the universe and of the earth as a whole, neither is true of her in fact, nor would I myself assert it. In the first place, that distinction can belong to only a single city and a single spot, and it is impossible for all the rest to attain this same privilege, no matter how hard they might strive; only, therefore, if someone were to condemn all other cities on this count, and if apart from this we should have no means whereby to clear ourselves of blame and rank ourselves among those worthy of praise—only then should we be obliged either to maintain that she too lies at the center or else, unable to do so, to veil our faces and go about in shame, stripped of what contributes most to glory. In the second place, if being by nature supreme among all cities followed straightway upon lying at the center, there would be good reason to trouble oneself over the point; but if not even one who fights against plain reality would make such a claim, and if instead there are many diverse regions of the earth, better and superior, lesser and greater—the earth itself for the most part excelling itself in most of its regions, where centrality has no place—why would anyone adorn the city he praises with qualities that neither exist nor command any great wonder, setting at naught the merits she actually possesses, overlooking her true ornament, and sinning against propriety on both counts? The center of the earth, then, our city may not occupy; yet that she occupies its fairest part, sight bears witness, experience has established, and our discourse, as it advances, will demonstrate.

§ 13. [σ. 14–15] Εἰ δή με καὶ μεσότητος χρὴ μνησθῆναί τινος, μέσην ἂν φαίην οὐκ Ἀττικῆς τινος καὶ Ἑλλάδος, μικροῦ χωρίου καὶ γῆς ὀλίγης, μικροῖς διαστήμασι μετρουμένης καὶ στενοῖς ὅροις ὁριζομένης, ἀλλὰ τοῦ

§ 13. [p. 14–15] Yet if I must indeed make mention of some centrality, I would call her the center not of some Attica and Hellas—a tiny district and a scanty land, measured by narrow intervals and bounded by confined borders—

τῆς Ἀσίας ὡς εἰπεῖν πλείστου καὶ τῶν Ἀσιανῶν ἐθνῶν καὶ πόλεων. Ἐκ μὲν γὰρ τοῦ πρὸς ἀνίσχοντα ἥλιον Πέρσαι καὶ Μῆδοι καὶ Σάπειρες καὶ τὰ Κόλχων ἔθνη περιοικοῦσι τὴν ἡμετέραν, ἐκ δέ γε θατέρου Καππαδόκαι καὶ Κίλικες καὶ Γαλάται περιστοιχοῦσιν ἡμᾶς καὶ Λυδοί, ὥσπερ τινὰ δορυφορίαν ἡμῖν συμπληροῦντες καὶ χορείαν τινὰ περιελίττοντες ἐναρμόνιον, ὥσπερ ἐν κύκλῳ, καὶ στεφανοῦντες μὲν ἡμᾶς τοῖς παρ' ἑαυτῶν καὶ ὧν ἑκάστη φέρει καλῶν, δεχόμενοι δὲ τὰ παρ' ἡμῶν καὶ ὅ φασιν ἐξαντλοῦντες μὲν ἀμφοτέραις, πλείω δὲ λείποντες ἢ λαμβάνουσιν. Αὐτή τε γὰρ παρ' αὐτῆς ἡ πόλις ἡμῶν οὐκ ἔστιν ἧς τινος ἔλαττον ἔχει οἷς φέρει καὶ γεωργεῖ καὶ τὰ παρ' ἐκείνων ὑποδεχομένη ταμεῖον κοινὸν καὶ ἐργαστήριον οἰκουμένης καὶ θάλασσα, φασίν, ἀγαθῶν ἀναπέφηνεν.

but of well-nigh the greatest part of Asia and of the Asian nations and cities. For on the side toward the rising sun, Persians, Medes, Sapeires, and the Colchian peoples dwell around our land, while on the other side Cappadocians, Cilicians, Galatians, and Lydians stand ranged about us, forming, as it were, a bodyguard of honor for us and weaving a harmonious choral dance around us as in a circle: they crown us with their own goods and with the fine things that each land brings forth, while receiving ours in return, and—as the saying goes—though they scoop up with both hands, they leave behind more than they take away. For our city, both of herself—falling short of none whatever in what she produces and cultivates—and by welcoming the goods that come from those peoples, has proved to be a common storehouse and workshop of the inhabited world and, as the proverb says, a veritable sea of blessings.

Οὐ γὰρ δὴ πρὸς οὓς εἴρηται μόνον οὕτω θέσεως δεξιῶς ἔχει, ὥσπερ τι κέντρον πρὸς τὰ κύκλῳ πανταχοῦ σχεδὸν ἴσην ἔχουσα τὴν ἀπόστασιν, ὡς, ὅθεν ἄν τις ἐπ' αὐτὴν ὁρμηθῇ, κοῦφον εἶναι τὴν πόλιν καὶ μονονοὺ πάντοθεν ἴσην καὶ ὅμοιον, ἀλλὰ καί, πρὸς τοὺς τῆς ἑτέρας ἠπείρου καὶ πόλεις τὰς εὐρωπαίας οὐδὲν ἧττον ἔχουσα συμμιγνύναι, τὴν ἀρίστην εἴληχε τάξιν καὶ θέσιν καὶ ἧς οὐδ' ἂν αὐτὴ κρείττονα ηὔξατο. Τοῦ γὰρ πρὸς ἕω σύμπαντος Πόντου καὶ τῆς τῇδε θαλάσσης τὴν μέσην σχεδὸν χώραν ἐπέχουσα, πρός τε τὰ παρ' ἑκάτερα παραπλεῖν ἀσφαλῶς ἔχει καὶ ῥᾷστα, τὰ μὲν ἐκφέρουσα, τὰ δ' ἀντεισάγουσα, τῇ τε ἀντιπέρας ἠπείρῳ οὐκ ἐκ πολλοῦ διαστήματος οὐδὲ πολλοῦ πόνου καὶ πλοῦ μιγνυμένην οὐκ ἔστιν ὃ τῶν καλῶν αὐτὴν διαφεύγει καὶ ὧν ἡ σύμπασα φέρει. Οὕτως ἡμῖν περίεστι καὶ μεσότητος, καὶ τοιούτων ἄρα καὶ τοσούτων ἐθνῶν καὶ χωρῶν τὴν μέσην εἰλήχαμεν, εἴπερ τῳ φέρειν καὶ τοῦτο δοκεῖ εἰς ἔπαινον καὶ θαύματος λόγον.

Nor is it solely in relation to the peoples just named that she is so favorably situated—maintaining, like a center toward the circumference, an almost equal distance in every direction, so that from whatever quarter one sets out toward her, access to the city is easy and well-nigh equidistant and uniform from every side—but also, being no less able to hold intercourse with the inhabitants of the other continent and the cities of Europe, she has obtained as her lot the finest station and site, one better than which not even she herself could have prayed for. Occupying as she does nearly the central position along the entire eastern Pontus and the sea in these parts, she is able to coast safely and with the greatest ease toward the regions on either hand, exporting some goods and importing others in exchange; and mingling with the opposite continent across no great distance nor at the cost of much toil and voyage, there is nothing that escapes her of all the fine things that the whole earth produces. To such a degree do we abound even in centrality, and of nations and lands of such quality and number have we been allotted the midst—if indeed anyone deems that this too contributes to praise and a ground for wonder.

§ 14. [σ. 15–17] Πελάγους τε καὶ θαλάσσης τοιαύτης τὸ μέσον ἐπέχομεν, ἣν οὐδεὶς ἂν διὰ τέλους οὐ λογογράφος οὐ ποιητὴς ᾄσαι, κἂν πολλὰ φθέγξαιτο καὶ τοῦτο μόνον ἔργον προστήσαιτο. Τῷ γὰρ Εὐξείνῳ

§ 14. [p. 15–17] Moreover, we occupy the middle of an open main and a sea of such a character that neither prose writer nor poet could ever sing its praises to the full, even should he utter many words and set this before

δὴ Πόντῳ πρῶτον μὲν αὐτὸ τοὔνομα τοῦτο, πολλὴν φιλανθρωπίαν τε καὶ κοινότητα μαρτυροῦν, πάντα συλλήβδην αὐτοῦ κατηγορεῖ τἀγαθά, ὡς μὴ τὸν πολλὰ μὲν εἰρεσίαις ἐνιδρώσαντα, πολλὰ δὲ πρωρεύσαντα καὶ διασκεψάμενον πνεύματα, κύματα, κλύδωνας, πλείω δὲ πηδαλιουχήσαντα μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὸν θαλάσσης καὶ τοῦ κατ' αὐτὴν ἄπειρον πλοῦ τοῦτο μόνον ῥηθὲν θαρρύνειν τε καὶ πτεροῦν πρὸς τὸν πλοῦν, καὶ κυμάτων καὶ πνευμάτων ὑπερορῶντα καὶ πᾶσαν τῆς ψυχῆς ἀπεληλακότα δειλίαν.

Ἔπειτ' αὐτῇ τε πείρᾳ γνόντας καὶ πράγματι ὡς ἀλύπως καὶ ἀσφαλῶς, ὡς ἐνὸν τοὺς πλέοντας ἑκασταχοῦ παραπέμπει, οὐκ ἔστιν αὐτῷ παραβαλεῖν οὐδ' ὁντινοῦν ἕτερον, οὐ κόλπον, οὐ πέλαγος. Οὐ Χάρυβδιν γάρ, οὐ Σκύλλαν προτείνεται, οὐκ ἄμπωτιν, οὐ πλημμυρίδα ποιεῖ καὶ παλίρροιαν, τοτὲ μὲν ἐπὶ ξηρᾶς ὥσπερ προσηλῶν καὶ πατταλεύων τὰ σκάφη, τοτὲ δὲ βυθίζων καὶ δεικνὺς ὑποβρύχια, οὐδὲ Σικελικὸς ἐνταῦθα πορθμὸς καὶ πελάγους Ἀτλαντικοῦ ῥαχίαι καὶ πέτραι τινὲς ὕφαλοι καὶ σπιλάδες, αἷς ἀνάγκη τοῦ πνεύματος τοὺς πλέοντας συρρηγνύντας τῶν μὲν αἰσθάνεσθαι μόνον, οὐκ ἔχειν δ' ὅπερ ἂν διαπράξωνται, πρὸ ὀφθαλμῶν σφίσι τοῦ ὀλέθρου κειμένου, τῶν δ' οὐδὲ συνεῖναι πληττουσῶν, ἀλλὰ φθάνειν τὴν πεῖραν τὴν αἴσθησιν τῶν κακῶν, πρὶν οἱ τύχης κεχώρηκε σφίσι τὰ πράγματα γνῶναι τοῦ ἁλμυροῦ πίνοντας ὕδατος, ἀλλ' ὅλος δι' ὅλου ἑαυτοῦ ὁμαλός τε καὶ συνεχὴς τέταται, ἐφ' ὅσον πλεῖστον ἐχρῆν ἥκων μήκους τε καὶ πλάτους, ὡς μήτε ἀδιεξίτητος εἶναι διὰ τὸ μέγεθος, μήτ' αὖ ὑπεροπτέος τῷ συνεστάλθαι πρὸς τὸ μηδὲν καὶ μικροῖς ὅροις ἀπείργεσθαι, ἀλλ' ἡμερῶν μὲν οὐκ ὀλίγων τριφθήσεται πλῆθος πανταχῇ περιπλέοντι, διὰ παντὸς δὲ ὅμως ἔξεστι διελθεῖν καὶ πάντα τὸν Πόντον διερευνήσασθαι, μηδὲν αὐτοῦ καταλιπόντα ἀκίχητον. Τὴν γὰρ ἐν ἑκατέρῳ φυγὼν ἀμετρίαν, ἐπίσης τε καὶ μικρότητα καὶ μέγεθος ἀτιμάσας, ἐπὶ τοῦ μέσου τε καὶ ὀρθοῦ τετήρηκεν ἑαυτόν, τιμήσας τὸ μέτριον, νικῶν μὲν ὧν βέλτιον κατὰ μέγεθος, ἡττώμενος δ' ἃ γε νικᾶν οὐκ ἐχρῆν, ὡς νίκην εἶναι καὶ τὴν ἧτταν αὐτῷ κἀνταῦθα μόνον νικᾶσθαι οὗ νικᾶν οὐ συνήνεγκεν ἄν. Ὥστε, δέκα τῶν μεγέθει διαφερόντων κόλπων θαλάττης γνωριζομένων, οὔτε πρῶτός ἐστιν οὗτος οὔθ' ὕστατος, ἀλλ' ὁ μέσος ἤδη καὶ ἕκτος. Οὕτω καὶ οὗτος τὸ μέσον τετίμηκε.

himself as his sole task. For in the case of the Euxine [Hospitable] Sea, first of all this very name itself, bearing witness to great benevolence and genial hospitality, proclaims at once the sum of all its blessings: the mere utterance of this name emboldens and gives wings for the voyage not only to the man who has often sweated at the oars, often kept watch at the prow scanning winds, waves, and surges, and still more often guided the helm, but even to one wholly unacquainted with the sea and with sailing upon it, making him disdain waves and winds alike and banish all cowardice from his soul.

Secondly, once men have learned by actual experience and fact how painlessly and safely—so far as nature allows—it escorts mariners to every quarter, it is impossible to compare with it any other sea whatever, neither gulf nor open main. For it thrusts forward no Charybdis and no Scylla; it produces no ebb, no flood-tide and reflux, at one moment nailing and pegging vessels, as it were, fast upon dry land, and at another plunging them into the deep and sinking them beneath the surge; nor is there here any Sicilian Strait, or breakers of the Atlantic Ocean, or sunken rocks and jagged reefs, against which mariners, dashed by the force of the wind, are compelled with the one sort merely to behold them without having any means of saving themselves while destruction lies right before their eyes, and with the other sort not even to be aware of them as they strike, the actual impact outstripping their perception of the disaster, so that they are drinking the briny water before realizing to what pass their fortunes have come. Instead, throughout its whole expanse it stretches out smooth and continuous, attaining the greatest desirable measure of length and breadth, so as neither to be impassable through vastness nor, on the other hand, contemptible through shrinking into insignificance and being hemmed within narrow bounds; rather, while not a few days will be spent by one who sails right round it in every direction, it is nevertheless possible to traverse it from end to end and explore the entire Pontus, leaving no part of it unvisited. Shunning excess in either direction, and scorning pettiness and immensity alike, it has kept itself upon the middle and rightful course, honoring due measure—surpassing in size those seas which it was better to surpass, while yielding to those which it ought not to surpass, so that even its defeat is a victory for it, and it is surpassed in that point alone where to surpass

Θάλαττα δὲ καὶ πέλαγος ὢν καὶ καλούμενος, αὐτὸ τοῦτο μόνον ἐστὶν ὃ κέκληται, πέλαγος, οὐ νήσους, οὐκ ἠπείρους προβάλλων ἐν τῷ μέσῳ, οὐδ' ἀγροὺς καὶ κώμας καὶ πόλεις ἐν μέσῃ θαλάττῃ δεικνύς, ὡς ἔργον εἶναι τὴν ἀληθῆ κλῆσιν αὐτῷ φωράσαι καὶ ὅθεν ἂν αὐτὸν ὀνομάσαιμεν, πότερον ἤπειρον ἢ θάλατταν ὑγρὰν ἢ ξηράν, χέρσον ἢ πέλαγος, τοῦτο δὴ τὸ τῆς ἄλλης θαλάττης, ᾗ νόθην ἂν φαίην ταύτην προσεῖναι τὴν κλῆσιν, ἀλλοτρίῳ ἐπιθεμένην ὀνόματι, τὴν δ' ἡμετέραν ταυτηνὶ θάλασσαν μόνην γνησίως τε καὶ κυρίως τοῦτο καλεῖσθαι καὶ μόνην συμβαίνειν οἷς ὀνομάζεται, ὥστε καὶ τοὺς τῇδε τὸν πλοῦν ποιουμένους οὐδὲν οὐδαμῶς ὑποπτεύειν, ἀλλ' ὅλοις ἐστὶ θαρρεῖν φερομένους καὶ νύκτωρ καὶ μεθ' ἡμέραν μέσον τὸ πέλαγος τέμνοντας, οὐ νήσους, οὐ σκοπέλους ὑφορωμένους, οὐ δεδιότας ναυάγια, οἷς πολλοῖς περιπίπτειν ἀνάγκη τοὺς Ἑλλησπόντῳ τε καὶ Αἰγαίῳ καὶ τῇ τῇδε παραβαλλομένους θαλάττῃ ἀσφαλέστερόν τε πλεῖν ἄνευ ἁπάσης περιεργίας τὸν Εὔξεινον τῶν ὑπὸ πυρσοῖς καὶ λαμπτῆρσι καὶ πύργοις ἀλλαχοῦ καταιρόντων.

Περὶ πᾶσαν μὲν γὰρ ἑαυτοῦ τὴν ἀκτὴν ὅρμους τε καὶ λιμένας αὐτοφυεῖς ἐκ συμμέτρου διαστήματος παρεχόμενος, ὡς ἔστιν ἐν οἷς οὐδὲ πείσματος ὁρμούσας δεῖσθαι τὰς ναῦς, εἴσω δὲ τῶν ἑκατέρωθεν αἰγιαλῶν αὐτὸ τοῦτο μόνον ὕδωρ καὶ πέλαγος ὑπάρχων ἀμύθητον ἐφέντας μὲν εἰς αὐτὸ ταῖς χρηστοτέραις βουκολεῖ τῶν ἐλπίδων· κοῦφον γὰρ αὐτοῖς τότε καὶ νὺξ ἐπιγενομένη καὶ καταιγίδες καὶ λαίλαπες καὶ τυφὼς προσραγείς· ἔξεστι δέ γε πυθέσθαι τῶν ναυτικῶν, πᾶν οἰομένων φορητὸν μετά γε πελάγους· κατάραντας δὲ λαμπρῶς ὑποδέχεται καὶ φιλοφρόνως διαναπαύει, μεταδιδοῦσα καὶ λιμένων καὶ ἀγορῶν καὶ τῆς ἄλλης τρυφῆς· ὃ πολλοῦ δεῖ τῆς ἄλλης ἀπολαύειν θαλάσσης, ἡνίκ' ἄν, νυκτὸς ἀσελήνου ἐπιλαβούσης καὶ πνευμάτων ἐναντίων ἀπολαβόντων καὶ κύκλῳ πανταχῇ περικεχυμένων τῶν νήσων, ἔστι δ' ὅτε καὶ λαμπρὸν τῆς ἡμέρας διαλαμπούσης, σφοδρότερον συνωθοῦντος τοῦ

would not have been advantageous. Consequently, among the ten gulfs of the sea recognized as preeminent in magnitude, this is neither the first nor the last, but squarely in the middle, the sixth. Thus has it too honored the mean.

Moreover, both being and being called sea and open main, it is strictly the very thing it is called—open main—projecting no islands or continents in its midst, nor displaying fields, villages, and cities in the middle of the sea, so as to make it hard work to detect its true appellation and decide after what fashion we should name it—whether continent or sea, wet or dry, mainland or open water—as is the case with that other sea, to which I would say this title belongs only spuriously, since it has laid claim to a name not its own, whereas this sea of ours alone is genuinely and properly so called and alone corresponds to the names it bears. Hence those who make their voyage here harbor no suspicion whatsoever, but can take heart as they speed onward under full sail both by night and by day, cleaving the mid-sea, eyeing askance neither islands nor crags, nor dreading shipwrecks—into many of which those who hazard themselves upon the Hellespont, the Aegean, and the sea in those parts must needs fall—and they sail the Euxine without any anxious precautions more safely than men who put into port elsewhere with the aid of signal-fires, lanterns, and lighthouses.

For all around its entire coastline it affords natural roadsteads and harbors at well-proportioned intervals—so that in some of them vessels riding at anchor do not even need a mooring-cable—while within the shores on either side, being nothing else than water and boundless open sea, it cheers with the brightest of hopes those who have launched out upon it; for then oncoming night, squalls, tempests, and the bursting hurricane all seem light to them—indeed, one may inquire of seamen, who deem anything endurable so long as they have open sea room—; and when they put in to land, it welcomes them splendidly and refreshes them kindly, granting them harbors, markets, and every other comfort. Far indeed is one from enjoying such a blessing upon that other sea, whenever—as a moonless night overtakes us, contrary winds hem us in, and islands lie scattered all around in every direction, nay, at times even while broad daylight shines bright, if the gale drives us on too fiercely—before

πνεύματος, πρινὴ μεταχειρίσασθαι τὰ ἱστία καὶ χαλάσαι τὰ λαίφη, λάθοιμεν ἐξοκείλαντες πρὸς τὰς τῶν νήσων ἀκτὰς καὶ ταῖς πέτραις προσρήξαντες καὶ δύντες κατὰ βυθοῦ.

we can shift the sails and lower the canvas, before we know it we have run aground upon the shores of the islands, dashed against the rocks, and sunk to the bottom of the deep.

§ 15. [σ. 17–19] Τοιούτου δὲ τοῦ παντὸς ὄντος Εὐξείνου, τὸ περικλύζον ἡμᾶς ἔτι μέρος αὐτοῦ πολλῷ φιλανθρωπότερόν τε καὶ ἡμερώτερον, ὥσπερ ἑαυτὸν ἐνταῦθα νικῆσαι ἐρίσαντος καὶ αὐτὸν ἑαυτοῦ βελτίω τοῦτο τὸ μέρος φανῆναι θελήσαντος, ὥστε τοὺς ἐνταῦθα ναυτικοὺς καὶ θαλάττης ἐργάτας, καίτοι λιμένων ὄντων ἡμῖν οὐκ οἶδ' εἴ τινος φερόντων τὰ δεύτερα, ἔνθεν μὲν τοῦ τοῦ Ὕσσου λιμένος, ἐκεῖθεν δὲ τοῦ Ῥιζοῦντος, οὐδὲν αὐτοῖς χρῆσθαι, τὰ πλεῖστα κατ' ἐξουσίαν ἐνθερίζοντάς τε καὶ ἐνεαρίζοντας, ἔστι δ' ὅτε καὶ ἐγχειμάζοντας ὅπου καὶ τύχοι τῶν αἰγιαλῶν, ἐπὶ μιᾶς ἀγκύρας ἢ καὶ πολλάκις ἑνὸς πείσματος πεποιθότας καὶ χρωμένους ἀντὶ λιμένων ἀκτῇ πάσῃ καὶ πᾶσιν αἰγιαλοῖς καὶ σφᾶς αὐτοὺς καὶ τὰ σκάφη πιστεύοντας ᾧ ἂν καὶ βούλοιντο. Ὥσπερ γάρ, οἶμαι, τῆς φύσεως εὐφυῶς τε καὶ δεξιῶς τὰ τῇδε πάντα διαθεμένης, ἅτε προειδομένης τὴν ἐσομένην ἐνταῦθα πόλιν καὶ ὡς τοῖς τε ἄλλοις καὶ τῷ ναυτικῷ πλεῖστον διοίσει καὶ τριήρεσι περιέσται καὶ ναυσὶ κρατήσει τῶν κατ' αὐτήν, οὕτω τῆς ἐνταῦθα θαλάσσης ἥ τε φύσις καὶ θέσις εὐφυῶς ἔσχεν, ἀντὶ λιμένων μὲν τὰς ἀκτάς, ἀντὶ δὲ ὅρμων πεπλουτηκυῖα τοὺς αἰγιαλούς, ὃ μόνον ἄπιστον πανταχῇ πιστὸν ἐνταῦθ' ἀναφήνασα καὶ τὰ ἴσα δυνάμενον, οἷς μόνοις ἔνι πιστεύειν καὶ θαρρεῖν πανταχῇ, ὡς μηδὲν ἐμποδὼν εἴη τῷ πεπρωμένῳ καὶ οἷς περὶ αὐτῆς εἵμαρτο, μηδὲ κωλύσῃ μηδὲν αὐτὴν θαλάττης πειρᾶσθαι καὶ κυμάτων κατατολμᾶν καὶ ναυτικὸν βίον βιοῦν.

§ 15. [p. 17–19] Yet while the entire Euxine is of such a character, the part of it that washes our shores is still more benevolent and gentle by far, as though it had striven here to surpass itself and wished in this region to prove superior even to its own self. Consequently, the mariners and toilers of the sea here—although we possess harbors that yield second place, I dare say, to none, on the one side the Harbor of Hyssos and on the other that of Rhizous—make no use of them at all, for the most part spending summer and spring at their pleasure, and at times even wintering, at whatever spot along the beaches they happen upon, relying on a single anchor or oftentimes even a single mooring-cable, using every shore and every beach in place of harbors, and entrusting themselves and their vessels to whichever spot they please. For just as Nature, methinks, arranged all things here with happy skill and dexterity—inasmuch as she foresaw the city that was to arise here, and how she would excel greatly both in all else and in seamanship, prevail with her triremes, and rule by her ships over the peoples around her—even so have the nature and lie of our local sea been happily ordered: enriched with shores in place of harbors and with open beaches in place of roadsteads, it has rendered trustworthy here—and equal in efficacy to those shelters in which alone men can trust and take courage elsewhere—the very thing that everywhere else is untrustworthy, so that nothing might stand in the way of destiny and what was ordained concerning our city, nor anything hinder her from essaying the sea, braving the waves, and living a maritime life.

Πρὸς δὲ τοῦτο δοκῶ μοι καὶ τοὺς πρώτους ταύτην οἰκισαμένους ἰδόντας καὶ ταῦτα μαντευσαμένους περὶ αὐτῆς, ἐνταῦθα φέροντας ἐνιδρῦσαι τοὺς ἐξ ἑαυτῶν, πολλῶν τῶν ἐν μέσῳ ὑπεριδόντας. Παρ' ἑκάτερα γὰρ λιμένων ἐλλογίμων ὄντων, ὡς ἂν ἐκ τοῦ σύνεγγυς ἀμφοῖν ἔχοιεν χρῆσθαι, ἐπίσης αὐτοὺς ἑκατέρων ἀπέστησαν, πρὸς μὲν τὴν παροῦσαν ἑκάστοτε χρείαν ἀρκεῖν ἂν οἰόμενοι τοὺς παρόντας αἰγιαλούς, ἐν δὲ τῷ καλοῦντι τῆς ἀνάγκης κατ' ἐξουσίαν ἢ τόν γε κρείττω καὶ ταῖς παρισταμέναις ὥραις συμβαίνοντα πληροῦν

Looking to this same end, it seems to me, those who first colonized this city, having divined this destiny concerning her, passed over many intervening sites and brought their settlers to plant them right here. For since renowned harbors lay on either side, in order that they might be able to use both from close at hand, they stationed their people at an equal distance from each, judging that for ordinary day-to-day needs the beaches right before them would suffice, while at the call of necessity either the better harbor—whichever suited the

αὐτοῖς τὴν ἀνάγκην ἢ καὶ ἄμφω τὰς ναῦς αὐτῶν ὑποδέχεσθαι, τοῦ ἑνὸς οὐ χωροῦντος, οὐδ' ἀρκοῦντος τοσῷδε ναυτικοῦ πλήθει, ὃ πολλοῦ γ' ἔδει αὐτοὺς δύνασθαι, θατέρῳ τῶν λιμένων ἐπικειμένης τῆς πόλεως. Τούτου τε γὰρ ἂν ἐστέρητο, οὗ τὸ πλεῖστον τοῦ χρόνου νῦν ὁρμοῦσιν αἱ πλόϊμοι καὶ τοῦ τῶν λιμένων ἑτέρου δὶς τοσοῦτον ὅσον τό γε νῦν εἶναι διέχουσα οὐδέποτ' ἂν εἶχεν ὅσον νῦν ἀπολαύειν. Νῦν δ' ἀμφοῖν ἐν τῷ μέσῳ κειμένη, τριπλοῦν ἀνθ' ἁπλοῦ περιβέβληται τὸν λιμένα, τῶν παρ' ἑκάτερα κειμένων ὥσπερ μεταδιδόντων καὶ τῇ μεταξὺ ἑαυτῶν θαλάσσῃ τῆς οἰκείας φύσεως καὶ τὸ σύμπαν αὐτῆς ἕνα τινὰ καὶ συνεχῆ διὰ παντὸς ἑαυτοῦ λιμένα δεικνύντων. Ἐξ οὗ τί γίνεται; Πᾶσι μὲν συμμίγνυμεν ἔθνεσι, πᾶσι δὲ συμβάλλομεν γένεσιν, ἄστεά τε καὶ νόον ἀνθρώπων οὐκ ἔστιν ὧν τινων οὐ γινώσκοντες, τὰ μὲν οἷς αὐτοὶ ναυσὶν ἡμεδαπαῖς πανταχῇ διαβαίνομεν, τὰ δ' οἷς ἐπήλυδες ἁπανταχόθεν καταίρουσιν, σοφώτεροί τε καὶ αὐτῶν καὶ βελτίους γινόμεθα, τὰ κάλλιστα πανταχόθεν συλλέγοντες καὶ τὸ χρήσιμον ἐκλεγόμενοι καὶ πᾶν εἶδος ἐμπορευόμενοι γνώσεως.

prevailing season—would freely meet their need, or indeed both together would receive their vessels whenever one alone could not contain or suffice for so vast a naval multitude: an advantage they would have been far from enjoying had the city been set upon only one of the two harbors. For she would then have been deprived of this roadstead where seagoing ships now moor most of the time, and, being twice as far removed from the other harbor as she is at present, she could never have enjoyed the use of it to the extent she does now. As it is, lying midway between both, she has encompassed herself with a triple harbor instead of a single one, since the harbors on either flank impart, as it were, their own nature to the sea between them as well, turning its entire stretch into one unbroken harbor throughout. And what comes of this? We mingle with all nations and deal with all races, there being none among men whose cities and mind we do not come to know—partly as we ourselves cross everywhere in our own ships, partly as strangers put into port here from every quarter; and we grow both wiser and better even than they, gathering the finest things from every side, selecting what is useful, and trafficking in every form of knowledge.

Καίτοι τινὸς ἤκουσα λέγοντος ὡς πλεῖστον ἀπέχειν αἰγιαλῶν καὶ θαλάττης μέρος εὐδαιμονίας εἶναι ταῖς πόλεσι καὶ πρὸς ἀρετὴν ἔχειν αὐταῖς συμβαλέσθαι ὡς ἂν ναυτικῆς ἀναρχίας καὶ ἀπειροκαλίας ἀπηλλαγμέναις καὶ τῶν παρεπομένων θορύβων καὶ ταραχῆς καὶ συγχύσεως καὶ τῆς δεινῆς ἀμαθίας. Ἐγὼ δ' εἰ μὲν ἢ τοὺς ναυτικοὺς μόνους ἢ πάντας ἑώρων ταῦτα νοσοῦντας ἢ τὴν πολυπειρίαν ἄλλως συλλεγομένην ἀνθρώποις καὶ τὸ εἰδέναι τήν τ' ἀρετὴν οὐκ ἂν προσγενομένην οὐδ' ὁτῳοῦν, ἂν μὴ πολλὴν πρότερον ἀλογίαν ἐπιτηδεύσῃ καὶ ἀμιξίαν, μηδενὶ μήτε συμβάλλων μήτε διομιλούμενος, σφόδρ' ἂν ἐδεδίειν τὸν λόγον καὶ τὴν θάλατταν ἂν ἐδυσχέραινον καὶ τὰ κύματα· εἰ δὲ πόλιν μὲν εὖ ἔχειν καὶ διὰ παντὸς ἥκειν ἐπαινουμένου μὴ ὡς πλείστοις συμβάλλουσαν, οὐδεὶς ἂν συμφήσαι, τῶν δ' ἐμπορευομένων οἱ πλεῖστοι κακοί, κἂν ναυτικοὺς εἴποις κἂν ἠπειρώτας, ἔστι δέ γ' ἐς ἀγαθὸν καὶ θαλαττίων ἀπώνασθαι· οὐδὲν γὰρ ἀπώμοτον, τό τε πολλὰ μαθεῖν ἐκ τοῦ πολλὰ παθεῖν περιγίνεται καὶ τὸ ἰδεῖν τῷ εἰδέναι συμβάλλεται, ἀρετῆς τε κυρίως οὐκ ἄν τις ἐφίκοιτο οὐδ' ἂν ἐπαινοῖτο κατ' αὐτὴν καὶ θαυμάζοιτο πρὸς

And yet I have heard someone say that to lie as far as possible from beaches and the sea is part of good fortune for cities and can contribute toward their virtue, inasmuch as they are rid of naval lawlessness and vulgarity and of the attendant clamor, tumult, confusion, and grievous ignorance. For my part, if I saw either that seafarers alone or all of them suffered from these vices, or that wide experience was gathered by men in some other way, and that knowledge and virtue could accrue to no one at all unless he first cultivated extreme heedlessness and isolation, neither dealing nor conversing with any man, I should greatly fear that argument and feel disgust at the sea and its waves; whereas if, on the contrary, no one would agree that a city fares well and attains every praiseworthy quality without holding intercourse with as many people as possible; if most traders are knaves, whether you speak of seafarers or of landsmen; if nevertheless one may derive good profit even from things of the sea—for nothing is to be forsworn—, and learning much comes from experiencing much, just as seeing contributes to knowing; and if no one could genuinely attain virtue or

ἀξίαν, μὴ πολλῶν ὄντων τῶν ἀντικρουόντων περιγινόμενος καὶ κατορθῶν ἐν πολλοῖς σφάλλουσι, καίτοι καὶ τὸ εἰδέναι μόνον αὐτὸ καὶ γινώσκειν οὐκ οἶδ' εἴ τις τοῦ κρατίστου μέρους ἐξέλοι τῆς ἀρετῆς, τί δεῖ τῶν ἀναχωρήσεων καὶ προφάσεων τούτων ἢ πῶς ἀξίως δυσχερανοῦσιν ἃ μὴ χρεὼν καὶ ψέξουσι θάλατταν, καὶ κοῦφον ἂν νομιοῦσιν εἴ τις αὐτῆς στέρηται, δέον, ἐγκαλυπτομένους οἷς τούτῳ τῷ μέρει τῶν ἄλλων λείπονται, τοῦτο μὲν σιγῇ παρελθεῖν, ἑτέρωθεν δὲ τὸν ἔπαινον ἐρανίζεσθαι καὶ συμπληροῦν τὸ ἐγκώμιον;

be praised for it and admired according to his worth unless, amid many opposing forces, he overcomes them and stands upright among many who stumble—though indeed I know not whether anyone would exclude mere knowing and understanding itself from the noblest part of virtue—what need is there of these evasions and pretexts? Or with what justice will men spurn what they ought not, disparage the sea, and account it a slight matter if a city is deprived of it, when instead they ought, veiling their faces in shame over falling short of others in this respect, to pass this topic over in silence and collect their praise from other quarters to fill out their encomium?

§ 16. [σ. 19–21] Τίς γὰρ καὶ τούτων ἄνευ οὐκ οἶδεν ὅσοις ἀνάγκη τῶν ἐν μεσογείᾳ πλεονεκτεῖν τὰς ἐν θαλάττῃ κατῳκημένας εὐδαιμονίας τε εἵνεκα καὶ πλούτου καὶ ὠνίων ἀφθονίας καὶ τῆς ἄλλης ἐς τὸν βίον παρασκευῆς τε καὶ εὐθηνίας, προσέτι δὲ καὶ δυνάμεως καὶ τῆς κατὰ πόλεμόν τε καὶ μάχας ἀνδρείας καὶ ἐμπειρίας; Ταῖς μέν γε καὶ ἀμφοῖν ἔξεστιν ἀπολαύειν καὶ θαλαττίοις εἶναι κατ' ἐξουσίαν καὶ γῆν ἀσπάζεσθαι καὶ τὰ τῆς χέρσου καλὰ καὶ στρατιὰν ἀγείρειν καὶ ἐπιταφρεύεσθαι καὶ χαράκωμα βάλλεσθαι καὶ πηγνῦναι στρατόπεδον καὶ στόλον δεῆσαν συγκροτῆσαι πάντων μάλιστα ῥᾷστα καὶ ἀπὸ τοῦ καταστρώματος διαμάχεσθαι καὶ λαίφεσι καὶ κώπαις καὶ πνεύμασι πιστεύειν εἰσπλέοντας, ἐκπλέοντας, διαπλέοντας καὶ πάντοθεν ἰσχυροῖς εἶναι καὶ τῶν ἐχθρῶν περιγίνεσθαι. Αἱ δ' οὐδὲν μᾶλλον τῆς ἠπείρου μόνης καὶ τῶν ἐκεῖθεν καλῶν κορεννύμεναι θατέρῳ, τάχα δὲ δὴ τῷ πλείστῳ καὶ τῷ παντὶ τὸ ἔλαττον ἔχουσι, τῶν ἐκ θαλάττης καλῶν στερισκόμεναι, καίτοι, εἰ Πλάτων ἀμφοτεροδέξιον ἄνθρωπον ἐπαινεῖ καὶ θαυμάζει καὶ τυχόντα μὲν οὕτω τῆς φύσεως μακαρίζει, τοὺς δὲ μὴ τυχόντας προτρέπει πρὸς ἄσκησιν, ὡς τῷ παντί γε διαφέρον μιᾷ τε χειρὶ καὶ ἀμφοῖν ἔχειν κεχρῆσθαι, ἦπου τούς γε θαλάττης ὅλης εὐφυῶς ἔχοντας καὶ ἠπείρου ὅσον μιᾶς χειρὸς καὶ ἑνὸς μέλους σώματος τοσούτῳ μέρει τῆς οἰκουμένης μᾶλλον ἂν καὶ πρὸς πλείω τις χρήσαιτο, τοσοῦτον ἄρα καὶ μᾶλλον θαυμάσομεν καὶ ζηλώσομεν καὶ τῷ ὄντι νομιοῦμεν εὐδαίμονας, τοῦτο δὴ τὸ ἡμέτερον; Τίς γὰρ ἡμῶν ἢ πρὸς γῆν ἢ πρὸς θάλατταν εὐφυέστερον ἔχει, τίς δὲ καὶ τῶν παρ' ἀμφοῖν ἐξ ἴσης ἡμῖν ἀπολαύειν;

§ 16. [p. 19–21] For even apart from these considerations, who does not know in how many respects cities settled upon the sea must surpass those in the interior—in prosperity, wealth, abundance of merchandise, and all other provision and plenty for life, and furthermore in power and in courage and experience in war and battle? Maritime cities may enjoy both elements alike: at their pleasure they can take to the sea and yet embrace the land and the blessings of the continent; muster an army, dig entrenchments, throw up a palisade, and pitch a camp, and yet, when need arises, man and equip a fleet most easily of all, fight from the decks, trust to sails, oars, and winds—sailing in, sailing out, sailing across—and prove strong on every side and prevail over their enemies. Inland cities, on the other hand, while taking their fill no whit more of the mainland alone and the good things therefrom, come off worse in the other element—nay, perhaps in the greatest part, and altogether—being deprived of the blessings of the sea. And yet, if Plato praises and admires the ambidextrous man, counting happy one so endowed by nature and exhorting those not so endowed to train themselves, on the ground that it makes all the difference in the world whether one can use both hands or only one, surely those who are favorably situated with respect to the whole sea and the continent alike—inasmuch as one can make greater and more varied use of so vast a portion of the inhabited world than of a single hand and a single limb of the body—we shall by that same measure all the more admire and emulate and account truly happy: which is precisely our own condition! For who is more favorably situated than we are toward either land or sea,

Οἵ γε τοῦ Πόντου τὸ μεσαίτατον εἰληχότες καὶ τοσούτων ἐθνῶν καὶ χωρῶν Γαλατίᾳ μὲν καὶ Παμφυλίᾳ καὶ Κιλικίᾳ καὶ τοῖς Εὐφρατίοις ἀπόνως συμμίσγομεν ἔθνεσι, πλέοντές τε καὶ τὰ πλεῖστα πεζεύοντες κἀκεῖθεν κατ' ἐξουσίαν πόρρω τῶν ἑῴων τε καὶ μεσημβρινῶν ἐλαύνοντες πόλεων, διαβαίνομεν δὲ ῥᾷστά τε καὶ κουφότατα πρὸς τὴν ἀντιπέρας ἤπειρον καὶ ἀμφοτέραν τὴν Σαρματῶν γῆν καὶ Κολχίδα καὶ Ἀλβανίαν καὶ Ἰβηρίαν καὶ ἐκεῖθεν αὖθις τῶν ἀρκτῴων ἐς ὅσον ἔνι ἀπολαύομεν, οὐδὲ τῶν δυσμικῶν τῷ τοσούτῳ διαστήματι διειργόμενοι. Ταῖς ναυσὶ γὰρ τὸ τοσοῦτον μῆκος συστέλλεται, καὶ ῥᾷον καὶ τούτοις συμβάλλομεν, αὐτοί τε παρὰ τούτους ἰόντες καὶ τοὺς ἐκεῖθεν ὑποδεχόμενοι, ὥσθ', ὥσπερ τινὸς ἐργαστηρίου κοινοῦ ἢ ἐμπορίου τῆς οἰκουμένης ἁπάσης ἡμῖν οὔσης τῆς πόλεως, τούς τε ἁπανταχοῦ τῆς γῆς ἐνταῦθα ἂν ἴδοις πολιτευομένους τὸ πλεῖστον τοῦ χρόνου καὶ οὐ πολλὰ ἂν κάμοις τὰ γνωριμώτερα τῶν γενῶν καὶ γλωσσῶν ἐξετάζων. Ἀρκεῖ γὰρ ἐς τὴν τῇδε ἀγορὰν κατιόντα τῶν ἀγοραζόντων πυθέσθαι καὶ αὐτῶν τούτων περὶ ὧν ἂν δέοι μαθεῖν καὶ τῶν ἑκασταχοῦ γινομένων καὶ ὧν ἑκάστη φέρει καλῶν οὐκ οἶδ' εἴ που καλλίω ἢ πλείω ἔστιν εὑρεῖν. Μηδική τε γὰρ ἐσθὴς καὶ αἰγύπτιος καὶ τὰ Σηρῶν νήματα καὶ κανᾶ τῶν Σινῶν καὶ τὰ Κιλίκων ὑφάσματα οὐκ ἐλάττω παρ' ἡμῖν ἢ παρ' οὓς φύονται, καὶ ὅσα ἡ περὶ τὸν Φάσιν καὶ Τάναϊν φέρει καὶ τὴν ἐνταῦθα γῆν ἅπασαν πάντα ἂν εὕροις ἐνταῦθα καὶ ὅσα τῆς ἄλλης γῆς οὐδαμοῦ, ὥστε κἀν τούτοις ἑκάστην τε ἀνὰ μέρος νικᾶν καὶ πάσας ὁμοῦ τὸ μὲν οἷς τὰ πασῶν ἔχει κεκτημένα πλουσίως, ἑκάστης τοῖς οἰκείοις πλεονεκτούσας, τὸ δ' οἷς καὶ τὰ παρ' ἑαυτῆς προστίθησι δαψιλῶς καὶ τὰ ἑτέρωθεν ἐπεισάγουσα καὶ τὰ παρ' ἑαυτῆς πλεῖστα φύουσα. Ἑκάστης γοῦν τῆς ἡμέρας ὥσπερ ἐν ἑορτῇ τε καὶ πανηγύρει τοὺς μὲν ἴδοις ἂν ἐσιόντας, τοὺς δ' ἐξιόντας, καὶ οἱ μὲν προσίασιν, οἱ δὲ ἀπίασιν, οἱ μὲν ἐκ θαλάττης, οἱ δ' ἐξ ἠπείρου, πλέοντες καὶ πεζεύοντες, ὥστε τὴν μὲν τῇδε θάλατταν ὁλκάσιν ἀναγομέναις τε καὶ καταγομέναις ἀεὶ κατακαλύπτεσθαι καὶ σχεδὸν ναῦν μόνην ὁρᾶσθαι καὶ λαίφη κυρτούμενά τε καὶ κοιλαινόμενα, τὴν δ' ἤπειρον πλήθειν ἀνθρώπων καὶ φορτηγῶν ζῴων, ἐμπόρων ἄλλοθεν ἄλλων προσιόντων καὶ ἀπιόντων καὶ παντοδαπὰ φερόντων τε καὶ

and who is better placed to enjoy the gifts of both on equal terms with us?

Having obtained the very midpoint of the Pontus and of so many nations and lands, we mingle effortlessly with Galatia, Pamphylia, Cilicia, and the peoples along the Euphrates, both sailing and for the most part traveling overland, and pushing onward from there at will deep among the eastern and southern cities; we cross with the greatest ease and lightness to the opposite continent, to both lands of the Sarmatians, and to Colchis, Caucasian Albania, and Iberia, and from there in turn we enjoy the products of the northern regions to the utmost, while not even from those of the west are we cut off by so vast a distance. For ships contract that great expanse, and we deal readily with westerners too, both journeying to them ourselves and welcoming visitors from there; hence, since our city serves as it were as a common workshop or emporium of the entire inhabited world, you may see men from every corner of the earth residing here most of the time, and you would not have to labor much to survey the better-known races and tongues. Indeed, it suffices to go down into our marketplace and inquire of those doing business there—the very peoples themselves concerning whom one might wish to learn—while as for the products of every region and the fine things that each land brings forth, I know not whether one can anywhere find them finer or more plentiful. Median and Egyptian raiment, silken threads of the Seres, vessels of the Sinae [probably porcelain], and textiles of the Cilicians are no less abundant among us than among the peoples where they are produced; and whatever the country around the Phasis and the Tanais and all the surrounding land brings forth, you will find it all here, together with things found nowhere else on earth. Thus in these respects too our city surpasses each land singly and all of them together: partly because she possesses in rich abundance the treasures of them all, whereas the others excel only in what is native to each, and partly because she adds lavishly of her own store as well, both importing goods from elsewhere and bringing forth most plentifully those of her own soil. Every single day, therefore, as though at a festival and great fair, you may see some entering and others departing; some approach and others leave, some from the sea and others from the mainland, sailing and traveling on foot, so that our sea is forever overspread

λαμβανόντων ὤνια πάντων, τῶν μὲν πρὸς χρείαν καὶ τὴν ἀναγκαίαν ἀνθρώποις ζωήν, τῶν δὲ πρὸς τρυφὴν καὶ διαγωγὴν καὶ ῥᾳστώνην καὶ ὅσα πόλεων εὐτυχίαν καὶ περιουσίαν εὐδαιμονίας κατηγορεῖ.

with merchantmen putting out and putting in—until almost nothing is to be seen save hull and canvas billowing and hollowing—while the mainland teems with men and pack-animals, as merchants come and go from every quarter, bringing and taking away wares of every kind from all the world: some for daily need and the necessities of human life, others for luxury, refined living, and ease, and all things that proclaim the good fortune of cities and an overflow of prosperity.

§ 17. [σ. 21–25] Ἀλλ’ οὕτω μὲν τῆς κατὰ γῆν τε καὶ θάλατταν εἴληχε θέσεως, καὶ οὕτως ἐν καλῷ καὶ τούτων ἀμφοῖν κεῖται καὶ δεξιῶς ἔχει πρὸς ἀμφοτέρας. Τῆς γε μὴν τῶν ὡρῶν ἁρμονίας καὶ κράσεως εἵνεκα καὶ ὡς ἐνταῦθα τῷ ὄντι κυρίως καὶ ἀληθῶς ἔξεστιν αὐτὰς διαιρεῖν ἑκάστη τε τούτων ἕκαστον μέρος ἀπονέμειν οἰκείως τοῦ χρόνου, τούτων μὲν οὖν οὐδεὶς ἐρίσας ἡμῖν ἀμφισβητήσιμον γοῦν ἑαυτῷ καταστήσει τὴν ἧτταν, οὐδ’ ἔστιν ἥτις τῶν πόλεων τὰ ἐντεῦθεν βραβεῖα ἀποίσεται, μᾶλλον δ’ οὐκ ἔστιν ἥτις οὐ παραχωρήσει τῇ ἡμετέρᾳ καὶ τοῖς δευτερείοις ἀγαπήσει καὶ στέρξει νικωμένη τῆς Τραπεζοῦντος, ὥσπερ ἄλλη νικήσασα. Μόνη γὰρ ἡ παρ’ ἡμῖν κατὰ φύσιν τε καὶ λόγον καὶ τὸ εἰκὸς ἢ κομιδῇ σὺν ὀλίγαις ἡμέρων ἔτυχε τῶν ὡρῶν καὶ συμμέτρου τῆς ἐνεργείας ἑκάστων καὶ ὄντως ὡραίων καὶ αὐτὸ τοῦτο ὃ κέκληνται. Καὶ μαρτυρήσουσιν ἄνδρες ἀστρονόμοι καὶ οἱ παιδεύοντες τὰ μετέωρα καὶ οὐράνια, ὀγδοήκοντα μὲν μοιρῶν τὸ σύμπαν τῆς καθ’ ἡμᾶς οἰκουμένης πλάτος καὶ ἀπὸ τῆς διακεκαυμένης μέχρι τῆς κατεψυγμένης ζώνης τιθέμενοι, ὑπὸ δὲ τεσσαρακοστὸν τρίτον παράλληλον τὴν Τραπεζοῦντα κεῖσθαι διδάσκοντες καὶ τὸ μέσον τοῦ καθόλου πλάτους μαρτυροῦντες ἐπέχειν.

§ 17. [p. 21–25] Such, then, is the situation she has obtained by land and by sea, so advantageously is she placed with respect to both, and so favorably is she disposed toward either. Yet as regards the harmony and temperate blending of the seasons—and how here in very truth one may properly and genuinely distinguish them and assign to each its fitting portion of the year—no one who contends with us on this score will render his defeat so much as open to dispute, nor is there any city that will carry off the prize herein; rather, there is none that will not yield place to ours and be content with second honors, rejoicing as much in being surpassed by Trebizond as another city would in having won the victory. For our city alone—or at most in company with very few—has in accordance with nature, reason, and due proportion been blessed with gentle seasons, with the well-measured operation of each, and with seasons truly seasonable and answering to the very name they bear. And astronomers and teachers of celestial and heavenly science will bear witness, reckoning the entire latitudinal breadth of our inhabited world, from the torrid zone to the frigid zone, at eighty degrees, while teaching that Trebizond lies beneath the forty-third parallel and testifying that she occupies the midpoint of the whole latitude.

Ὥστ’ ἴσον τοῦ σφοδροῦ καύματος καὶ ψύχους ἀπέχουσα οὔτε τοῦ χειμῶνος οὔτε τοῦ θέρους παρὰ τὴν ἐπωνυμίαν τετύχηκεν ἢ τῷ ψύχει πλέον τοῦ δέοντος ἢ τῷ καύματι χρωμένη μᾶλλον ἢ χρῆν, ὡς ἢ χειμῶνα τὸ θέρος ἢ θέρους ὥραν εἶναι τὴν τοῦ χειμῶνος αὐτῇ, ὃ τῶν πόλεων αἱ πολλαὶ πάσχουσι καὶ ὅσαι πρὸς βορρᾶν μᾶλλον ἢ πρὸς νότον τὴν οἴκησιν ἔλαχον, ὅπου τῷ μᾶλλον καὶ ἧττον τὰς ὥρας ἔξεστι διαιρεῖν καὶ τούτοις ἀμυδρῶς τε καὶ σκιωδῶς καταχρωμένους ταῖς κλήσεσιν, οὐ κυρίας τὰς ὀνομασίας προσφέροντας. Ταῖς μὲν γὰρ ὄμβροις ἀεὶ

Removed, therefore, at an equal distance from fierce heat and bitter cold, she experiences neither winter nor summer in a manner belying its name—subject neither to cold beyond due measure nor to heat more than is fitting, such that summer would be winter for her, or winter the summer season. Yet that is the very plight suffered by most cities, and above all by those allotted a dwelling too far toward the north or toward the south, where one can distinguish the seasons only by 'more' and 'less'—and even by these degrees only dimly and shadowily—misapplying their titles and not bestowing

καὶ χιόσι καὶ παγετῷ πηγνυμέναις οὐ τοῦ χειμῶνος μόνον ἀνάγκη ῥιγοῦν καὶ τρόπον δεσμίων ταῖς οἰκίαις ἐνεῖρχθαι τοὺς ἐν αὐτῇ, πεδητῶν βίον βιοῦντας καὶ ταῖς ἀγοραῖς ἢ οὐδ' ὀλίγα συμβάλλοντας ἢ μόνον φανέντας εὐθὺς ὡς εἰς χηραμοὺς φεύγοντας τὰς οἰκίας ἐνδεδυκέναι, ἀλλὰ καὶ μέσου τοῦ θέρους ζητεῖν ὃ περιβάλωνται καὶ ὅθεν ἂν ἀλέαν πορίσωνται καὶ τὸ ψῦχος ἀμύνωνται· ταῖς δ' αὖ ἐκ τοῦ ἐναντίου θέρμῃ καὶ καύματι καὶ ταῖς ἡλιακαῖς φλεγομέναις ἀκτῖσι θέρος εἶναι καὶ τὸν χειμῶνα καὶ μέσου Ποσειδεῶνος τηκομένους τοὺς ἐνοικοῦντας καὶ ζητοῦντας ὅθεν ἂν ἀναψύξωσιν. Ὥστε τοὺς ὁποτέραν αὐτῶν ἑκάστοτε ἐγκωμιάζοντας τὰ πλείω χαριζομένους ἢ ἀληθεύοντας ἐν τοῖς περὶ τούτων λόγοις ἔστιν εὑρεῖν οὐ σκοποῦντας ὅ τι ἂν ἀληθεύσαιεν, ἀλλ' ὅ τι χαρίσαιντο κἂν μὴ τύχοι τἀκριβὲς οὕτως ἔχον, μόνοις δ' ἡμῖν καὶ ὅσοι τὸν ὑπὲρ τῆς ἡμετέρας λόγον ποιοῦνται ταύτην οὐκ ἔστιν ἐπενεγκεῖν τὴν αἰτίαν, οὐδὲ γράψαιτ' ἄν τις ἡμᾶς ψεύδους οὐδὲ τούτῳ τῷ μέρει.

Χορείαν γὰρ ὑπὲρ ἡμᾶς αἱ ὧραι περιελίττουσιν ἐναρμόνιον, ἑκάστης τῇ γείτονι μεταδιδούσης καὶ μεταλαμβανούσης τῶν παρ' ἀλλήλων, ὡς τόν τε χειμῶνα μετέχειν ἀλέας καὶ τὴν θέρειον ὥραν συμμέτρως ψυχραίνεσθαι, κιρναμένων ἀλλήλοις τοῦ ψύχους τε καὶ τοῦ καύματος παρ' ἑκατέρας τὰς ὥρας καὶ τὴν καλλίστην οὕτως ἁρμονίαν ἀποτελούντων, ὡς αὐτάς τε ταύτας καὶ τὰς μεταξὺ τούτων ὥρας τά τε οἰκεῖα τηρεῖν ἀσυγχύτως καὶ τὰ παρ' ἀλλήλων φιλοφρόνως εἰσδέχεσθαι, οὔτε πλεονεκτούσας ἀλλήλαις, οὔτε τοῦτο πασχούσας, ἐπίσης τε τὴν παντελῆ ἀμιξίαν ἀλλήλων καὶ τὴν παντάπασιν ἕνωσίν τε καὶ μίξιν ἀποστρεφομένας καὶ σύγχυσιν, ἐξ ὧν ὑγιεινοῖς μὲν εἶναι καὶ καλῶς κεκραμένοις τὰ σώματα περιγίνεται, αὐτῇ δὲ τῇ γῇ πρός τε καρπῶν ἀφθόνους εὖ μάλα παρεσκευάσθαι γονὰς καὶ πρὸς τὰς τῶν ὡραίων προβολὰς εὖ ἔχειν, νικώντων κἀνταῦθα μάλιστα καὶ παρὰ τὴν ἐπωνυμίαν εἴπερ που τῆς γῆς. Ἀκρόδρυα γὰρ πάντα καὶ βάλανος ἅπας καὶ ὀπωρῶν ποικιλία, καὶ κάλλει καὶ πλήθει διαφερουσῶν, οὔτε πλείω οὔτε καλλίω παρ' ἄλλοις· λέγω δὲ οὐχ ὡς εἰπεῖν πλεῖστα, οὐδ' εἵνεκα λόγου, ἀλλ' ὄντως πλεῖστα καὶ ἀριθμὸν ὑπερβάλλοντα. Οὕτω

the names in their proper sense. For in cities perpetually congealed by rains, snows, and frost, the inhabitants are compelled not in winter alone to shiver and be penned inside their houses like prisoners—living the life of fettered captives, either scarcely setting foot in the marketplaces at all or, having barely shown themselves, fleeing straightway as if into burrows and plunging back indoors—but even in the height of summer to seek wraps to put around themselves and means whereby to procure warmth and ward off the chill; whereas in cities on the opposite extreme, scorched by warmth, sultry heat, and the sun's rays, even winter is summer, and in the middle of Poseideon [midwinter] the inhabitants melt with heat and cast about for some means to cool themselves. Hence one may find that those who from time to time compose encomia of either class of cities flatter more than they speak the truth in what they say on this theme, looking not to what they might state truthfully, but to what favor they might curry, even should the strict facts be otherwise; whereas against us alone, and all who deliver praise in behalf of our city, this charge cannot be brought, nor could anyone indict us for falsehood in this part of our discourse either.

For above us the seasons weave a harmonious choral dance, each imparting to her neighbor and receiving in turn what belongs to one another, so that winter shares in genial warmth and the summer season is temperately cooled. Cold and heat blend with one another across both seasons and thus bring about the fairest harmony, whereby both these extremes and the seasons between them preserve their own proper character without confusion while kindly welcoming one another's gifts—neither encroaching upon one another nor suffering encroachment, and shunning alike total isolation from each other and complete fusion, mixture, and confusion. From this it results that the inhabitants are healthy and well-tempered in body, while the earth itself is excellently prepared for abundant yields of crops and well suited for putting forth the fruits of the season—fruits that here above all, if anywhere on earth, prevail even beyond the promise of their name. For all tree-fruits, every sort of chestnut and nut, and a rich variety of orchard fruits, excelling alike in beauty and in abundance, are neither more plentiful nor finer among any other people; and I say 'most plentiful' not as a manner of speaking or for rhetorical effect, but in very

κατάκαρπος ἡμῖν ἡ χώρα καὶ πλήρης ἀρίστου παντός, καὶ οὐδ' ἔστιν εὑρεῖν αὐτῆς ὃ μὴ ἕν τι τῶν πάντων προάγει, μηδὲ χορηγεῖ τὴν ἀναγκαίαν συντέλειαν.

truth most plentiful and surpassing all number. So fruit-laden is our countryside and so full of every excellence; indeed, no part of it can be found that does not bring forth some one of all good things and furnish its needful contribution.

Οὔτε γὰρ διὰ πάσης ἑαυτῆς ἀνέστηκεν, ἀποκορυφουμένη καὶ ὑψουμένη πρὸς ὄρη, οὔτ' αὖ ὅλη δι' ὅλης ἐξήπλωται εἰς πεδιάδας, ὡς τοῖσδε μὲν ἐξαρκεῖν, ἔστι δ' ὧν καὶ ἀπᾴδειν, μιᾶς φύσεως γῆς οὐκ ἐχούσης ἐπιτηδείως διακεῖσθαι πρὸς πάντα, ἀλλ' ὁμοίως εἰς ὄρη μεριζομένης καὶ πεδιάδας, τὰ πλεῖστα μὲν τὰ αὐτὰ γεννῶσί τε καὶ προφέρουσι καὶ τοῖς αὐτοῖς ἡμᾶς δεξιοῦνται, ὅσα δὲ ἡ ἑτέρα φέρειν οὐκ ἔχει, ταῦτα θάτερον ἐπιδαψιλεύεται μέρος, παρέχον πλουσίως ὧν ἄλλοθεν ἀπολαύειν οὐκ ἔνι. Τὰ μὲν γὰρ τὸν πάντων καρπῶν ἡμερώτατον φύει, καὶ τοῦτον τῶν ἁπανταχοῦ κάλλιστον. Οὕτως ἐριβῶλαξ ἡμῖν ἡ γῆ καὶ πίειρα, ὥστε, πολλοῦ πάντοθεν ἐπεισαγομένου σίτου διαποντίου τε καὶ χερσαίου, ἅτε πληθούσης τε ἀνθρώπων τῆς ἡμετέρας καὶ πολλῆς ἐπεισάκτου δεομένης τροφῆς, οὐδεὶς τῶν ἁπανταχοῦ τῷ παρ' ἡμῖν οὐδ' ἐγγὺς ἂν ἥκοι ποτέ. Τὰ δ' ἄλσεσιν ἀνεῖται καὶ δένδρεσι, τοῖς μὲν καρποφόροις, τοῖς δ' ἄλλην οὐκ ἐλάττω συντέλειαν χορηγοῦσιν ἡμῖν οἷς ὑλοτομεῖν τε καὶ δρυτομεῖν τοῖς ἐνταῦθα παρέχουσιν, ἐξ ὧν νεώς τε ἱδρύομεν καὶ συσκευάζομεν οἴκους, ἐς δύο καὶ τρεῖς ὀρόφους ἀνάγοντες καὶ κάλλους οὐδὲν ἀπολείποντες, καὶ πήγνυμεν ναῦς μακράς τε καὶ φορτηγούς, ἔς τε πόλεμον καὶ εἰρήνην ὁμοίως τὰ μέγιστά τε καὶ ἀναγκαιότατα συντελούσας, ὥστε καὶ δι' ὁμαλῆς ἔξεστι τῆς ὁδοῦ καὶ ψιλῆς διέναι, τὸν προκείμενον δρόμον ἀνύοντας, καὶ ὑπὸ σκιαῖς καὶ δένδροις ἀνάπαυλαν ἴσχειν καὶ καταψύχεσθαι, τὴν ἐκ τοῦ καύματος θεραπεύοντας φλόγα τοῖς τ' ἀνέχουσι τῶν ὀρῶν καὶ τοῖς παρ' αὐτῶν πνεύμασι τὴν ἐκ τῶν πεδίων ἀποκρουομένους ἀλέαν καὶ ἀποψύχοντας τὸν ἐντεῦθεν ἱδρῶτα.

For our land neither rises up throughout its whole extent, towering into peaks and soaring into mountains, nor again is it spread out from end to end into flat plains, so as to suffice for certain products while proving unsuited to others—since a single kind of soil cannot be aptly disposed for everything; rather, being apportioned alike into mountains and plains, for the most part both bring forth and proffer the same crops and regale us with the same gifts, while whatever the one nature cannot bear, the other portion lavishes upon us, richly supplying what cannot be enjoyed from the first. Thus the lowlands bring forth the most civilized of all crops [wheat], and the finest to be found anywhere: so deep-soiled and rich is our earth that, although much grain is imported from every quarter by sea and by land—inasmuch as our city teems with people and requires abundant imported provisions—no grain from anywhere in the world could ever come even close to our own. The uplands, meanwhile, are given over to groves and trees—some fruit-bearing, others furnishing us another no less valuable service by affording our people timber and oak to fell, out of which we erect temples, build houses two and three stories high lacking nothing in beauty, and frame both warships and merchantmen that render the greatest and most indispensable services in war and peace alike. Thus travelers may both journey along level, open roads as they accomplish their appointed course and take rest and cool themselves beneath shady trees, relieving the fiery blaze of the heat, while by the jutting heights of the mountains and the breezes blowing down from them they ward off the warmth rising from the plains and cool the sweat it brings.

Οὐ γὰρ δὴ τὸ μὲν τῆς χώρας πεδιὰς μόνον καὶ ὅλον ὕπτιον, τὸ δ' ἀνέστηκεν εἰς ὄρη τε καὶ βουνούς, ὡς ἑκάτερον ἑκατέρου κεχωρίσθαι παντάπασιν, ἀλλ' ἔστι μὲν εὑρεῖν ἐνταῦθα καὶ τοῦτο, ἔστι δὲ καὶ πεδία μετὰ γηλόφων ἰδεῖν καὶ βουνῶν οὐ μάλα τοι μετεώρων ἐντυχεῖν τε καὶ ὄρεσι λιβάδας ἐφ' ἑαυτῶν καὶ πεδία προτεινομένοις οὐ μάλα στενά, οὐδὲ σμικροῖς ὅροις

Nor indeed is one part of the country sheer plain and wholly flat while the other rises abruptly into mountains and hills, so that the two are altogether severed from each other; rather, while one can find that arrangement here as well, one may also behold plains interspersed with knolls and hills of no great height, and likewise come upon mountains that stretch forth watered

περιγραφόμενα, ὡς πανταχοῦ τὸ ἴσον τηρεῖσθαι καὶ μέτριον ἀμφοῖν ὁμοίως, ἀνὰ μέρος τὴν ἡμετέραν κοσμούντων, ὡς μήτ' ἔνθα χρῆν ἐκτετάσθαι τὸν χῶρον εἰς πεδιάδας ἀποκεκορυφῶσθαι πρὸς ὄρη, μηδ' ὅπου τῶν ὀρῶν ἔδει τὰ πεδία παρεμπεσεῖν, ἀλλὰ τὸν προσήκοντα τηρεῖν ἑκάτερα τόπον καὶ ὃς ἑαυτοῖς τε καὶ τοῖς ἐνταῦθα κατῳκημένοις ἔμελλε συνοίσειν. Πεδία γὰρ ἐκδέχονται ὄρη καὶ βουνοὺς τὰ πεδία καὶ συμφυὲς ἓν οἷον διὰ παντὸς ἑαυτοῦ καὶ πεδίοις τισὶ σύμμικτον ὄρος ἀποκαθίσταται μέχρις ἂν εἰς τὸν Ἀντίταυρον ἥκοι, τὸν ὀρῶν ἄριστον ἡμῖν τε σωτήριον, ὅς, ἀπὸ τοῦ Ταύρου ὄρους μέχρις Εὐφράτου καὶ τῶν Καυκασίων διήκων ὀρέων, μεγέθει τε μέγιστος καὶ μήκει μήκιστος πεφυκώς, τὴν ἡμετέραν τῆς Ἀρμενίας ὁρίζει γῆς καὶ Κιλίκων καὶ ἧς νῦν ἄρχουσι βάρβαροι πάσης. Ἔδει γὰρ δὴ τοὺς τοσούτῳ φωνῆς τε καὶ γλώττης καὶ τῶν ἑλληνικῶν ἠλλοτριωμένους ἠθῶν μὴ ποταμοῖς τισιν εὖ μάλα διαβατοῖς, κἂν Ἰνδὸς κἂν Γάγγης ὢν τύχοι, καὶ φάραγξιν ἀποτόμοις, οὐδ' αὐτοῖς ἀπεράτοις, καὶ οὐκ οἶδ' οἷς τισι λήροις ἑτέροις, ἀλλ' οὕτως ἐλλογίμοις ἡμῶν καὶ μεγίστοις ὅροις διείργεσθαι, πόρρωθεν καὶ τοῖς ἀγνοοῦσι παρεχομένοις τεκμήρασθαι ὅσον ἡμῶν τε κἀκείνων τὸ μέσον καὶ ὡς πλεῖστον ἀλλήλων διέστημεν παιδείᾳ τε καὶ τοῖς κατὰ φρόνησιν ἀγαθοῖς καὶ ἃ κοσμεῖ μόνα τὸν ἄνθρωπον.

Πρὸς γὰρ δὴ τῷ τοσοῦτον ἡμῶν τε κἀκείνων μεταξὺ κεῖσθαι ἔτι καὶ δεινῶς ἄβατον ἢ μάλιστα δύσβατον ἑαυτὸν παρεχόμενος ἀποτόμους τε καὶ κρημνώδεις ἔχει καὶ μάλα στενὰς τὰς εἰσόδους τε καὶ διόδους καὶ οὐ πάνυ τοι περασίμους, καὶ ταύτας οὐ δύο καὶ τρεῖς οὐδὲ τέτταρας, οὐδ' ἑκάστην ὀλιγομήκη καὶ βραχὺ τὸ φαραγγῶδες καὶ ἀπότομον ἔχουσαν, ἀλλ' ἐς μὲν ὅσον ἐνῆν πλεῖστον ῥαγάσι τε καὶ κρημνοῖς καὶ στενοπόροις μηκυνομένην ὁδοῖς, ἐς ἀριθμὸν δὲ τὰς πάσας ἀποπερατουμένας ἱκανὸν καὶ ὑπὲρ ὃν οὐκ ἐχρῆν ἐκτετάσθαι. Οὐ γὰρ κατὰ τὰς ἐν Ἑλλάδι Πύλας ἡμῖν ὁ Ἀντίταυρος τὰς εἰσόδους παρέχεται, ἑνί τινι τόπῳ μόνον ὠχυρωμένας καὶ τούτῳ δ' ἐλλιπῶς· δι' ἑτέρας γάρ ἐστιν ἀκινδύνως ἄνωθεν εἰσιέναι, καὶ μὲν δὴ καὶ εἰσίασι Πέρσαι καὶ ὁ μετὰ Ξέρξου στρατός, καὶ Λεωνίδην καὶ τοὺς τριακοσίους μετὰ τῶν σὺν αὐτοῖς συνεπάτησαν, οὐδὲν πλέον τοῦ καλῶς ἀποθανεῖν ἐπιδείξασθαι

meadows and plateaus upon their uplands, neither very narrow nor circumscribed by scanty bounds. Everywhere, therefore, equality and due proportion are preserved in both alike as they adorn our land by turns: neither does the ground tower up into mountains where it ought to have spread out into plains, nor have plains intruded where mountains were needed, but each keeps its fitting place—the very place destined to benefit both the features themselves and those who dwell here. For mountains succeed plains and plains succeed hills, until there arises, as it were, a single continuous highland mass interwoven throughout with plains, reaching all the way to the Anti-Taurus—the noblest of mountains and our savior—which, stretching from Mount Taurus as far as the Euphrates and the Caucasian Mountains, greatest in bulk and longest in sweep, parts our territory from the land of Armenia, from that of the Cilicians, and from all the territory that barbarians now rule. For surely men so deeply alienated from Greek speech, tongue, and customs had to be sundered from us not by rivers easy enough to cross—even were it an Indus or a Ganges—nor by sheer ravines, themselves far from impassable, and I know not what other such trifles, but by boundaries thus renowned and mighty, enabling even strangers from afar to judge how vast is the gulf between us and them, and how widely we stand apart from one another in culture, in the excellences of wisdom, and in those qualities that alone adorn mankind.

For besides standing as so great a barrier between us and them, by rendering itself dreadfully untrodden—or at least exceedingly hard to tread—it possesses entrances and thoroughfares that are sheer, precipitous, narrowly confined, and scarcely passable at all; and these are not merely two or three or four, nor is each of brief length with only a short stretch of ravine and cliff, but each is drawn out to the utmost amid clefts, crags, and narrow defiles, while in number, all told, they are bounded at a sufficient count and extend no further than they should. For the Anti-Taurus does not furnish us passes like the Gates in Hellas [Thermopylae], fortified at one single spot alone, and imperfectly even there—for one may enter safely from above by another path, and indeed the Persians and the host with Xerxes did enter thereby and trampled down Leonidas and the Three Hundred together with those at their side, who were able to display nothing more than a noble death. Nor does it

δυνηθέντας. Οὐδὲ Θυρέαν μιμεῖται τὴν διαιρέτιν γῆς τῆς λακωνικῆς καὶ τῆς ἀργολικῆς μοίρας, ἣν διαβῆναι κοῦφον καὶ σμικροῦ πόνου καὶ μερίμνης ὀλίγης. Οὐδὲν δὲ πρὸς ταύτας ἥ τε δι' Ἄλπεων ἐξ Ἰταλίας ἐς τὴν Κελτῶν γῆν διάβασις καὶ Κιλίκιοι πύλαι, ἔς τε Συρίαν ἀπάγουσαι καὶ τὴν Αἴγυπτον, νικᾶσθαι δὲ τὰς ἁπανταχοῦ πάσας τῶν παρ' ἡμῖν πλήθει τε καὶ δεινότητι, ὡς μέγαν ὅρον τόδε τὸ ὄρος ἑστάναι τοῖς ἑκατέρωθεν ἑαυτοῦ οἵς τε πρὸς τοσοῦτον ἐκτέταται μέγεθος καὶ οἷς οὕτω δύσβατον παρέχεται ἑαυτόν, ὥστ' ἐπὶ μὲν ἀνακωχῆς καὶ εἰρήνης κατ' ἐμπορίαν ἀλλήλοις συμμίσγοντας ἔξεστιν ἀσφαλῶς διιέναι, οὐδὲν δεδιότας, ἐπὶ δὲ πολέμου καὶ μάχης, δεῆσαν ἐπελθεῖν στρατιάν, ἢ οὐδ' ἂν οὐδ' ὅλως εἰσέλθοι, εὐαριθμήτοις τισὶ τῶν εἰσόδων φυλαττομένων ἀνδράσιν, ἢ εἰσελθοῦσα κακῶς ἀπαλλάξει καὶ γνώσεται καθ' ἑαυτῆς ὁρμηθεῖσα καὶ τὸ ξίφος ὠθήσασα. Οὕτως ἡμῖν καὶ ὄρος καὶ τεῖχος καθέστηκεν ὁ Ἀντίταυρος καὶ τῆς ἐκεῖθεν ἡμᾶς γῆς διαιρῶν μέσος ἕστηκεν ἡμῖν ἀκλινὴς οἷόν τις διαλλακτὴς καὶ ταμίας καὶ διανομεὺς ἑκατέρας ἀρχῆς καὶ ἡγεμονίας, οὐκ ἐῶν οὐδέτερον μέρος ἐπιβουλεύειν θατέρῳ καὶ τῆς ἀλλήλων γῆς ἐπιβαίνειν ἀκόντων.

resemble Thyrea, the borderland dividing Laconian territory from the Argive district, which is easy to cross and costs slight toil and little concern. Nay, nothing in comparison with our passes are either the crossing through the Alps from Italy into the land of the Celts or the Cilician Gates leading down into Syria and Egypt; rather, all passes everywhere are surpassed by ours both in number and in ruggedness, so that this mountain stands as a mighty boundary for those on either side of it, both by stretching to so vast a bulk and by rendering itself so hard to traverse. Hence in times of truce and peace men mingling with one another for trade may pass through safely without fear; whereas in times of war and battle, should a hostile army seek to march against us, either it could not enter at all—when the passes are guarded by a mere handful of men—or, having entered, it will come to grief and learn that it has marched to its own ruin and thrust the sword against itself. Thus the Anti-Taurus stands for us at once as mountain and as rampart; sundering us from the land beyond, it stands steadfast between us like an arbiter, steward, and apportioner of either realm and dominion, permitting neither side to plot against the other or to set foot upon the other's soil against its will.

§ 18. [σ. 25–30] Ἐπὶ δὴ τῆς τοιαύτης μὲν γῆς, τοιαύτης δὲ χώρας, οὕτω δὲ κύκλῳ διειλημμένης ὄρεσι καὶ βουνοῖς καὶ πεδίοις καὶ τῇ πασῶν ἡμερωτάτῃ καὶ φιλανθρωποτάτῃ θαλάσσῃ τὴν οἴκησιν οἱ πατέρες λαχόντες ἡμῶν, τὸ ταύτης αὖ κάλλιστον καὶ ἀσφαλέστατον ἐκλεξάμενοι τείχεσι περιέλαβον. Γήλοφος γάρ τις οὐ μάλα μετέωρος ἐξανέχει τῆς γῆς, φάραγξί τισιν ἑκατέρωθεν ὠχυρωμένος βαθείαις καὶ τῆς ἄλλης διειργόμενος γῆς ὥσπερ τισὶ τάφροις καὶ πολλῷ τῷ μέσῳ τάφρων ἀμείνοσι. Διὰ δὲ τούτων καὶ ποταμοί τινες ἀέναοι πρὸς θάλατταν ἐκδιδοῦσι, χειμῶνος μὲν καὶ σφοδρότερον ῥέοντες ἑαυτῶν καὶ τὸ ῥεῦμα πληθύοντες, οὐδ' ἔαρος δ' ἀπολείποντες, οὐδὲ μέσου τοῦ θέρους αὐτοῦ, ὡς καὶ πολλὴν οὐ μόνον ἀσφάλειαν τοῖς ἐντὸς ἑαυτῶν χορηγεῖν, ἀλλὰ καὶ ψυχαγωγίαν ἱκανὴν καὶ χρείαν αὐτοῖς ἀποπληροῦν οὐκ εὐκαταφρόνητον. Ῥύμματά τε γὰρ καὶ καθάρματα πάντα δι' αὐτῶν ἔνεστιν ἀπόνως καὶ κούφως ποιεῖσθαι, δι' αὐτῆς ὡς εἰπεῖν τῆς ἑκάστου οἰκήματος θύρας διιόντος τοῦ ῥεύματος. Ὁ δὴ γήλοφος οὗτος, ἀπὸ θαλάττης ἀρξάμενος, ἠρέμα μὲν

§ 18. [p. 25–30] Having obtained their dwelling upon such a land and such a country, thus encompassed round about by mountains, hills, plains, and the gentlest and most benevolent of all seas, our fathers selected in turn the fairest and most secure spot within it and enclosed it with walls. For a certain hill, not overly lofty, rises up from the ground, fortified on either side by deep ravines and sundered from the rest of the land as if by trenches—indeed, far superior by a wide margin to any trenches. Through these ravines perennial streams also empty into the sea, flowing in winter even more vehemently than their wont and swelling their current, yet failing neither in spring nor even in the very height of summer, so that they furnish those dwelling between them not only with great security, but also with ample delight, while fulfilling a practical need by no means to be despised. For all washings and cleansings of refuse can be carried out through them effortlessly and with ease, since the stream passes, so to speak, right by the very door of every house. Beginning from the sea, this hill ascends gently and gradually up the slope and

καὶ κατὰ μικρὸν ἐπὶ τὸ ἄναντες ἄνεισι καὶ τιμᾷ τὸ μετέωρον, προϊὼν δ' εἰς ὕψος ἀποκαθίσταται σύμμετρον, ἑκατέρωθεν ὥσπερ τῆς παρ' ἑκάτερα φαραγγώδους μᾶλλον ἀποχωρῶν γῆς καὶ πρὸς ἑαυτὸν συσφιγγόμενος καὶ κρημνώδη μὲν τὰ παρ' ἑκάτερα ἑαυτοῦ λείπων καὶ ἀποκαθιστάς, ἑαυτὸν δ' ὥσπερ στρογγύλλων εἰς μετέωρόν τινα καὶ ἐπίπεδον χῶρον καὶ ὡς ἐνῆν ἄριστόν τε πρὸς οἴκησιν καὶ πρὸς τὰς τῶν ὡρῶν κράσεις εὐαρμοστότατον. Ἐπὶ δὴ τούτου τὴν πάλαι μὲν πόλιν, νυνὶ δὲ ἀκρόπολιν ᾤκησαν δομησάμενοι, τῇ σφῶν τε ἀρετῇ μᾶλλον ἢ τῇ θέσει τοῦ τόπου πεπιστευκότες καὶ τειχῶν ἐχυρότητι, καίτοι καὶ τείχη περιεβάλλοντο καρτερὰ πύργων τε εἵνεκα καὶ τῆς στεφάνης αὐτῶν καὶ ἐπάλξεων καὶ πάσης τῆς τῇδε παρασκευῆς, οὐδενὸς εἶχον τὰ δεύτερα. Ἐδύναντο μὲν γὰρ ἀντ' ἄλλου τινὸς ἐρύματος σφῶν αὐτῶν τὰ δόρατα προβαλέσθαι καὶ τείχεσι χρῆσθαι τοῖς ὅπλοις ὡς πάλαι ποτὲ Λάκωνες, ὡς δὲ μηδὲν αὐτοῖς πρὸς ἀσφάλειαν φέρον ἀπείη, μηδὲ τοῦτο γοῦν τὸ μέρος τῆς κατ' αὐτάρκειαν εὐδαιμονίας ἐλλίποιεν, καὶ τοῦτο καλῶς ποιοῦντες προσεπορίσαντο.

Ἐντεῦθεν Ἕλληνες ἄνθρωποι καὶ τὴν Ἑλλήνων φωνήν τε καὶ γλῶτταν προϊέμενοι καὶ τιμῶντες ἐλευθερίας τε καὶ ἰσονομίας ἀντιποιούμενοι μόνοι μέσον ᾤκουν βαρβάρων, κύκλῳ περικεχυμένων ἐς πλῆθος, καὶ τῆς Περσῶν ἀρχῆς τε καὶ δυναστείας, πολλὰ μὲν δυναμένων, πάντα δὲ καταδουλωσαμένων, πλείω δὲ περιεζωσμένων ἀρχήν τε καὶ ἐξουσίαν καὶ γῆς ὡς εἰπεῖν ἡγουμένων ἁπάσης. Ἄρτι γοῦν συνῳκισμένοι καὶ οἷα εἰκὸς τόν τε ἀριθμὸν ὄντες οὐ πάνυ πολλοὶ τήν τε ἰσχὺν ἀσθενεῖς, ὅμως εὐθὺς ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἔδειξαν Ἕλληνες ὄντες, γένος ἀδέσποτον καὶ ἀδούλωτον καὶ μόνον ἐλεύθερον τήν τε ψυχὴν τά τε σώματα, Σινωπεῖς τε καὶ Μιλησίους καὶ ἔτι πρότερον Ἀθηναίους τοὺς σφῶν πατέρας μιμούμενοι, τοὺς μὲν οἵας ἴσμεν ἀποκρίσεις ἐπιόντων αὐτοῖς τῶν βαρβάρων ἀποκεκριμένους ἔργα τε διὰ πάντων ἐπιδειξαμένους τίνος οὐκ ἄξια, τοὺς δ' ἐν μέσοις μὲν τοῖς βαρβάροις οἰκοῦντας, οὐδὲν δ' ἐπιστρεφομένους αὐτῶν, ἀλλ' ἐς ὅσον ἐξῆν ὑπὲρ ἐλευθερίας τοῖς τῆς οἰκουμένης δεσπόταις ἀνταίροντας καὶ μετέχοντας ἰσοπολιτείας αὐτοῖς, οὐδὲν οὐ τοῦ φρονήματος, οὐ τοῦ τῆς ψυχῆς ἐφεῖσαν ἐμβριθοῦς καὶ γενναίου, οὐδ' ἀνάξιον οὐδὲν τῶν προγόνων καὶ τῆς ἑλληνικῆς ἐπεδείξαντο δόξης, ἀλλ'

claims an elevated poise; as it advances, it settles at a well-proportioned height, drawing further back on both flanks, as it were, from the ravine-cleft ground on either side and gathering itself inward, leaving and rendering sheer the precipices on either hand while rounding itself off, so to speak, into an elevated and level plateau—the finest possible for habitation and most harmoniously suited to the tempering of the seasons. Upon this plateau they built and inhabited what was of old the city, and is now the acropolis, placing their trust rather in their own valor than in the site's natural position and the strength of walls—and yet they also girt themselves with stout walls, and in respect of towers, their crowning circuit, battlements, and every defensive provision of this kind, they took second place to none. For although they could have held forth their own spears in place of any other bulwark and used their arms as walls, as the Laconians did long ago, nevertheless, so that nothing conducive to security might be wanting to them, nor might they fall short in even this element of self-sufficient prosperity, they wisely provided themselves with this as well.

Hence, being Greek men who uttered and honored the speech and tongue of the Greeks and laid claim to freedom and equality before the law, they dwelt alone in the midst of barbarians who poured round about them in vast multitudes, and in the midst of the empire and dominion of the Persians—men of immense power who had enslaved everything, girt themselves with ever wider rule and authority, and held sway, so to speak, over the entire earth. Though newly settled together and, as was natural, neither very numerous in count nor strong in might, they nevertheless proved right from the outset that they were Greeks—a race masterless, unenslaved, and alone free in both soul and body. Imitating their forefathers, the Sinopeans and Milesians and, still earlier, the Athenians—the latter having given such answers as we know when the barbarians marched against them and having displayed throughout deeds worthy of all admiration, while the former dwelt in the very midst of the barbarians yet paid them no heed, standing up for freedom so far as lay in their power against the masters of the inhabited world and maintaining equal civic standing beside them—they slackened nothing either of their high spirit or of the steadfastness and nobility of their soul, nor did they

ὥσπερ οὐ γῆς μᾶλλον ἢ τῆς ἐκείνων ἐκπεμφθέντες ἀρετῆς κληρονόμοι πρὸς αὐτούς τε διεπράττοντο πᾶν ἀναφέροντες κἀκείνοις καὶ τύπον ποιούμενοι καὶ παράδειγμα, διεγίγνοντο φύσει τοῖς βαρβάροις ὄντες πολέμιοι καὶ ἀσύμβατοι καὶ μεγίστοις αὐτῶν ὅροις φωνῇ τε καὶ ψυχῇ διιστάμενοι καὶ κοινὸν οὐδὲν αὐτοῖς ἔχοντες. Πολέμου τε γοῦν νόμῳ κατ' αὐτῶν ἐπιόντες ἰσχυρῶς ἀπεκρούοντο, λόγοις τε φιλανθρώποις παράγειν καὶ ὑποσχέσεσι τὴν αὐτῶν ὑφελέσθαι πειρωμένους ἐλευθερίαν οὐ παρεδέχοντο, ἀλλ' ἐς ὅσον πλεῖστον ἐνῆν διετέλεσαν καὶ ψυχὰς καὶ τὰ σώματα τηροῦντες ἐλεύθερα. Καίτοι τοσάκις εἰκὸς ἦν αὐτοὺς προσβαλεῖν καὶ μετὰ πάσης ἐπιέναι στρατείας τὰ κύκλῳ πάντα καταδουλωσαμένους ἀνθρώπους καὶ καταστησαμένους ὑποχείρια σφίσι, μόνην δὲ μίαν ταυτηνὶ πόλιν ὁρῶντας ἀφηνιάζουσαν καὶ νόμοις καὶ τρόποις καὶ ἤθεσι διαφέρουσι κεχρημένην καὶ ἀλλοτρίαν οὐ φωνὴν μόνον προϊεμένην, ἀλλὰ καὶ δεσποτείαν ἐπικεκλημένην ἑτέραν καὶ τελοῦσαν εἰς Ἕλληνας.

display anything unworthy of their ancestors and of Greek glory. Rather, as though sent forth to inherit their forefathers' virtue more than mere land, they accomplished every deed by referring it back to them, taking them too as model and pattern, and continued to be by nature hostile and irreconcilable toward the barbarians, sundered from them by the greatest boundaries in both speech and soul and having nothing in common with them. Accordingly, when the barbarians marched against them by the law of war, they were vigorously repulsed; and when they attempted to beguile them with kindly words and filch away their freedom by promises, our fathers did not admit them, but for the longest time possible continued to keep both their souls and their bodies free. And yet how often was it likely that men who had enslaved all the surrounding peoples and brought them under their sway would assault them and advance with all their host, seeing this one city alone spurning the yoke, observing different laws, ways, and customs, and not only uttering an alien tongue, but also invoking another sovereignty and reckoning itself among the Greeks!

Ὧν οὐκ εἰ μὴ πασῶν περιγεγενημένη διατετέλεκε δεινὸν ἡγεῖσθαι δεῖ καὶ ἐπίψογον, δειλίας καὶ ἀνανδρίας ποιουμένους τεκμήριον, ἀλλ' ὅτι τῶν πλείστων ἐκράτησε καὶ τοσοῦτον ἀντέσχε, μόνη πρὸς τοσούτους καὶ τηλικούτους ἀνταίρουσα, καὶ θαυμασόμεθα καὶ ζηλώσομεν καὶ τὴν αἰτίαν ἀνοίσομεν εἰς τὴν κατὰ ψυχὴν τῶν ἐνοικούντων ἀνδρείαν καὶ γενναιότητα καὶ τὸ τοῦ φρονήματος ἀκλινὲς καὶ ἀήττητον, ὧν οὕτως ὡς πλεῖστον αὐτοῖς περιῆν ὡς πλείσταις ἀνδρῶν γενεαῖς καὶ χρόνῳ κρείττονι μνήμης ἐν ἐλευθερίᾳ διαρκέσαι τῇ ὄντως καὶ πάντων τῶν κύκλῳ περικεχυμένων ἐχθρῶν, πλειόνων τε καὶ ἐλαττόνων, μειόνων τε καὶ μειζόνων, καὶ τῶν ἐκεῖθεν ἐγειρομένων πολέμων οὕτως ὑπερορᾶν καὶ ἐν οὐδενὶ τίθεσθαι καὶ πολλῷ περιγενέσθαι τῷ κρείττονι, ὡς μὴ τὰ καθ' αὑτοὺς μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὰ πρὸς ἑτέρους κατ' ἐξουσίαν ὡς ἐβούλοντο διοικεῖν, τῶν ἐθνῶν καὶ γενῶν, οἷς ἂν ἑκάστοτε τὸ παραστὰν τῆς χρείας καλέσειε, συμμαχοῦντες, κἂν προσκρούειν τισὶν ἔμελλον, καὶ τούτοις αὐτοῖς τοῖς δυνατωτάτοις ἀνθρώπων οὐδὲν ἐπιστρεφόμενοι οὐδὲ πολύν τινα ποιούμενοι λόγον. Τοὺς γοῦν μετὰ Κλεάρχου μυρίους Κύρῳ τῷ νέῳ κατ' Ἀρταξέρξου τοῦ τῆς Παρυσάτιδος συμμαχοῦντας καὶ

And if she did not continue to prevail over every single one of these assaults, one ought not to deem this terrible or blameworthy, making it a proof of cowardice and unmanliness; rather, because she overcame most of them and held out for so long, standing alone against enemies so numerous and so mighty, we shall both marvel at her and emulate her, and ascribe the cause to the spiritual courage and nobility of her inhabitants and to their unswerving and unconquerable spirit. In these qualities they abounded to the very highest degree, so that for the greatest number of generations of men and for a span of time surpassing memory they endured in true freedom; and they so disdained and set at naught all the enemies poured round about them—more numerous and fewer, lesser and greater alike—and the wars stirred up from that quarter, prevailing over them by a wide margin of superiority, that they regulated freely as they wished not only their domestic affairs, but also their relations with others, allying themselves among the nations and peoples with whomever the exigency of each occasion called upon them to aid, even if they were bound to offend some, paying no heed even to those mightiest of men themselves nor making much account of them. Consider, for instance, the Ten Thousand with

τὴν Περσῶν ἀρχήν τε καὶ βασιλείαν αὐτῷ συγκατακτωμένους, ἐπείπερ αὐτῷ μὲν δυστυχὲς τὸ τοῦ πολέμου τέλος ἀπήντησεν, οὔτε τῆς ἀρχῆς ἐπιλαβομένῳ καὶ προσαπολωλεκότι τὸ ζῆν, οἵδ' ἐν τῷ καθ' αὑτοὺς μέρει καὶ ᾗπερ ἐτάχθησαν κατορθοῦντας ὅμως ἐπαύσαντο τὸν θάνατον Κύρου πυθόμενοι, ἀπαιτούμενοί τε σφᾶς αὐτοὺς καὶ τὰ ὅπλα φέροντας παραδοῦναι οὐδ' ἄκροις ὠσὶν ὑπεδέξαντο, καίτοι μυριάσιν ἐνενήκοντα στρατοῦ κατειργόμενοι, πολλὰ δὲ τὰ μὲν ἔδρασαν, τὰ δ' ἔπαθον, πόρρω μὲν τῆς Ἀσίας ἀναβεβηκότες καὶ αὖ κατιόντες ἐκεῖθεν, διὰ δὲ τῆς ἀλλοτρίας καὶ πολεμίας ἰόντες καὶ πᾶν τὸ ἀντιπῖπτον τὸ μὲν συγκόπτοντες, ἔστι δ' ὑφ' οὗ τοῦτο πάσχοντες. Παραμυθία δ' ἦν αὐτοῖς οὐδεμία καὶ τῶν κακῶν ἀποφυγὴ καὶ μετρία πόλεών τέ τινι προσιέναι κἀνταῦθα τὸν πολὺν διαναπαύσασθαι πόνον, οὔτ' αὐτοῖς εἶχεν ἀσφάλειαν τούς τε δεξομένους οὐκ ἦν εὑρεῖν· ἐδεδίεσαν γὰρ ἅπαντες Πέρσας καὶ τὴν Περσῶν ἀρχήν, οὕτω κορυφωθεῖσαν. Ἔδει δ' ὅμως διόδου καί τινος ἀναπαύλης αὐτοῖς· ἤδη γὰρ ἀπειρήκασι πολλὰ κεκμηκότες, καὶ οὐκ ἦν ἐπὶ πλέον ἀντέχειν, εἰ μή τις ἐξ ὑπογυίου τῶν περιστάντων αὐτοὺς ἀνακωχὴ κακῶν ἀπαντήσει.

Clearchus, who fought as allies for Cyrus the Younger against Artaxerxes, son of Parysatis, and were helping him win the empire and kingship of the Persians: when an ill-starred end to the war befell Cyrus, who neither gained the throne and lost his life besides, these men, though succeeding in their own sector where they had been stationed, nevertheless halted upon learning of Cyrus's death; and when demanded to come surrender themselves and their arms, they would not listen with even the tips of their ears, though hemmed in by an army of nine hundred thousand. Having marched far up into Asia and descending again from there, they inflicted much harm and suffered much, advancing through alien and hostile territory and cutting to pieces whatever stood in their path, though at times suffering the like at an enemy's hands. Yet they had no solace and not even a modest escape from their ills; to approach any city and rest there from their heavy toil neither offered safety for themselves, nor was anyone to be found willing to receive them, for all feared the Persians and the Persian Empire, which had reached such a pinnacle of power. Even so, they stood in need of passage and some respite; for worn out by many hardships they had already reached exhaustion, and it was impossible to hold out any longer unless some immediate relief from the evils besetting them should present itself.

Τότε δὴ μόνη καὶ πρώτη τούτους ἡ ἡμετέρα λαμπρῶς ὑποδέχεται καὶ φιλοφρόνως διαναπαύει καὶ παραμυθεῖται καὶ ἀναψύχει, μεταδιδοῦσα καὶ ἀγορᾶς καὶ ὠνίων καὶ δεξαμένη συνοίκους καὶ τραπέζης αὐτοῖς κοινωνήσασα καὶ ἁλῶν καὶ πάντων ὧν εἶχε καλῶν, οὐ τὰς ἀπειλάς, οὐ τὸν ἐπηρτημένον κίνδυνον ὑπολογισαμένη, οὐδ' ὡς ἀνάγκη τούτοις προσκρούειν, οὓς οὐκ ἀνήρ, οὐ πόλις, οὐ γένος οὐδὲν ὑφίσταται, ὑποχωρεῖ δὲ πάντα καὶ συναπάγεται ῥᾷον ἢ ψηφῖδες κατὰ κυμάτων φερόμεναι καὶ χειμάρρου ῥευμάτων. Ἥ τε γὰρ γενναιότης καὶ τὸ ἐν πολέμοις ἀήττητον ἥ τε φιλανθρωπία καὶ ἡμερότης καὶ τὸ μὴ πρὸς αὐτῶν εἶναι παριδεῖν τε καὶ ἀπώσασθαι ἱκέτας ἀνθρώπους ταὐτοῦ γένους καὶ τῆς αὐτῆς φωνῆς τε καὶ γλώττης, ἐλευθερίας ἀθλητὰς καὶ γενναίους προβόλους, ταῦτ' οὖν παρ' οὐδὲν ἔπειθον τὴν βαρβαρικὴν ὠμότητα τίθεσθαι καὶ διαπτύειν τὰς ἀπειλὰς καὶ δεδιττομένων καταγελᾶν, εἴτε γοῦν ἥττους αὑτοὺς τῶν βαρβάρων ἤδεσαν ὄντας καὶ διὰ τοῦτο πεισομένους ἂν ὑπ' αὐτῶν ὅσα τοὺς ὡς κέντρα λακτίζοντας ἔδει, ὅμως

At that very hour, alone and first of all, our city splendidly welcomed these men and graciously gave them rest, comfort, and refreshment, granting them access to a market and provisions, receiving them to share her hearths, and partaking with them of table and salt and all the good things she possessed—taking no account of the threats or the impending danger, nor of the certainty of offending those whom no man, no city, and no nation could withstand, before whom all things gave way and were swept along more easily than pebbles borne down by waves and the torrents of a winter stream. For their nobility and invincibility in war, their humanity and gentleness, and the conviction that it was not in their character to overlook and thrust away suppliants of the same race and of the same speech and tongue—champions and noble bulwarks of freedom—all these moved them to count barbarian cruelty as nothing, to spit upon threats, and to laugh to scorn those who sought to terrify them. Whether, knowing themselves weaker than the barbarians and bound on that account to

ἀνθείλοντο τῆς τῶν ἱκετῶν σωτηρίας τὴν ἰδίαν οἱ πολῖται ζημίαν καὶ τῆς ἱκεσίου θεοῦ θεραπείας οὐδὲν ἔθεντο πρότερον, μέγιστον ἂν εἶεν ἐξενηνοχότες καὶ σαφέστατον δεῖγμα φιλανθρωπίας τε καὶ μεγαλοψυχίας καὶ τελεώτατον ὅρον ἀγάπης σφᾶς αὐτοὺς ὑπὲρ τοῦ σῶσαι τοὺς φίλους προέμενοι καὶ θάνατον εὐκλεᾶ ζωῆς εὐκλεοῦς ἀνθελόμενοι. Εἴτ' ἀξιόμαχον ἰσχὺν περιβεβλημένοι καὶ κράτος ἐν μάχαις ἐπίστευον ἑαυτοῖς καὶ τῇ οἰκείᾳ ἀνδρείᾳ ὡς κούφως πᾶν οἴσοντες καὶ μετὰ πολλῆς τῆς ῥᾳστώνης τὸν ἐπιόντα ἀγωνισόμενοι πόλεμον, πῶς οὐ διὰ παντὸς ἂν ἥκοιεν θαύματος καὶ εἰς ἔσχατον εἶεν ἀναδραμόντες ἀνδρείας καὶ γενναιότητος, οὕτως ὀλίγοι πρὸς τοσούτους καὶ τηλικούτους ἀνταίροντες καὶ δεινὸν ἐντεῦθεν οὐδὲν οὐχ ὅσον οὐ προσδοκῶντες, ἀλλ' οὐδὲ πάσχοντες, τοῦ καιροῦ παραστάντος. Ἄσμενοι οὖν διὰ ταῦτα τοὺς πρόσφυγας ὑποδεδεγμένοι καὶ μεταδόντες ὅσων εἰκός, τῆς τε πρὸς τὸ παρὸν ἀσφαλείας αὐτῶν προὐνοήσαντο, εἴσω τειχῶν αὐτοὺς ποιησάμενοι, καὶ τῆς μετέπειτα σωτηρίας ἐφρόντισαν, καὶ ὅπως ἂν ἀσφαλέστατα διὰ φιλίων καὶ ἑλληνίδων βαδίζοιεν πόλεων, μηκέτι δεδιότες βαρβάρους καὶ τὸν ἐκεῖθεν ὑποπτεύοντες κίνδυνον, διεπράξαντο.

Ὁ γοῦν αὐτοῖς καὶ Κλεάρχῳ ἄνω τε συναναβὰς τῆς Ἀσίας καὶ πάλιν συνεπανιὼν κατελθοῦσι Ξενοφῶν Ἀθηναῖος, ἀνὴρ οὐ σοφίαν μόνον καὶ λόγον εὐδόκιμος, ἀλλ' οὐδὲν ἧττον τὴν πολιτικὴν ἄριστος ἐπιστήμην καὶ τὰ πολεμικὰ κράτιστος, στρατηγῶν μὲν αὐτῶν ἐν τῷ μέρει, τοῦ Κλεάρχου θανόντος, τὰ πλείω δ' ὅμως ὧν κατειργάσαντο ἔχων εἰς ἑαυτὸν ἀναφέρειν τὰς οἰκείας βουλάς, οἷόν τις ἄρχων ἀρχόντων ὑπάρχων καὶ στρατηγὸς τῶν ἀγόντων, οὗτος τοίνυν, τὰ καθ' ἑαυτούς τε καὶ Κῦρον συγγράφων καὶ τὴν στρατείαν ἐκείνην, τῆς ἡμετέρας τὰ κάλλιστα μαρτυρεῖ, θαλάσσιόν τε καὶ ἑλληνίδα καὶ μόνην σφίσιν ἀναφανεῖσαν φίλιον ὀνομάζων, ὡσανεὶ βοῶν καὶ διαμαρτυρόμενος ὡς ἐν οἰκουμένῃ τοσαύτῃ καὶ τοσούτῳ γῆς μέρει, ἣν διῆλθον καὶ δι' ἧς διιόντες πολλὰ τὰ μὲν ἔπαθον, τὰ δ' ἔδρασαν, μόνην ἐλευθέραν καὶ κυρίαν ἑαυτῆς ἐθεάσαντο ταυτηνί, τῶν ἄλλων ἁπάντων δεδουλωμένων. Τοὺς γὰρ βασιλέως ἐχθροὺς οὐκ ἦν οὐδέσι χρήσασθαι φίλοις τῶν πολύν τινα λόγον ποιουμένων τοῦ βασιλέως. Ἅμα τε γὰρ ἂν αὐτοῖς ἦσαν φίλοι καὶ τοῦ βασιλέως ἐχθροί, ὥστε πρὶν

suffer at their hands all that awaits those who kick against the goads, the citizens nonetheless preferred their own loss to betraying the suppliants' safety and placed nothing above reverence for the God of Suppliants, they must have set forth the greatest and clearest proof of humanity and magnanimity and the most perfect standard of love, hazarding their own selves to save their friends and choosing a glorious death in place of even a glorious life; or whether, clad in battle-worthy strength and mastery in combat, they trusted in themselves and their own valor as able to bear anything lightly and fight out the coming war with great ease, how could they not merit every admiration and have ascended to the utmost height of courage and nobility, standing up so few against enemies so numerous and so mighty, and not merely expecting nothing dreadful therefrom, but suffering nothing when the crisis arrived? Gladly having welcomed the refugees for these reasons and shared with them all that was fitting, they both provided for their immediate safety by admitting them within their walls and took thought for their subsequent deliverance, arranging how they might journey most safely through friendly Greek cities without any longer fearing barbarians or suspecting danger from that quarter.

Indeed, Xenophon the Athenian, who marched up into Upper Asia with them and Clearchus and returned again with them on their descent—a man renowned not only for wisdom and eloquence, but no less supreme in political science and mightiest in warfare, who served as one of their generals in his turn after Clearchus had died, yet could credit most of what they accomplished to himself and his own counsels, being, so to speak, a commander of commanders and a general of their leaders—this man, in writing the history of their own deeds and Cyrus's and of that famous expedition, bears the noblest witness to our city, calling her a maritime Greek city and the only one that proved friendly to them, crying aloud as it were and solemnly testifying that in so vast an inhabited world and across so great a tract of earth through which they passed—suffering much and inflicting much on their march—they beheld this city alone free and mistress of herself, while all others lay enslaved. For the enemies of the Great King could find friends in none who made much account of the King; at one and the same moment men would become friends to

πρὸς αὐτοὺς ἐπιδείξασθαι τὰ τῶν φίλων πρὸς ἐκεῖνον ἀκήρυκτον ἐχρῆν πόλεμον ἀναρριπίσαι καὶ μάχην, τοῦτο δ' ἂν ὅσης εἴη δυνάμεως καὶ ὡς ἀνδρῶν ἐλευθέρων καὶ τὰς ψυχὰς ἀηττήτων οὐδεὶς ὃς ἀγνοεῖ. Δεξάμενοι γοῦν αὐτοὺς ἐπὶ τῆς αὐτῆς οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν πόλεως καὶ τὴν Περσῶν ἔχθραν ἐν δευτέρῳ θέμενοι τοῦ πρὸς αὐτοὺς γιγνομένου, μέχρι Σινώπης διαβῆναι ἐποίησαν, ἐκεῖσε καταγαγόντες αὐτούς, οὗ λοιπὸν ἦν οὐδὲν δέος οὐδ' ὑποψία περσικοῦ φόβου καὶ τῶν ἐκεῖθεν ἐπηρτημένων κινδύνων. Καίτοι, εἰ θαυμάζομεν Ἀθηναίους, Ἡρακλείδας οὐ μόνον ὑποδεξαμένους, Εὐρυσθέως ἐλάσαντος, ἀλλ' ἔς τε τὸ παρὸν μεταδόντας πολιτείας καὶ τῆς ἄλλης παραμυθίας καί, τοῦ καιροῦ παρασχόντος, εἰς τὴν γῆν τὴν πατρῴαν καταγαγόντας καὶ τὴν ἐκ γένους καὶ πατρὸς αὐτοῖς προσήκουσαν ἀποδόντας ἡγεμονίαν, πῶς ἄν τις οὐχὶ θαυμάσεται τὰ ἡμέτερα καὶ τὴν φιλανθρωπίαν ὑμνήσει καὶ ζηλώσει τὴν γενναιότητα;

Οὔτε γὰρ τῶν ἐκ Περσῶν ὑπεριδεῖν ἀπειλῶν τοσοῦτο δυναμένων, οὔτε τοῦ σφίσι συμφέροντος ἦν ἀμελῆσαι, μὴ γενναιότητι καὶ φιλανθρωπίᾳ διενεγκόντας. Ὅσον γοῦν ἑνὸς ἀνδρὸς Εὐρυσθέως καὶ γῆς ὀλίγης τυράννου μικρὰ δυναμένου τὰ Περσῶν ἔθνη δεινότερά τε καὶ φοβερώτερα, τοσοῦτο μεῖζον ἐροῦμεν ἐξενηνοχέναι καὶ ἐναργέστερον πάντων ἀγαθῶν δεῖγμα τοὺς ἀνηρημένους τὸν πρὸς τοὺς δεινοτέρους τῶν ἀντιπάλων ἀγῶνα. Τὸ γὰρ τῶν πολεμίων εὐδόκιμον θατέροις, πάντως δὲ τοῖς νικῶσιν οὐκ ὀλίγα πρὸς εὔκλειαν συλλαμβάνεται καὶ ἡ τῶν ἀνταγωνιστῶν γενναιότης ἐς δόξαν τοῖς κρατήσασι φέρει. Ὥστε, εἴτ' οἰκοθεν ἡ πόλις ἡμῖν, μηδενὸς προδιδάξαντος, ἐπὶ τὰ τῶν πράξεων κάλλιστα τὴν ῥοπὴν ἔσχε, τοσοῦτο διήνεγκεν, εἴτ' Ἀθηναίους καὶ τὰς αὐτῶν πράξεις ζηλοῦσα πρὸς τοῦθ' ὥρμησε, τοσοῦτον ὑπερεβάλετο. Οὕτως ἄνωθεν ἑλληνικοῦ τε φρονήματος ἔμπλεως ἦν καὶ τὴν ἐλευθερίαν ἐτίμα, τὴν δουλείαν καὶ μέχρι τῆς κλήσεως ὡς ἐνὸν ἀποστρεφομένη καὶ δυσχεραίνουσα, ἐπεί τοι τὸ χείροσιν ἑαυτῶν ἀναγκάζεσθαι δουλεύειν τινὰς καὶ συνειδέναι σφίσι τὰς ψυχὰς πολλῷ κρείττοσιν οὖσιν ἢ ὑφ' ὧν ἄρχονται τίνος οὐκ ἂν καταβάλοι ψυχὴν ἢ πῶς ἄν τις οὐ δεύτερα πάντα κακὰ θεῖτο καὶ πρὸς ἓν μόνον ἀγωνίσαιτο τοῦτο, τῆς μεγίστης συμφορᾶς ταυτησὶν ἀπηλλάχθαι; Τὸν γὰρ ἐλεύθερον ἄνδρα καὶ

them and enemies to the King, so that before showing acts of friendship toward them, one had first to kindle truce-less war and battle against him—and what great strength this required, and how truly it belonged to free men unconquered in soul, there is no one who does not know. Receiving them, therefore, in that same city, and counting the enmity of the Persians secondary to what was due toward these men, our fathers enabled them to cross over as far as Sinope, bringing them safely ashore there, where henceforth there was no dread nor any shadow of fear of the Persians and the dangers impending from that quarter. And yet, if we admire the Athenians because, when Eurystheus had driven out the Heraclidae, they not only sheltered them, but for the present granted them citizenship and every other comfort and, when opportunity offered, restored them to their ancestral land and gave back to them the sovereignty that belonged to them by lineage and their father, how shall one not marvel at our own deeds, hymn our humanity, and emulate our nobility?

For it would have been impossible either to disdain the threats coming from the Persians, who possessed such vast power, or to disregard their own advantage, had they not excelled in nobility and humanity. Accordingly, by as much as the nations of the Persians were more formidable and terrifying than a single man, Eurystheus, the petty tyrant of a small strip of land, by so much greater and clearer a proof of every virtue shall we say those men set forth who took upon themselves the struggle against the more formidable adversaries. For the renown of one's enemies contributes in no small measure to the glory of the other side—above all to the victors—and the valor of antagonists redounds to the fame of those who have prevailed. Thus, whether our city inclined toward the noblest of deeds of her own accord, with no one having taught her beforehand, she excelled to such a degree; or whether she was spurred to this out of emulation of the Athenians and their deeds, by so much did she surpass them. So thoroughly filled with Greek spirit was she from the very beginning, and so deeply did she honor freedom, shunning and loathing slavery as far as possible even to its very name; since, indeed, for men to be compelled to serve their inferiors while conscious within their souls that they are far superior to those by whom they are ruled—whose spirit would this not cast down, or how would anyone not

πόλιν ἢ τοῖς ἀμείνοσιν ὑπείκειν ἀνάγκη καὶ δουλεύειν τοῖς κρείττοσιν, ἀγομένοις ὑπ' ἐκείνων ἐπὶ τὰ σφίσι συμφέροντα καὶ ἐφ' ἅπερ οὐκ ἂν αὐτοὶ οἴκοθεν ἤχθησαν· οὗτος γὰρ δὴ νόμος ἀρχῆς ἄριστος καὶ δουλεία ἐλευθερίᾳ ἀντίρροπος, ἔστι δ' ὅτε καὶ κρείττων, ὅταν μὴ σφίσι τινὲς ἐξαρκοῖεν μηδὲ δύναιντο μηδενὸς παραδείξαντος ἐφικνεῖσθαι τῶν ἀρετῶν· ἢ τοῦτο οὐκ ἔχοντας οὐδὲ τοιούτων δεσποτῶν εὐποροῦντας ζῆν καθ' αὑτοὺς ὥς γ' ἐκ τῶν ἐνόντων αἱρουμένους τὰ βέλτιστα καὶ ἃ ἄν τις διὰ πάντων ἐλευθερίαν αὐτοῖς μαρτυρήσειεν.

count all other evils secondary and strive for this one aim alone: to be rid of this greatest of calamities? For the free man and the free city must either yield to their betters and serve their superiors, being guided by them toward their own true advantage and toward goals to which they would not have been led of their own accord—for this is indeed the best law of rule, and a service counterpoised to freedom, nay at times even better than freedom, whenever men are not self-sufficient in themselves nor able to attain the virtues without someone to point the way—or else, lacking this fortune and enjoying no supply of such masters, they must live independently by themselves, choosing what is best so far as circumstances allow and pursuing such courses as anyone would attest to be thoroughgoing freedom for them.

§ 19. [σ. 30–34] Ἐπὶ δὴ τοιούτοις καὶ οἱ ἡμέτεροι σαλεύοντες λογισμοῖς καὶ ταῦτα προμελετῶντες, οὕτω τῶν τοιούτων ἐγένοντο λογισμῶν καὶ ταύτης τῆς δόξης, ὥστ' ἐφ' ὅσον μὲν ἐνῆν καὶ ψυχὰς καὶ σώματα διετέλεσαν ἐλεύθεροι ὄντες, μετ' ἐλευθερίας τῆς ὄντως πολιτευόμενοι καὶ τὰ καθ' αὑτοὺς διοικοῦντες, μόγις δέ ποτε καὶ τοῦτ' ἐπ' ὀλίγον τοῖς σώμασιν εἴξαντες, ταῖς ψυχαῖς οὐχ ὡμολόγησαν οὐδ' ἐγγύς, οὐδ' ἐδουλώθησαν τὰ φρονήματα τῷ μεγίστῳ ἑαυτῶν καὶ κυριωτάτῳ τὸ ἀρχικὸν τηροῦντες καὶ τὴν ἡγεμονίαν καὶ τὸ διὰ πάντων ἐλεύθερον. Δυοῖν γὰρ δὴ τούτοιν, σώμασι καὶ ψυχαῖς, δεδουλωμένων τῶν ἀνθρώπων ἀνθρώποις, τοὺς μὲν τὰς ψυχὰς καταβεβλημένους καὶ γνώμαις ταπεινωθέντας ἐλευθέρους οὐκ ἂν ὀνομάσαιμι, κἂν σώμασιν ἄρχοιεν, τῷ τιμιωτάτῳ ἑαυτῶν ὑπακούοντας ἄλλων. Ἂν δέ τις ἐς μὲν ὅσον ἐστὶν ἐφικτὸν ὑπερέχῃ τῶν ἐναντίων καὶ ἀμφοτέροις, ἀνάγκης δὲ συνωθούσης προδιδοίη τὰ τῆς ἐλάττονος μοίρας ὑπὸ τοῦ σῶσαι τὸ κρεῖττον, τοῦτον τῷ ὄντι ἐλεύθερον οὐκ ἂν αἰσχυνοίμην ἀποφαινόμενος καὶ ἄρχειν, δουλείαν ὑποκρινόμενον, καὶ δεσπόζειν ἐν ᾧ δοκεῖ πρὸς ἄλλων τινῶν ἄρχεσθαι. Τίς γὰρ οὐκ οἶδεν, ὡς τὸν μὲν γνώμῃ ταπεινωθέντα καὶ σώματι δουλεύειν ἀνάγκη, ἅτε τοῦ μὲν ἑπομένου, τῆς δὲ ψυχῆς ἀγούσης ἐκ τρόπου παντός, τῇ δὲ τοῦ φρονήματος ἐμβριθείᾳ καὶ τῷ ἀταπεινώτῳ τῆς γνώμης καὶ τὰ σώματα συνεξαίρεται καὶ συμμετέχει τῆς ἐλευθερίας πρός τε τὴν παρεστῶσαν ὥραν τοῦ χρόνου καὶ τῶν πραγμάτων διδόντων ἐς ὕστερον

§ 19. [p. 30–34] Riding at anchor upon such reflections and rehearsing these principles beforehand, our people too held so firmly to such reasoning and to this conviction that, for as long as was possible, they continued to be free in both soul and body, governing themselves in genuine freedom and managing their own affairs; and when at length—scarcely, and even then only for a brief season—they yielded in body, in their souls they did not come close to capitulating, nor were their spirits enslaved, preserving in the greatest and most sovereign part of themselves their ruling dignity, primacy, and thoroughgoing freedom. For since men are enslaved to other men in these two respects, body and soul, those who are cast down in soul and abased in mind I would never call free, even should they rule with their bodies, when in the most precious part of themselves they obey others. Yet if a man prevails over his adversaries in both respects so far as is attainable, and when necessity presses hard surrenders what belongs to the lesser portion in order to save the better, I would not be ashamed to pronounce this man truly free, and to declare that he rules while feigning servitude and is master even while he seems to be ruled by certain others. For who does not know that he who has been abased in mind must needs be a slave in body as well, inasmuch as the body follows while the soul leads in every way; whereas through gravity of spirit and an unbowed mind even men's bodies are uplifted together with their souls and partake of freedom both at the present moment and still

τελεώτερον, ὡς ἔργοις αὐτοῖς καὶ πράγμασιν οἱ ἡμέτεροι ἔδειξαν, οὐ μετὰ πολὺ τοῖς κοινοῖς δεσπόταις Ῥωμαίοις καὶ τῇ ἀρίστῃ καὶ δικαιοτάτῃ Ῥωμαίων προστεθέντες ἡγεμονίᾳ καὶ ἄσμενος ἐκείνων ἀπαλλαγέντες οἷς πρότερον ὑπετάγησαν, Μιθριδάτου φημὶ καὶ τῶν ἐξ ἐκείνων ποντικῶν βασιλέων. Πρὸς γὰρ δὴ τούτους καὶ τοὺς ἐκ τούτου τοῦ γένους βασιλεῖς, ἐπὶ μέγα ἠρμένους, ὡς οὐκ ἦν ἔτι ἀντέχειν τὸ μὲν οἷς πολλὰ κεκμήκασι πρότερον ἠγωνισμένοι πρός τε Πέρσας καὶ τοὺς ἄλλους βαρβάρους καὶ αὐτοὺς τοὺς ἀπὸ Μιθριδάτου, τὸ δ' οἷς αὐτοὺς ἔπειτα εἰς μέγιστον ἐπιδεδωκότας συνεῖδον καὶ πολλῆς ἄλλης ἑλληνικῆς γῆς ἐπιλαβομένους, ἐσπείσαντο αὐτοῖς καὶ ὑπήκουον, ἀναξιοπαθοῦντες ὅμως καὶ ταῖς ψυχαῖς δυσχεραίνοντες καὶ ἀνάξιον κρίνοντες ὅτι σώμασι γοῦν, τῷ χείρονι ἑαυτῶν, οἷς μὴ χρεὼν ἔδει ὑπείκειν.

Τὴν γὰρ ἐν Πόντῳ καὶ Γαλατίᾳ Μιθριδάτου τοῦ Ἀριοβαρζάνου ἡγεμονίαν, ταπεινὴν ἐν τοῖς ἄνω καιροῖς οὖσαν ἀπὸ μικροῦ τέ τινος ἀρξαμένην, ὅμως ὑπώπτευεν ὁ τῶν Ἀλεξάνδρου διαδόχων μέγιστος καὶ πρεσβύτατος Ἀντίγονος, ὁ βασιλεὺς τῆς Συρίας καὶ τῆς Ἀσίας τοῦ πλείστου, ἔκ τε τῶν πραγμάτων αὐτῶν τεκμαιρόμενος ἐς ὅσον ὄγκου τε καὶ μεγέθους προβήσεται καὶ πόσης γῆς ἐπιλήψεται ἔκ τέ τινος ἐνυπνίου διαταραχθεὶς οὐ μετρίως. Νομίσας οὖν, Μιθριδάτου θανόντος, παραλύσεσθαί τε τὴν βασιλείαν αὐτῷ καὶ μέρος τῆς ἰδίας ἀρχῆς γενήσεσθαι τελεώτερον, βουλὴν βουλεύεται πονηρὰν μᾶλλον ἢ σοφήν, ἀδόκητον αὐτῷ καὶ αἰφνίδιον ἐπιστῆσαι τὸν θάνατον. Ἐπεὶ δὴ ξύμμαχον ὄντα κἀν τοῖς φίλοις τελοῦντα καλῶς οὐκ εἶχεν ἐκ τοῦ προφανοῦς ἀνελεῖν, εὐπροσώπου μὴ δραξαμένῳ προφάσεως, δόλῳ μετελθεῖν αὐτὸν ἐδοκίμασε παρόντα τε καὶ κατὰ συμμαχίαν αὐτῷ συνεπόμενον, καί, τῷ υἱῷ Δημητρίῳ τὸ ἀπόρρητον κοινωσάμενος, ὅρκοις αὐτὸν προκατείληφε παρ' ἑαυτῷ τηρεῖν ἀνέκφορον τὸ μυστήριον μηδενί τε τὸ παράπαν εἰπεῖν μηδὲ ἕν. Τὸν δὲ φιλίᾳ τε προκατειλημμένον τἀνδρὸς καὶ ἅμα παθόντα τὴν ψυχὴν ὡς ἀδίκως πεισομένου τἀνθρώπου εὑρεῖν ὅπως Μιθριδάτην τε ῥύσεται τοῦ κινδύνου καὶ κρείττων αὐτὸς ἐπιορκίας φανήσεται, τὰ

more perfectly thereafter when circumstances permit? This our people proved by their very deeds and actions, when not long afterward they joined themselves to the Romans, the common masters of the world, and to the Romans' best and most righteous hegemony, gladly ridding themselves of those to whom they had previously been subjected—I mean Mithridates and the Pontic kings sprung from that line. For against these rulers and the kings of this house, once they had risen to great power, when it was no longer possible to hold out—partly because our people were worn out from having struggled long beforehand against the Persians, the other barbarians, and the house of Mithridates itself, and partly because they perceived that these kings had subsequently grown to the greatest might and seized hold of much other Greek territory—they made terms with them and submitted, yet smarting under the indignity, chafing in their souls, and deeming it unworthy that even with their bodies, the inferior part of themselves, they had to yield to men to whom they ought not.

For the principality in Pontus and Galatia of Mithridates, son of Ariobarzanes, humble though it was in earlier times and risen from slender beginnings, was nonetheless viewed with suspicion by Antigonus, the greatest and eldest of Alexander's Successors and king of Syria and the greater part of Asia, who both conjectured from the course of events itself to what bulk and magnitude it would advance and how much territory it would grasp, and was also disturbed in no small measure by a certain dream. Supposing, therefore, that if Mithridates died his realm would be dissolved and become more completely a part of his own empire, he devised a counsel more wicked than wise: to bring sudden and unexpected death upon him. Yet since he could not decently slay him openly when he was an ally and numbered among his friends without having seized upon some specious pretext, he resolved to deal with him by craft while he was present and accompanying him in alliance; and having shared the secret with his son Demetrius, he bound him beforehand by oaths to keep the mystery divulged to none within his own breast and to utter not a single word of it to anyone at all. Demetrius, however, already bound by friendship to the man and at the same time moved in soul because the fellow was about to suffer unjustly, found a way both to

ὁμωμοσμένα τηρήσας ὡς ἐνὸν ἔμπεδα· ἀπολαβὼν γὰρ αὐτὸν κατὰ μόνας, ὡς ἐγεγόνεισαν καθ' αὑτούς, γράφει μὲν αὐτὸς κατὰ γῆς τῆς λόγχης τῷ στύρακι, ὁρῶντος ἐκείνου, Φεῦγε, Μιθριδάτα, ὁ δ' εὐθὺς συναισθόμενος ἀπέδρα τε νυκτὸς εἰς Καππαδοκίαν καὶ τὸν ἐπηρτημένον αὐτῷ διέφυγε κίνδυνον. Ἐκ τούτου τῆς τε φιλίας Ἀντιγόνου ἀφίσταται καὶ διετέλει διάφορός τε ὢν αὐτῷ καὶ πολέμιος καὶ τὴν ἀρχὴν ἑαυτοῦ οὐ συνέχων μόνον καὶ συντηρῶν, ἀλλὰ καὶ προσαύξων οὐ μικραῖς ταῖς προσθήκαις. Πολλῆς τε γὰρ καὶ ἀγαθῆς ἐκράτησε χώρας καὶ πολλὴν περιεβάλετο δύναμιν, πολλὰ τῶν τότε μὲν ὑπὸ Μακεδόνας, ὕστερον δὲ γενομένων ὑπὸ Ῥωμαίους τότε μὲν αὐτός, ἔπειθ' οἱ μετ' ἐκείνου δουλώσαντες. Ἀσίαν τε γὰρ Ῥωμαίων καὶ Βιθυνίαν καὶ Καππαδοκίαν καὶ Παφλαγονίαν ἀφεῖλον ἦρχόν τε Πόντου τε καὶ Βοσπόρου καὶ μέχρι τῶν ὑπὲρ τὴν Μαιῶτιν ἀοικήτων, οὐδενὸς παρενοχλοῦντος.

Ἐπεὶ δ' οὐδὲν αὐτοῖς ὥριζε τὴν πλεονεξίαν, ἀλλ' ἀεί τι ἐπικτώμενοι κἀπὶ τῆς ἀντιπέρας ἠπείρου διέβησαν, Θρᾴκην τε καὶ Μακεδονίαν ἐπὶ στρατῷ πολλῷ προσαγόμενοι καὶ μεγάλῳ συμπάσης τε θαλάσσης ἐπικρατοῦντες καὶ τὰς Κυκλάδας καταδουλούμενοι νήσους καὶ τὴν Εὔβοιαν ἔχοντες ἤδη ἔκ τε Ἀθηνῶν ὁρμώμενοι, τὰ μέχρι τῆς Θετταλίας ἔθνη τῆς Ἑλλάδος ἀφίστων, ἤγειραν μὲν καθ' ἑαυτῶν τοὺς Ῥωμαίους, κατὰ δὲ τῆς οἰκείας ἤδη κεφαλῆς ἔγνωσαν πᾶν μηχανώμενοι, ἥ τε πλεονεξία προσαπώλεσεν αὐτοῖς καὶ τἀρχαῖα, καὶ τὸ κεφάλαιον αὐτὸ ζημιώσασα, ὥσπερ τοὺς ἐπὶ τόκοις μεγάλοις δανείζοντας, καὶ εἰς τοὐναντίον αὐτοῖς ἢ ἐβούλοντο περιέστη τὰ πράγματα. Μάριός τε γὰρ καὶ μετ' ἐκεῖνον ὁ Σύλλας πολλάκις Μιθριδάτῃ τε τῷ ἀπὸ τοῦ πρώτου ὀγδόου καὶ τοῖς ἐκείνου συρράξαντες στρατηγοῖς πόλεμον, οὐ τῆς εὐρωπαίας γῆς διεώσαντο μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ Λούκουλλος μετὰ τούτους τῶν ἀσιανῶν ἐθνῶν αὐτὸν οὐκ ὀλίγα ἀφείλετο. Ἐπεὶ δὲ τὸ πεπρωμένον ἀπῄτει καὶ ἡ μοῖρα τὴν Ῥωμαίων ἡγεμονίαν ἠνάγκαζεν ἐς τὰ γῆς ἔσχατα ἐκτετάσθαι καὶ τούτοις ὡρίσθαι σχεδὸν πέρασι, Πομπήιον Μάγνον ἀνέστησε, προθυμότερον μὲν τοῦ κατ' αὐτῶν ἡμμένον πολέμου, μετὰ λαμπροτέρας δὲ καὶ εὐδαιμονεστέρας τῆς τύχης ὁρμώμενον. Ὃς Μιθριδάτῃ συμβαλὼν καὶ ἡττήσας, εἶτα φυγόντα μεταδιώκει, καί, μέχρι Κασπίων πυλῶν

rescue Mithridates from danger and to prove himself above perjury, keeping his sworn pledge unbroken so far as lay in his power: taking him aside privately, when they were by themselves, with Mithridates looking on, he traced upon the ground with the butt-spike of his spear, "Flee, Mithridates!" Understanding at once, Mithridates fled by night into Cappadocia and escaped the danger hanging over him. From that time forth he broke off his friendship with Antigonus and remained at variance and at war with him, not merely holding together and preserving his own realm, but enlarging it with no small additions. Indeed, he mastered much fair territory and clothed himself with great power, first he himself and afterward his successors subjugating many of the lands that were then under the Macedonians and later came under the Romans. For they wrested Asia, Bithynia, Cappadocia, and Paphlagonia from the Romans, and ruled both Pontus and Bosporus and as far as the uninhabited wastes beyond Lake Maeotis, with no one troubling them.

Yet when nothing set a bound to their greed for dominion, and ever acquiring something more they crossed over even to the opposite continent—winning over Thrace and Macedonia with a vast and mighty host, commanding the entire sea, enslaving the Cyclades islands, holding Euboea already, and using Athens as their base to drive the peoples of Greece as far as Thessaly into revolt—they roused the Romans against themselves and found that they had been contriving everything against their own heads; their grasping ambition cost them their original possessions besides, forfeiting even the principal itself, just like men who lend at exorbitant interest, and affairs came round for them to the very opposite of what they wished. For Marius, and after him Sulla, repeatedly clashing in war with Mithridates, the eighth from the first, and with his generals, not only thrust him back from European soil, but Lucullus after them stripped him of no few Asian nations as well. And when destiny required it and fate compelled the hegemony of the Romans to stretch forth to the ends of the earth and be bounded virtually by those limits, it raised up Pompey the Great, who laid hold of the war against them with even greater zeal and set forth with brighter and more auspicious fortune. Engaging Mithridates and defeating him, he then pursued him in flight, and ascending as far as the

ἀνελθών, κρατεῖ μὲν τῶν ἄλλων ἁπάντων ἐθνῶν, Σύρων τε καὶ Κιλίκων καὶ Παφλαγόνων καὶ τῶν ἐν Μεσοποταμίᾳ τε καὶ Φοινίκῃ καὶ Παλαιστίνῃ κατῳκημένων καὶ Ἰουδαίᾳ καὶ Ἀραβίᾳ, δουλοῖ δὲ Ῥωμαίοις Καππαδοκίαν, Μοισίαν, Κολχίδα, Ἰβηρίαν, Ἀλβανίαν, Ἀρμενίαν καὶ τὰ μέχρι Μαιώτιδος. Μιθριδάτῃ δ' οὐ τὴν ἀρχὴν μόνην, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὴν ζωὴν αὐτὴν ἀφελόμενος, λαμπρὸς λαμπρῶς ἐπανῆλθε τῷ δήμῳ Ῥωμαίων εὐφημίαις τε καὶ θριάμβοις καὶ πᾶσι τιμῶν καταστεφόμενος εἴδεσιν.

Ἐντεῦθεν ἡ ἡμετέρα ἄσμενός τε ἦν ἐκ πολλοῦ ἐπίδοξον εἶχεν ἐλευθερίας εἶδεν ἡμέραν, καὶ τοῖς οἰκουμένης δεσπόταις εὐθὺς προσχωρήσασα Ῥωμαίοις καὶ τῇ 'κείνων ἡγεμονίᾳ ἑαυτήν τε καὶ τοὺς ἰδίους τροφίμους ἐνέδωκε φέρουσα, πολλὰ μὲν συνησθέντας σφίσιν αὐτοῖς ἀνθ' ὧν τῆς βαρβαρικῆς ἐπιστασίας εὐτυχῶς ἀπηλλάγησαν, πολλὴν δὲ τῷ ἐλευθερίῳ θεῷ χάριν ὁμολογήσαντας τῆς ἐς τὸ κρεῖττον αὑτῶν τε καὶ τοῦ ξύμπαντος ἐπιδόσεως. Τὸ δ' ἦν Ῥωμαίοις ὑποταγῆναι, ἑλληνικῆς τε γῆς οὐ μόνον ἡγουμένοις ἁπάσης, ἀλλὰ καὶ μόνοις ἀξίως καὶ ὄντως ἄρχουσι, κηδεμονικήν τε καὶ πατρικὴν τὴν ἐς τοὺς ὑπηκόους ἐπιδεικνυμένοις εὔνοιαν καὶ τὸ 'κείνοις συμφέρον ἐκ παντὸς τρόπου μηχανωμένοις, ὅπερ ἐστὶν ἀληθῶς ἄρχοντος καὶ ἡγεμόνος τῷ ὄντι. Οὐ γὰρ δυνάμει γε μόνον καὶ περιουσίᾳ καὶ πλούτου καὶ στρατιᾶς κατεῖχον ὑπήκοα πάντα ἔθνη καὶ πᾶν γένος ἀνθρώπων, ἀλλ' οὐδὲν ἧττον τῷ τε νομίμως ἄρχειν καὶ δικαίως αὐτοὺς ἐπήγοντο καὶ οἷς ὡς πρὸς παῖδας πατὴρ ὢν ἤπιος προσεφέροντο. Ἐντεῦθεν γὰρ αὐτοῖς καὶ παραμόνιμον τὸ τῆς ἀρχῆς διατετέλεκε γενόμενον πρόσχημα, ἅτε συνεχόμενόν τε εὐνοίᾳ καὶ φιλίᾳ συνδούμενον, καὶ μόνοι τοῦ χρόνου κρείττους ἐγένοντο, τοσούτου μὲν ἤδη τοῦ ἀπ' ἐκείνου παραρρυέντος, οὐδὲν δ' αὐτοῖς τήν τε εὐδαιμονίαν καὶ τὴν ἡγεμονίαν λυμηναμένου, ἀλλ' ἄτρεπτόν τε καὶ ἀκίνητον σχοῦσιν, ἐφ' ὅσον εἰκός, τὸ κατὰ πάντων κράτος καὶ τὴν ἀρχὴν τὴν βασίλειον. Οἷς πολλῆς γῆς καὶ πλειόνων ἐθνῶν δουλωθέντων τὸ μέγιστόν τε καὶ κάλλιστον ἦν τὸ καὶ τὴν Ἑλλάδα τοὺς δεσπότας γνωρίσαι καὶ ζῆν ὑπὸ τούτους ἑλέσθαι τοὺς ἁπανταχῆ γῆς τὴν Ἑλλήνων τιμῶντας φωνήν. Πατρικήν τε γὰρ βασιλείαν καὶ νόμιμον καὶ σοφῶν ἐπιστασίαν ἀνδρῶν πόσων οὐκ ἄν τις ἐλευθεριῶν ἄσμενος πρίαιτο;

Caspian Gates, he mastered all the other nations—Syrians, Cilicians, and Paphlagonians, together with the inhabitants of Mesopotamia, Phoenicia, Palestine, Judaea, and Arabia—and subjugated to the Romans Cappadocia, Moesia, Colchis, Iberia, Albania, Armenia, and the regions reaching to Lake Maeotis. Having deprived Mithridates not of his realm alone, but of his very life, he returned in brilliant splendor to the Roman people, crowned with acclamations, triumphs, and every form of honor.

Thereupon our city gladly beheld the day of freedom which she had long held in expectation, and going over at once to the Romans, the masters of the inhabited world, she eagerly gave both herself and her own nurslings into their hegemony—her citizens warmly congratulating one another because they had been happily delivered from barbarian overlordship, and rendering abundant thanks to the God of Freedom for the advancement both of themselves and of the whole world toward the better. And that advancement was to become subject to the Romans, who not only led the whole of Greek land, but alone ruled worthily and in true reality, displaying a solicitous and fatherly goodwill toward their subjects and contriving their advantage in every way—which is the mark of a genuine ruler and a true leader. For not merely by power and by abundance of both wealth and armed forces did they hold all nations and every race of men in allegiance, but no less did they win them over by ruling lawfully and justly, and by conducting themselves toward them, as toward children, like a gentle father. Hence the majesty of their empire has continued enduring, held together by goodwill and bound fast by friendship, and they alone have proved mightier than time: though so vast a span has already flowed by since then, it has in no way marred their prosperity and hegemony, as they have maintained, so far as humanly possible, their universal dominion and imperial rule unshaken and immovable. When much land and many nations had been subjugated by them, their greatest and fairest achievement was that Greece too recognized her masters and chose to live under these men who everywhere on earth honored the speech of the Greeks. For at the price of how many freedoms would one not gladly purchase a fatherly and lawful kingship and the governance of wise men?

Ἐντεῦθεν Ῥωμαῖοι μὲν ἦρχον, ὑπήκουε δὲ καὶ ἡ ἡμετέρα καὶ ἤγετο μετά γε τῶν ἄλλων Ἑλλήνων καὶ τῆς Ἀθηνῶν πόλεως καὶ μητρὸς Ἀττικῆς καὶ σχῆμα μὲν εἶχον ὑπακουόντων, τιμῶν δ' εἵνεκα καὶ εὐνοίας καὶ ἧς ἐφύλαττον εἰς αὐτοὺς αἰδοῦς οἱ σφῶν ἄρχοντες συνάρχοντες μᾶλλον ἐδείκνυντο, ὥσπερ τις νεώτερος ἀδελφῷ πρεσβυτέρῳ συμβασιλεύων ἤ, ἵνα φῶ τἀληθέστερον, ὡς εὖ μὲν καὶ γνώσεώς τις καὶ φωνῆς ἥκων καὶ πείρας τῆς ἐς τὸν βίον, γήρᾳ δ' ἄλλως ἐξημβλωμένος τὸ δύνασθαι πράττειν ἀδελφῷ ῥωμαλέῳ μὲν καὶ θαρροῦντι καὶ πολεμικῆς ἐπιστήμης ἱκανῶς ἔχοντι, δεομένῳ δὲ λόγων καὶ συμβουλίας συμπαρομαρτῶν τε καὶ συνεπόμενος. Τήν τε γὰρ φωνὴν Ἕλλησιν ἐς τὸ ἀκριβέστατόν τε καὶ καθαρώτατον ἐξησκημένην Ῥωμαῖοι ἠπίσταντο τήν τε γνῶσιν καὶ φρόνησιν καὶ τὸ περιὸν τῆς σοφίας αὐτά τ' ἐδείκνυ τὰ πράγματα καὶ ὅσα φθάσαντες διεπράξαντο, ὥστ' οὔτε βουλεύεσθαι συνετωτέρους ἄλλους ᾔδεσαν ὄντας ἢ μείζους τε καὶ καλλίους ἐξ ὧν ἔπραξαν ἀφορμὰς ἔχοντας, οὔτε, λόγον ἀποτεῖναι δεῆσαν σοφόν τε καὶ πιθανόν, προῆγον ἑτέρους, τῶν δευτερείων Ἕλληνας ἀξιοῦντες, ἀλλ' ὡς ἂν μόνους ἀξίους λόγοις κεκοσμημένους καὶ μόνους τὴν ἀνθρώπῳ προσήκουσαν φωνὴν ἀφιέντας, ἅτε καὶ φύσεως ἀνθρώπων ἥκοντας ἐπὶ πλεῖστον καὶ τῷ ὄντι λογικοὺς ὄντας αὐτούς, προῆγόν τε τῶν ἄλλων ἁπάντων καὶ τιμῶν τῶν μεγίστων ἠξίουν καὶ σφῶν αὐτῶν ὁμολογοῦντες αὐτοὺς τῷ παντὶ διαφέρειν γλῶττάν τε τὴν αὐτῶν καὶ σοφίαν ἄγοντες περὶ πλείστου καὶ σπουδάζοντες ἕκαστος ὅστις αὐτὴν ἐξησκηκὼς ἀκριβέστερον φθάσει. Οὕτως ἦγον Ἕλληνες μᾶλλον τοὺς ἄγοντας ἢ ὑπ' αὐτῶν ἤγοντο, καὶ τοιοῦτον αὐτοῖς ἦν τὸ σχῆμα τῆς συμμαχίας.

Thenceforth the Romans ruled, while our city too obeyed and was led alongside the rest of the Greeks and the city of Athens and Mother Attica; and in outward form the Greeks were subjects, yet by reason of the honors, goodwill, and reverence which their rulers maintained toward them, they were shown rather to be fellow-rulers—like a younger brother sharing the kingship with an elder brother, or, to speak more truly, like a man well endowed with knowledge, eloquence, and experience of life, though otherwise blunted by old age in his capacity for action, attending and accompanying a brother who is vigorous, bold, and well versed in the art of war, yet stands in need of discourse and counsel. For the Romans knew that speech had been cultivated among the Greeks to the utmost precision and purity, while events themselves and all that they had previously accomplished demonstrated their knowledge, prudence, and surpassing wisdom; consequently, the Romans neither knew of any others more sagacious in counsel or possessing greater and nobler resources drawn from past deeds, nor, whenever there was need to deliver a wise and persuasive oration, did they promote others and assign second place to the Greeks. Rather, regarding them as the only ones worthily adorned with learning and eloquence and the only ones uttering speech befitting a human being—inasmuch as they had attained the fullest perfection of human nature and were themselves truly rational and articulate—they promoted them ahead of all others and deemed them worthy of the highest honors, confessing that in all this the Greeks altogether surpassed even themselves, prizing their tongue and wisdom above all else, and each vying eagerly to outstrip the rest in cultivating it most accurately. Thus the Greeks led their leaders more than they were led by them, and such was the form of their alliance.

§ 20. [σ. 34–36] Τούτῳ δὴ καὶ ἡ πόλις ἡμῖν τῷ τρόπῳ Ῥωμαίοις εἴξασα καὶ τῇ ’κείνων ἡγεμονίᾳ τῆς γινομένης μὲν αὐτῇ τιμῆς τε καὶ θεραπείας ἐκεῖθεν ἀπήλαυε, τὴν δὲ προσήκουσαν αὖθις αἰδῶ τε καὶ πίστιν καὶ εὔνοιαν αὐτὴ τοῖς ἄρχουσιν οὐ μόνον ἐφύλαττεν, ἀλλὰ καὶ ἐς τόδε τηροῦσα διατελεῖ ὑφ' οὓς εὔχετο τελέσαι δεσπότας καὶ οὓς ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἔγνω οὐδενός τε τῶν ἄλλων ἀλλάξασα καὶ διατελοῦσ' αὐτοῖς εὔνους οὖσα τὸν πάντα αἰῶνα. Ἐνιαυτοὶ γὰρ

§ 20. [p. 34–36] Yielding in this manner to the Romans and to their hegemony, our city too enjoyed the honor and solicitous care bestowed upon her from that source, while in return she herself not only guarded due reverence, fidelity, and goodwill toward her rulers, but continues to preserve them down to this day—never exchanging for any others those masters under whom she had prayed to be enrolled and whom she had recognized from the outset, and remaining loyal to them

ἤδη πρὸς τοῖς πεντακοσίοις παρῳχήκεσαν χίλιοι Ῥωμαίοις ὑποταγείσης, καὶ πολλὰ μὲν ἔφυσαν ἐν τῷ μέσῳ, πλείω δὲ κέκρυπται, ἃ τῷ μακρῷ χρόνῳ προσήκειν ἔφη τις ἔργα, καὶ ὅπως ἄτρεπτος ἡ πόλις ἡμῖν οὖσα διαμένει καὶ ἀμετάβλητος, οὓς ἡγεμόνας εἵλετο στέργουσα καὶ τὴν γιγνομένην αὐτοῖς ἀποδιδοῦσα πειθώ. Καίτοι τὸ μὲν τῆς ἀρχῆς εἶδος μετεβλήθη Ῥωμαίοις· δικτάτωρες γὰρ ἐν τοῖς ἄνω χρόνοις καὶ ὕπατοι καὶ γερουσία καὶ στρατηγοὶ τὰ Ῥωμαίων ἦγον καὶ ἔφερον, εἶτα μονάρχης αὐτῶν ἐπελάβετο καὶ τὸ βασιλείας εἶδος ἐς τὸν ὄπισθεν χρόνον παρέπεμψε, καὶ τοῦτο τὸ σχῆμα τοῦ δήμου Ῥωμαίων καὶ τῶν αὐτοῖς ὑπηκόων ἐς τόδε προϊσταται, μεταβάσης τῆς βασιλείας ἐς τὸ Βυζάντιον καὶ τὴν ἑῴαν ἀπόμοιραν.

through all time. For a thousand and five hundred years have already passed since she became subject to the Romans, and in the meantime many things have sprung into light while still more have been hidden away—works which, as someone has said, belong to vast Time—and yet see how unswerving and unchanging our city abides, cherishing those whom she chose as leaders and rendering them the obedience that is their due. And yet among the Romans themselves the form of government changed: in earlier times dictators, consuls, senate, and generals directed and administered Roman affairs; thereafter a monarch took charge of them and transmitted the form of kingship to subsequent ages, and down to the present day this polity presides over the Roman people and their subjects, following the transfer of the imperial throne to Byzantium and the eastern portion.

Ἡ ἡμετέρα δ' ἐν πᾶσί τε τοῖς καιροῖς καὶ παντοίαις μεταβολαῖς ἡ αὐτὴ πρὸς αὐτοὺς μένει, τὸ Ῥωμαίοις ὑπείκειν προὔργου παντὸς εἶναι κρίνουσα καὶ μόνοις χρῆσθαι δεσπόταις αὐτοὺς ἀξιοῦσα, δυοῖν τε τοῦτο τοῖν καλλίστοιν ἐξάγουσα δεῖγμα τοῦ τε τῇ Ῥωμαίων ἡγεμονίᾳ μηδεμίαν ἑτέραν ἀξίαν εἶναι παραβεβλῆσθαι φιλανθρωπίας τε εἵνεκα καὶ ἡμερότητος. Οὐ γὰρ ἂν αὐτοῖς οὕτως εὐνόει τοῦ τε σφόδρα μέλειν αὐτῇ οἷς κρίνασα ὁμολογήσει καὶ ὑπακούσει ἀνδρείας τε περιεῖναι καὶ ῥώμης, ὑφ' ὧν τοῖς μὲν ὡς ἀξίοις ὑπεῖκε, πολλῶν δ' ἄλλων ἐθνῶν ἐπιόντων περιεγίγνετο, καὶ μάλιστα τῶν νῦν ἐπικρατούντων βαρβάρων, οἵ, τὰ κύκλῳ πάντα καταστρεψάμενοι καὶ περὶ τὴν ἡμετέραν κατῳκημένοι, πολλάκις μὲν ἐπέβαλον, τοσαυτάκις δὲ ἀπεκρούσθησαν, ὡς πέτρᾳ τινὶ προσρήξαντες ἢ ὡς κάλω ῥαγέντος ὑπανεχώρησαν. Καὶ κατὰ μὲν τῶν ἄλλων ἴσχυσαν πάντων, μόνη δὲ ἡ ἡμετέρα κρείττων τε ὤφθη καὶ πᾶσιν ἀνάλωτος, καὶ τὰ μὲν περί που τὰ τῶν Ῥωμαίων βασίλεια καὶ ὅσα περὶ αὐτὸ τὸ Βυζάντιον ὡμολόγησαν τοῖς βαρβάροις καὶ τὴν δουλείαν ἐδέξαντο καὶ Ῥωμαίων οὐ πολὺν πεποίηντο λόγον, ἡμεῖς δ' ἐν ἐσχατιαῖς καὶ πρὸς αὐτοῖς τοῖς ὅροις καὶ πέρασι τῆς Ῥωμαίων ἀρχῆς ᾠκημένοι οὔτε τοὺς σφετέρους ἠρνήμεθα βασιλεῖς οὔθ' ὑφ' ἑτέρων, πολλὰ δυνηθέντων, ἡττήθημεν, ὡς ἂν πόρρω τε ζῶντες Ῥωμαίων καὶ ἢ καθ' αὑτοὺς ἄνευ τῆς ἐκείνων συμμαχίας ἀπειλημμένοι καὶ διὰ τοῦτο ὄντες εὐκαταγώνιστοι ἢ τὴν ἐκείνων ἐξελόντες αἰδῶ τῆς

Our city, however, in all seasons and amid every kind of upheaval, remains the same toward them, judging allegiance to the Romans more important than anything else, deeming them alone worthy to be her masters, and setting this forth as proof of two of the noblest things: first, that no other hegemony deserves to be compared with that of the Romans for humanity and gentleness—for otherwise she would not have borne them such goodwill—and second, that she cares deeply to keep faith with and obey those to whom she has once judged it right to pledge allegiance, while abounding in courage and strength, whereby she yielded to the Romans as worthy, yet prevailed over many other attacking nations, and above all over the barbarians who now hold sway. Though these have subdued all the surrounding lands and settled round about our territory, as many times as they have assaulted her, so many times have they been repulsed, retreating as though dashed against a rock, or recoiling backward as when a taut hawser snaps. Against all others they prevailed, whereas our city alone proved superior and impregnable to all; and while the districts lying near the imperial palace of the Romans and the lands around Byzantium itself came to terms with the barbarians, accepted servitude, and made little account of the Romans, we who dwell on the farthest frontier and at the very borders and limits of the Roman Empire have neither denied our own emperors nor been worsted by others of vast power—as might have befallen men living far from the Romans and either cut off by themselves

ψυχῆς, ἀλλ' ὡς ἂν πρός τε τοῖς αὐτῶν ὀφθαλμοῖς ἀγωνιζόμενοι, συνεπιρρωννύντων καὶ συμμαχούντων, οὕτω τήν τε πίστιν αὐτοῖς ἐτηρήσαμεν ἀκραιφνῆ καὶ τὴν εὔνοιαν ἀνδρείας τε μέγα σημεῖον ἐξενηνόχαμεν. Οὓς γὰρ οὐκ Ἀσία, οὐ Συρία, οὐκ Αἴγυπτος ἀντιβλέψαι δεδύνητο καὶ ὑφ' ὧν Παμφυλία καὶ Κιλικία καὶ Γαλατία δεδούλωτο καὶ οἷς τισι Καππαδοκία καὶ Ἀρμενία καὶ πᾶσα πόλις καὶ χώρα καὶ πᾶν γένος ἀνθρώπων ὑπεῖξαν, κατὰ μόνης οὗτοι τῆς ἡμετέρας οὐκ ἐνεανιεύσαντο πόλεως, οὐδ' ἴσχυσαν καὶ ταύτην καταδουλώσασθαι, ἀλλὰ ταῦτα μὲν ἀφεῖλον Ῥωμαίων καὶ τούτοις τὴν ἐκείνων ἐμείωσαν δύναμιν· ἐῶ γὰρ εἰπεῖν ὡς καὶ τῶν Εὐρωπαίων ὑφ' ἑαυτοὺς τὰ πλεῖστα πεποίηντο καὶ ὅσα νῦν οὐκ ἐν καιρῷ λέγειν· μόνης δὲ ταύτης τῆς ἡμετέρας ἡττήθησαν καὶ μόνην ἀνάλωτον ἔγνωσαν οὖσαν.

Οὕτω δυνάμεώς τε περιουσία καὶ πίστεως τὴν ἡμετέραν κατακοσμεῖ καὶ τῷ κεφαλαίῳ καλλωπιζόμεθα τῶν καλῶν, ἀληθείᾳ καὶ γενναιότητι. Τῶν τε γὰρ νυνὶ κρατούντων οὕτω περιεγένετο κἀν τοῖς ἀνωτέρω τούτων καιροῖς Πέρσαι τὸ κράτος ἔχοντες ἔτι πολλάκις μὲν ἐπειράθησαν, οὐδ' ἅπαξ δὲ κατ' αὐτῆς ἴσχυσαν. Τὴν γὰρ Κολχίδα καὶ Λαζικὴν γῆν, ἧς πάλαι τε προεῖχεν ἡ ἡμετέρα καὶ νῦν καθαρῶς ἄρχει, ὡς πάλαι τε σφῶν κατήκοος ἦν πεπυσμένοι καὶ ὡς μέγα σφίσι δουλωθεῖσαν αὖθις συντελέσειν τε καὶ συνδραμεῖσθαι πρὸς τὸ ῥᾳδίως ἐντεῦθεν τὴν Ῥωμαίων γῆν ἅπασαν καταδραμεῖν καὶ ληίσασθαι αὐτοί τε εἰδότες καὶ ἄλλων ἀκούοντες, οὐδὲ γὰρ οὐδ' αὐτὸ Βυζάντιον ἐάσειν ἀπόρθητον, ἀλλὰ καὶ τοῦτο αἱρήσειν, οὐδενὸς σφίσιν ἀντιστατοῦντος, οὐδὲν ὅ τι μὴ κατ' αὐτῆς ἐκίνησαν, καὶ σώμασι καὶ χρήμασι καὶ πλήθει στρατοῦ παρακινδυνεύοντες καὶ παραβαλλόμενοι ταῖς τε τῶν ὀρῶν δυσχωρίαις τοῖς τε στρατιώταις Ῥωμαίων, ἁπάντῶσιν ἐξ ὑπογυίου καὶ πειρωμένοις κωλύειν. Ἐπὶ γοῦν Ἰουστίνου τοῦ πρώτου Ῥωμαίων βασιλεύοντος Καβάδης ὁ Περσῶν βασιλεὺς Ἴβηρσί τε καὶ Γουργένῃ τῷ βασιλεῖ τῶν Ἰβήρων ἐπιστρατεύσας μέχρι τε Λαζικῆς αὐτοὺς καταδιώκει φυγόντας καὶ δύο Λαζικῆς ἔσχεν οὐ πολλῷ πόνῳ φρούρια, πρὸς αὐτοῖς εἰσιόντι τοῖς Λαζικῆς τε καὶ Ἰβηρίας ὅροις δεδομημένα.

without their alliance and therefore easy to subdue, or else having cast reverence for them out of their souls. Rather, just as though we were contending before their very eyes, with them cheering us on and fighting at our side, so have we kept our fidelity and goodwill toward them pure and unblemished, and set forth a great token of valor. For those whom neither Asia, nor Syria, nor Egypt was able to look in the face, by whom Pamphylia, Cilicia, and Galatia had been enslaved, and to whom Cappadocia, Armenia, and every city, land, and race of men yielded—against our city alone these men could not swagger in triumph, nor did they avail to enslave her as well; instead, while they wrested those lands from the Romans and thereby diminished their power—for I forbear to mention how they have also brought most of the European provinces under themselves, and all else that is unseasonable to speak of now—by this city of ours alone were they defeated, and her alone did they recognize to be impregnable.

Thus an abundance of both strength and fidelity adorns our city, and we pride ourselves upon the crowning summit of noble qualities: truth and nobility of spirit. For just as she thus prevailed over those who now hold power, so too in times earlier than these, when the Persians still held dominion, they made many attempts against her, yet not even once did they prevail. Having learned that the land of Colchis and Lazica—over which our city held preeminence of old and now exercises undisputed rule—had anciently been subject to themselves, and both knowing of themselves and hearing from others that, if subjugated anew, it would contribute and conduce greatly to their easily overrunning and plundering from there the entire Roman territory—for they reckoned they would not leave even Byzantium itself unravaged, but would capture it too with no one standing in their way—they left nothing untried against it, hazarding lives, treasure, and a multitude of troops, and exposing themselves both to the rugged fastnesses of the mountains and to the soldiers of the Romans, who met them promptly at short notice and strove to bar their way. Thus, during the reign of Justin the First over the Romans, Kavadh, king of the Persians, marched against the Iberians and their king Gourgenes, pursued them in their flight as far as Lazica, and without much toil seized two fortresses of Lazica

Χοσρόης τε ὁ Καβάδου, τὰ Ῥωμαίων Ἰουστινιανοῦ διευθύνοντος, ἠπείγετό τε προσωτέρω χωρεῖν καὶ σπουδὴν οὐ μικρὰν ἐποιεῖτο τὸ σύμπαν τε Λαζικῆς καὶ τὴν ἡμετέραν αὐτήν, εἰ οἷόν τε, καταδουλώσασθαι, ὡς τοῦτο ὂν αὐτῷ τῶν ἄθλων τὸ τελευταῖον καὶ τῆς ἀρχῆς ὁ ἔσχατος ὅρος, καὶ μεγάλῳ μὲν ἐσέβαλε πολλάκις στρατῷ, πλείω δὲ παθὼν ἢ δράσας, κακὸς κακῶς ἐκεῖθεν ἀπήλλαξεν. Οὐδὲ γὰρ οὐδὲν πλέον δυνηθεὶς ὅτι μὴ Πέτραν ἑλεῖν φρούριόν τι νεόδμητον, Ἰουστινιανῷ τῷ βασιλεῖ δομηθέν, εἶτα μετὰ πολλῆς ἐκεῖθεν ἀπηλάθη ζημίας, πολλούς τε καὶ ἀγαθοὺς ἀποβαλόμενος τῶν Περσῶν, Ῥωμαίων τε καὶ τῶν ἡμετέρων ἀντικρουσάντων πατέρων καὶ τὴν σφοδρὰν αὐτῶν ῥώμην ἐπισχόντων σφοδρότερον. Ὥστ' οὐχ ὅσον κακῶν ἀπαθὴς ἡ ἡμετέρα τετήρηται, οὐδ' ἄχρι Ῥιζαίου καὶ Ἀθηνῶν αὐτῶν προελθεῖν τῶν Περσῶν δυνηθέντων, ἀλλ' οὐδ' ἐπ' ἐξουσίας αὐτοῖς πρὸς τὰ οἰκεῖα καὶ γῆν τὴν σφετέραν ἐπανελθεῖν συνεχώρησεν, ἐν κομιδῇ μὲν στενοῖς καὶ δυσόδοις ἀπειλημμένοις χωρίοις, ἀξίαν δὲ δοῦσι δίκην Ῥωμαίοις ὧν πεπαρῳνήκεσαν εἰς αὐτούς, τῆς σφίσι μὴ προσηκούσης ἐπιβατεύοντες γῆς καὶ ἀλλοτρίαν ἐπικτώμενοι δύναμιν.

built right at the very borders of Lazica and Iberia as one enters.

And Khosrow, son of Kavadh, while Justinian was directing the affairs of the Romans, pressed eagerly to advance still farther and made no small effort to enslave the whole of Lazica and our city herself, if possible, regarding this as the crowning prize of his labors and the farthest boundary of his empire; and many times did he invade with a great army, yet having suffered more than he inflicted, he departed from there a wretch in wretched disgrace. For having availed to accomplish nothing more than the capture of Petra, a newly built fortress erected by the Emperor Justinian, he was subsequently driven out from there with heavy loss, forfeiting many brave Persians, as both the Romans and our own fathers struck back against them and checked their vehement might still more vehemently. Consequently, not only has our city been preserved unscathed by harm—the Persians not being able to advance even as far as Rhizaion and Pontic Athenai itself—but she did not even allow them to return freely to their homes and their own land, trapped as they were in exceedingly narrow and impassable defiles and paying the Romans a fitting penalty for the drunken insolence they had committed against them in trespassing upon a land that did not belong to them and grasping after another's dominion.

§ 21. [σ. 36–41] Οὕτως αὐτῇ τῶν τε ἐναντίων εἵμαρτο περιγίνεσθαι καὶ μετὰ πολλοῦ τοῦ κρείττονος ἀπαλλάττειν, κρείττονι γινομένῃ τῶν πάντοθεν κατ' αὐτῆς ἐπιόντων. Αὐτή τε γὰρ καθ' αὑτὴν ἄμαχος ἦν καὶ ἀήττητος οἷς ἠγωνίζετο, μηδενὸς συμμαχοῦντος, τῷ τ' ἐκ Βυζαντίου καὶ Ῥωμαίων στρατῷ κατὰ Περσῶν ἐνοχλούντων αὐτοῖς συμμαχοῦσα τοὺς μείζους τῶν ἀγώνων καὶ κρείττους οἰκεῖον ἑαυτῇ ἆθλον πεποίητο, ἡγουμένη τε καὶ παραδεικνῦσα καὶ τρόπους πολέμων καὶ τόπων εἰσόδους καὶ διόδους δυσχωριῶν, ὧν ἀκριβέστερον αὐτὴ πάντων πεπείρατο, ὡς ἂν τοῖς τε βαρβάροις ὅμορος οὖσα καὶ τὸν πρὸς αὐτοὺς πόλεμον πάλαι γεγυμνασμένη. Ὥσθ' ὧν αὐτή τε κατώρθου καὶ Ῥωμαῖοι ἐνίκων τὴν αἰτίαν αὕτη μόνη δικαίως ἂν ἀποφέροιτο καὶ τοῖς ἐντεῦθεν κοσμοῖτο στεφάνοις οὐχ ὅτι μόνον ἦρχε παντὸς ἀγαθοῦ καὶ παρεδείκνυ Ῥωμαίοις ἅπερ οὐκ ἦσαν εἰδότες αὐτοί, ἀλλ' ὅτι κἀνταῦθα τοὺς ἁπανταχόθεν ὑποδεχομένη στρατιώτας Ῥωμαίων καὶ πολλὰ ταῖς ὁδοιπορίαις

§ 21. [p. 36–41] Thus it was fated for her both to prevail over her adversaries and to come off with overwhelming advantage, proving superior to all who assailed her from every quarter. For by herself alone, with none to fight beside her, she was invincible and unconquered in the struggles she waged; and when fighting as an ally alongside the Roman army from Byzantium against the Persians who harassed them, she made the greatest and noblest of the contests her own personal prize, leading the way and pointing out the methods of warfare, the approaches to positions, and the passes through rugged terrain—things of which she had more exact experience than all others, seeing that she bordered on the barbarians and had been trained from of old in war against them. Consequently, both for her own successes and for the victories won by the Romans, she alone might justly claim the credit and be adorned with the crowns arising therefrom—not only because she initiated every good enterprise and showed the Romans what

ταλαιπωρήσαντας ἀναπαύουσα τῶν τε ἐπιτηδείων μεταδιδοῦσα καὶ τῶν ἀναγκαίων ἁπάντων, ἀκμῆτας αὐτοὺς ἐντεῦθεν ὡς ἔκ τινος ὁρμητηρίου καὶ ἐπιτειχίσματος, ἐπιθέσθαι τε τοῖς ἐχθροῖς ἐδίδου καὶ τὰ πλείω νικᾶν. Ἐδύνατο γὰρ δὴ τοῦτο μόνη τῶν ἄλλων ἡ ἡμετέρα, καὶ δυναμένη παντὸς μᾶλλον ἐβούλετο, τῶν ἄλλων τῶν μὲν ᾠκημένων ὡς πορρωτάτω πασῶν, ὥστ' οὐδὲν ἧττω τὸν πόνον εἶναι τῷ Ῥωμαίων στρατῷ, μέχρις αὐτῶν ἰοῦσι τῶν πολεμίων προκατειργασμένοις τε τὰ σώματα καὶ τὴν δύναμιν εὐχειρώτοις διὰ ταῦτα καθισταμένοις, τῶν δ' ἐγγὺς μὲν κειμένων, τὰ ἴσα δ' οὐ δυναμένων οὔτε μεγέθει καὶ κατασκευῇ πόλεως οὔτ' ἀφθονίᾳ τῶν ἐπιτηδείων καὶ ὅσων ἄνθρωποι χρῄζουσιν, ἐπ' ἀλλοτρίας οὐ διιόντες μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ διατρίβοντες. Εἰ δὴ κατορθοῦν μὲν οὐ μικρὸν οὐ μεῖζον ἔνι τῶν πολεμικῶν, μὴ πρότερον εὖ παρεσκευασμένους τὰ πάντα, πρὸς δὲ τὸ παρεσκευάσθαι καλῶς ἡ πόλις ἡμῶν οὐκ ὀλίγον Ῥωμαίοις παρ' ἑκάστους συνεβάλλετο τοὺς καιρούς, πῶς οὐχὶ καὶ τῶν ἐκείνοις κατορθωθέντων προσήκοι τῇ Τραπεζοῦντι καὶ διχῇ πλέκοιτο ταύτῃ τῶν ἐπαίνων ὁ στέφανος οἵς τε καθ' αὑτὴν διεγίνετο πάντων κρατοῦσα καὶ οἷς ἄλλοις ἐδίδου τὰς ἀφορμὰς τοῦ νικᾶν;

they did not know themselves, but also because, welcoming here the Roman soldiers gathered from every region, refreshing them after the heavy hardships of their marches, and sharing provisions and all necessities with them, she enabled them to set forth fresh and unwearied from here, as from a staging base and forward bulwark, to fall upon the enemy and for the most part prevail. For our city alone among all others had the power to do this, and having the power, desired it above all else: whereas of the remaining cities, some were situated farthest away of all, so that the toil was no less severe for the Roman troops, who by the time they reached the enemy themselves were already worn out in body and strength and thereby rendered easy to subdue; while others lay near at hand, yet were incapable of rendering the like service, whether in urban size and equipment or in abundance of supplies and of all that men require when they are not merely passing through a foreign land, but quartering there as well. If, then, it is impossible to achieve any success in warfare, small or great, unless men are first thoroughly prepared in every respect, and if on every occasion our city contributed in no small measure to the Romans' being well prepared, how should a share in their achievements not belong to Trebizond, and how should the crown of praises not be woven for her twofold—both for the constant triumphs she won over all by herself, and for supplying others with the means of victory?

Καὶ μήν, εἰ μὲν ἐν μέσῃ τῇ Ῥωμαίων ἀρχῇ κείμενοι κύκλῳ τε πόλεσι σφῶν ὑπηκόοις περιειλημμένοι, περιῆμέν τε τῶν ἐχθρῶν καὶ τοῖς ἐξ ἀρχῆς δεσπόταις τὴν εὔνοιαν καθαρὰν ἐτηροῦμεν, οὔτ' ἂν ἡμῖν ἐπαίνων μεγάλων προσήκειν ἔφη τις ἄν, οὔθ' ὡς ἐπὶ μεγάλῳ τινὶ κατορθώματι δικαίως ἂν ἐφρονοῦμεν· τῶν τε γὰρ κύκλῳ συντρεχόντων ἡμᾶς ἦν ἂν τὸ ἆθλον ἐν προβόλου τε μοίρᾳ καθεστώτων ἡμῖν καὶ τοὺς ἐπιόντας γενναίως ἀποκρουομένων, ἡμῖν τ' ἂν οὐδὲ πολλὰ βουλομένοις εἶχε καλῶς ἀφίστασθαι, μὴ ἔχουσι δίοδον· νῦν δ' ἐπ' αὐτοῖς ἤδη σχεδὸν τοῖς ὅροις Περσῶν καὶ Ῥωμαίων λαχόντες τὴν οἴκησιν αὐτοί τε προβεβλημένοι τῆς Ῥωμαίων γῆς ὅλης οὔτε πολλῶν καὶ πολλάκις ἐπιόντων ἡττήθημεν, ἀλλ' ὑφιστάμεθα τὰς προσβολὰς γενναιότατα, οὐ μόνον οὐδὲν ἄχαρι πάσχοντες, ἀλλὰ καὶ προσεργαζόμενοι τοὺς ἐχθρούς, εἰς ἀφρόν τε καὶ τὸ μηδὲν διαλυομένους ὡς κύματα πέτραις προβλῆσι προσράξαντα, οὔτε ῥᾴδιον ὂν

Furthermore, had we been situated in the heart of the Roman Empire, surrounded on every side by cities subject to its rule, and had we then prevailed over the enemy and preserved our loyalty pure toward our original sovereigns, neither would anyone say that great praises belonged to us, nor could we justly have prided ourselves as upon some great achievement: for the prize would have belonged to those rallying around us on all sides, standing as a bulwark before us and nobly repulsing the assailants, while even had we greatly wished to revolt, it would not have been feasible for us, lacking any way out. As it is, however, having been allotted our dwelling almost upon the very marches between Persians and Romans, and standing ourselves as the forward rampart of the entire Roman land, we neither succumbed when multitudes attacked us time and again—nay, we withstand their assaults most nobly, not only suffering nothing untoward, but even inflicting

βουλομένοις καὶ τοὺς ἄσμενος ἂν ἡμᾶς δεξομένους ἐπὶ ἴσῃ τε καὶ ὁμοίᾳ ἔχουσιν ἐγγυτάτω πρὸς ἀποστασίαν ἀπείδομεν ἢ γοῦν ἐννοῆσαί ποτ' ἐπῆλθε τοῖς πατράσιν ἡμῶν. Καίτοι, εἰ πίστις ἐστὶν ἄνθρωπος καὶ ἀλήθεια καὶ τὸ τοῖς ἐξ ἀρχῆς δεδογμένοις ἐμμένειν καὶ τὰ ὁμωμοσμένα τηρεῖν, οὕτως ἐπὶ πλεῖστον τῆς ἀνθρώπῳ προσηκούσης ἀρετῆς οἱ ἡμέτεροι προκεχωρήκεσαν πρόγονοι, εἴτε καὶ ἀνδρεία τὰ γένη κοσμεῖ καὶ γενναιότης προσήκει ψυχαῖς ἀνθρωπίναις, οὕτω καὶ ταύτῃ τὸ συγκεχωρηκὸς εἶχον καὶ τὴν ἐντεῦθεν νίκην ἀναμφίβολον ἑαυτοῖς κατεστήσαντο. Πρὸς γὰρ δὴ τῷ ταῦτα δυνηθῆναι κατορθῶσαι, ἃ τοὺς ἐν μέσοις Ῥωμαίους ἐχρῆν, ἔτι καὶ μεῖζον ἐκείνων δεδύνηνται, μείναντες αὐτῶν ἀπαθέστεροι καὶ πιστότεροι.

Τἆλλα μὲν γὰρ ἅπαντα περιεῖλον οἱ βάρβαροι καὶ τοὺς Ῥωμαίους ἀφείλοντο, τὰ μὲν ἐξαιροῦντες νόμῳ πολέμου, τοὺς δ' αὐτοὺς προσθεμένους καὶ σφᾶς ἐνδόντας δουλώσαντες, μόνη δὲ ἡ ἡμετέρα ἐπεδίδου τε μᾶλλον καὶ ηὔξανε καὶ τὸ καθ' αὑτὴν ἀμείωτον ἐτήρει τὴν Ῥωμαίων ἡγεμονίαν, οὔτε πολέμου νόμῳ τῶν ἐχθρῶν ἡττηθεῖσα οὔτε τῶν ἐξ ἀρχῆς ἀγαθῶν λογισμῶν καταγνοῦσα καὶ πρὸς τοὺς ἐναντίους ὥσπερ αὐτομολήσασα, ἀλλὰ μένουσα μὲν ἐφ' οἷς ἅπαξ ἔγνω μενετέον αὐτήν, ταῖς δὲ κατὰ μικρὸν αὐξομέναις προσθήκαις ἀνθρώπων τε πλήθει τῶν τε ἐκεῖ γεννωμένων τῶν τε ἄλλοθεν ἐπιγινομένων, οὓς πολλοὺς εἶναι ἀνάγκη, πολιορκουμένους μὲν πάντοθεν, εἰς αὐτὴν δ' ὡς εἰς ἀσφαλὲς κρησφύγετον καταφεύγοντας καὶ ἄλλως εὑρόντας τῶν αὐτῆς ἀγαθῶν καὶ οἷς τὸ ἐνοικοῦν τρέφει καὶ ἀναψύχει τεχνῶν τε καὶ ἐπιτηδευμάτων ἀσκήσει παντοίων, ὅσαι τε τῶν βαναύσων καὶ ὅσαι τῶν ἐλευθερίων ἀνδρῶν καὶ ψυχῶν, οὐ πρὸς χρείαν συντελοῦσαι μόνον ἀνθρώποις καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ συνίστασθαι, ἀλλὰ καὶ τὸν μετιόντα κοσμοῦσαι καὶ ἦθος καὶ ἀγωγὴν καὶ πολιτείας βελτίωσιν, ἔτι τε τειχῶν παραυξήσει καὶ περιβολῇ μειζόνων μὲν ἢ τὸ πρίν, ἐχυρότητος δ' εἵνεκα καὶ πρὶν προεχόντων. Ἀπῆν γὰρ ὅλως οὐδὲν ἢ μᾶλλον ἦν οὐδέν, ὃ μὴ τὸ μὲν ἤδη παρὸν ἦν αὐτῇ τῶν καλῶν, τὸ δ' ἔμελλε. Τὸ γὰρ πεπρωμένον αὐτῇ καὶ ἡ μοῖρα συνεφόρει πᾶν ἀγαθόν, τὰ μὲν ἤδη καὶ

loss upon the foe besides, as they dissolve into foam and nothingness like waves dashing against jutting crags—nor, easy though it would have been had we wished, and though we had right at our doorstep those who would gladly have received us on equal and like terms, did we ever look toward defection, or did it ever so much as enter our fathers' minds to conceive of it. Yet surely, if what makes a human being is good faith and truth, abiding by what was resolved from the beginning, and keeping sworn oaths, to such a supreme degree had our ancestors advanced in the virtue proper to man; or if courage adorns nations and nobility befits human souls, in this respect too they held undisputed preeminence and secured for themselves an unquestioned victory therein. For besides proving able to accomplish what it behooved the Romans in the interior of the empire to do, they achieved something greater still than those men, remaining both more unscathed and more faithful than they.

For all the remaining lands the barbarians stripped away and wrested from the Romans, capturing some by the law of war and enslaving others whose inhabitants went over of their own accord and surrendered themselves; our city alone grew all the more and increased, preserving the Roman dominion undiminished so far as lay in her power, neither vanquished by the enemy under the law of war nor renouncing her original noble principles and, as it were, deserting to the adversaries. Instead, she stood firm upon the resolve by which she had once judged she must abide, while thriving through gradually mounting increments: in abundance of inhabitants, both native-born and newcomers arriving from elsewhere—who were bound to be numerous, beleaguered as they were on every side and fleeing to her as to a secure refuge, and otherwise finding a share in her blessings and in all whereby she nourishes and refreshes her populace; in the practice of crafts and pursuits of every kind, both the manual trades and those belonging to liberal men and souls, which contribute not merely to human necessity and bare subsistence, but also adorn him who pursues them in character, conduct, and the improvement of civic life; and further, in the enlargement and circuit of walls greater than of old, though even formerly preeminent for strength. Indeed, nothing whatever was lacking—or rather, there was no fair blessing that was not either

προδεικνῦσα, πρὸς ἃ δ' αὐτὴν εὐτρεπίζουσα ὅσα μήπω παρεῖναι τὸ τοῦ χρόνου συνεχώρει φερόμενον καὶ ἡ τοῦ μέλλοντος μέλησις. Καὶ γοῦν πολλὰ τῶν ἐν τῷ μέλλοντι ταττομένων καὶ ἃ ἂν οὐδεὶς ἤλπισε παρήγαγέ τε καὶ ὡς ἂν οὐδεὶς οὐδ' ἂν ηὔξατο οὐχ ὅτι μὴ προσῆκεν αὐτῇ μηδὲ τὰ προσόντα οἱ κἀκεῖνα ἠνάγκαζον, ἀκόλουθά τε ὄντα καὶ οἷς φθάσασα ἔσχεν ἑπόμενά τε καὶ σύμφωνα, ἀλλ' ὅτι, πάντων ἤδη σχεδὸν ἀπολωλότων τῶν τῇδε Ῥωμαίων, ταύτην οὐχ ὅσον περιγενέσθαι, ἀγαπητὸν ὂν καὶ τοῦτο καὶ οὐκ ἂν ἐλαχίστης εὐδαιμονίας τεκμήριον, ἀλλὰ κἀπὶ τοσοῦτον ἀρθῆναι καὶ δόξης καὶ εὐτυχίας οὐδ' ἐλπίσαι γοῦν εἶχεν ἀσφάλειαν· ἀλλ' ἡ συνέχουσ' αὐτὴν ἄνωθεν ἀγαθὴ τύχη τοῖς τε ἄλλοις κεκόσμηκέ τε καὶ τιμῶσα διατελεῖ τῶν τε ἐς δόξαν φερόντων τὸ μέγιστον ἐπέθηκε φέρουσα καὶ βασιλείας αὐτῇ περιθεμένη διάδημα καὶ ἀξίωμα, βασίλειον αὐτὴν ἡμῖν ὡς πάλαι τοῖς πράγμασι καὶ οἷς διετέλει οὕτω ποιοῦσα, νῦν καὶ τῇ κλήσει παρασκευάσασα λέγεσθαι.

already hers or destined to be. For her allotted destiny and fate gathered every good thing together for her, displaying some already before the eye and readying her for others which the onward sweep of time and care for the future did not yet permit to be present. And indeed, Fate brought forth many things reserved in the future—things no one would have hoped for, and in a manner no one would even have dared pray for: not because they did not befit her, or because her existing endowments did not compel those too as natural sequels consequent and harmonious with what she already possessed, but because, when nearly all the Romans in these parts had already perished, there was no safe ground even to hope that this city would not merely survive—welcome though even that would have been, and a token of no slight felicity—but be raised to such a height of glory and good fortune. Yet the good fortune sustaining her from on high has both adorned her with every other gift and continues to honor her, crowning her with the greatest of all things that conduce to glory; and by investing her with the diadem and dignity of empire, it has caused her now to be called for us an imperial capital in title as well, just as long ago she proved herself to be in deed and by her constant conduct.

Ἔδει γὰρ δὴ τὴν τοσοῦτο πίστει καὶ δυνάμει διενεγκοῦσαν, ὡς μήτε βιασθεῖσαν μήτ' ἐθελοκακήσασαν προσθέσθαι τοῖς ἐναντίοις αὑτήν θ' ἑαυτὴν καὶ τὰς ἄλλας τὸ καθ' αὑτὴν Ῥωμαίοις φυλάξασαν μὴ τῆς ἀρχῆς μόνον τοῖς βασιλεῦσιν ἡμῖν ὑπερασπιστήν τε καὶ πρόβολον, ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτοῦ σώματος αὐτοῖς γεγονέναι, ἐν σωματοφυλάκων καθεστῶσαν αὐτοῖς μοίρᾳ. Εἴτε γὰρ εὐνοοῦσιν ἀνδράσι σφᾶς αὐτοὺς θαρρεῖν δεῖ τοὺς ἄρχοντας, οὕτω θαυμαστὰ πίστεως ἐν παντὶ τῷ χρόνῳ ἐξήνεγκε δείγματα, εἴτ' ἀνδρείᾳ καὶ ῥώμῃ σωμάτων οὕτω διήνεγκε γενναιότητι, εἴτ' ἀμφοῖν, καὶ δυνάμει καὶ πίστει, οὐκ οἶδ' εἴ τις ἐς ἴσον ἔλθοι τῇ ἡμετέρᾳ. Βασίλειά τε γοῦν ἐν αὐτῇ λαμπρῶς ᾠκοδόμηται, καὶ κρατεῖν ἀντὶ τοῦ δουλεύειν ᾑρέθη, καὶ βασιλέων διαδοχαὶ τῶν πάντα γενναίων ἡμᾶς κεκοσμήκασιν, αὐτοῦ τε τὸν πάντα χρόνον διατριβόντων ἐντεῦθέν τε κατὰ τῶν ἐχθρῶν ἐξιόντων καὶ ὡς ἡμᾶς αὖθις ἐπανιόντων κἀντεῦθεν ἀρχόντων τῶν ὑπὸ χεῖρα καὶ βασιλέων οὐχ οἷς ἄν τις καὶ προστρίψαιτο μῶμον οὐδὲ τῶν πάντα φιλοσκωμμόνων. Κομνηνιάδαι γὰρ ἡμῖν οἱ δεσπόται καὶ βασιλεῖς καὶ τῆς τῶν Κομνηνῶν ῥίζης

For it was altogether fitting that she who had so excelled in loyalty and might as neither under compulsion nor through faintheartedness to go over to the enemy, and who had preserved both her own self and the other cities, so far as lay in her, for the Romans, should become for our emperors the champion and bulwark not merely of their realm, but of their very persons as well, standing in the rank of their bodyguards. For whether rulers must entrust themselves to devoted men—so wondrous are the proofs of fidelity she has displayed throughout all time—or whether to courage and bodily strength—so greatly has she excelled in valor—or whether to both might and loyalty together, I know not if any city could rival ours. Accordingly, an imperial palace has been splendidly built within her, she has been chosen to rule rather than to serve, and successions of emperors noble in all things have graced us, residing right here throughout all time, sallying forth from here against the enemy, returning to us once more, and from here governing their subjects—emperors upon whom not even the most inveterate fault-finders could cast a blemish. For our sovereigns and emperors are

κάλλιστον ἔρνος καὶ πρέμνος μάλα προσήκων τῇ ῥίζῃ καὶ οἷος ἂν γένοιτο πάνυ τοι συμβαίνων τῷ φύσαντι οὐκ ἀπὸ γένους μᾶλλον ἢ τοῦ τρόπου τῆς ἀρχῆς ἄξιοι καὶ τοῦ τῆς βασιλείας ὀνόματος. Τό τε γὰρ γένος αὐτοῖς καὶ σφόδρα τῷ τῆς ἀρχῆς ὄγκῳ συνᾴδον ἥ τε ἀρετὴ καὶ τῶν πράξεων ἡ λαμπρότης οὐδέσι προσῆκεν ὅτι μὴ βασιλεῦσι καὶ δεσπόταις ἀνθρώπων, ὥστ' εἶναι καὶ τὸν τρόπον αὐτοῖς οἷον θαυμάζεσθαι τό τε γένος οὐκ ὀλίγα κοσμεῖν ἔχειν αὐτούς τε καὶ τοὺς σφίσι δουλεύοντας, ὑφ' ὧν τῆς τε βασιλείας ἐκρίθησαν ἄξιοι καὶ τῷ δήμῳ Ῥωμαίων ἀσμένῳ τε ἀνερρήθησαν καὶ κριθέντες οὐκ ἔψευσαν τῶν ἐλπίδων τοὺς ἑλομένους, οὔτε μετάμελον παρέσχον αὐτῆς τῆς αἱρέσεως. Ἄνδρες γὰρ οὗτοι καὶ πρὸ τῆς βασιλείας τὰ βασιλείας πράττοντες ἄξια καὶ μήπω τὸ διάδημα περικείμενοι τῶν ἐν τηβέννῃ τε καὶ πορφύρᾳ περιειλημμένων οὐδὲν διαφέροντες ὅσα γ' ἐς τὴν τῶν κοινῶν φροντίδα καὶ ἐπιμέλειαν καὶ στρατιωτικὴν ἐμπειρίαν καὶ πολέμους καὶ ἆθλα καὶ ἀγωνίσματα, μᾶλλον δ' αὐτοὶ ταῦτα διαχειριζόμενοι πάντα, καθευδόντων τῶν βασιλέων καὶ βαθὺν ὕπνον ὑπνούντων καὶ τοὺς μὲν πόνους οἰκείους αὑτῶν, τὰ δ' ἆθλα τῶν βασιλέων ποιούμενοι, τόν τε δῆμον τῆς ἑαυτῶν ἀνῆψαν ἀγάπης, συνιόντας ὅστις ἀληθής ἐστι βασιλεὺς καὶ ὅτῳ προσήκει τὰ ἆθλα σφῶν τε αὐτῶν αὐτοὺς δικαιοῦντας βασιλεύειν τε καὶ προϊστασθαι ὡς μόνους ἀξίους, αὐτοί τε ὑπέρ τε τοῦ γένους καὶ ὅπως μὴ παντελῶς ἀπόλωνται Ῥωμαίοις τὰ πράγματα τὴν ἡγεμονίαν ἐδέξαντο.

Ἤδη γὰρ ἐπὶ γόνυ τε ἔκλιναν καὶ παντελῶς ἐκεκμήκει τὰ τῆς εὐτυχίας τῷ γένει καὶ ὑπορρεῖν ἤρξατο καὶ ἐνδιδόναι τῷ χρόνῳ καὶ ταῖς ἐκεῖθεν μεταβολαῖς, τῶν μὲν βασιλέων κατερᾳστωνευμένον βίον βιούντων, τῶν δ' ἐναντίων ἀγωνιζομένων καὶ ἀγρυπνούντων. Ἀσίαν τε γὰρ κατέτρεχον οἱ βάρβαροι πᾶσαν καὶ τὰ ταύτης ἀδεῶς περιέκειρον κάλλη, μηδενὸς ἐμποδὼν ἱσταμένου, καὶ τὴν Σκυθῶν ἐρημίαν τὰ τῇδε πάντα πεποίηντο, οὐδαμοῦ τὴν οἰκείαν πλεονεξίαν ὁρίζοντες, ἀλλ' ἑξῆς πάντα καταστρεφόμενοι μέχρις αὐτῆς Χαλκηδόνος καὶ τῆς ἀντιπέρας ἠπείρου τῇ Βυζαντίδι, πρὶν ἐπ' αὐτὴν καταβῆναι τὴν θάλασσαν τῆς ἐπὶ τὰ πρόσω φορᾶς οὐκ ἀνακοπτόμενοι. Ἐκ μὲν γὰρ Αἰγύπτου Σαρακηνοί, Τοῦρκοι δ' ἐξ αὐτῆς τῆς Περσίδος ὁρμώμενοι καὶ τῶν ἔτι κατωτέρω μερῶν, οἱ μὲν Συρίαν καὶ Παλαιστίνην καὶ Παμφυλίαν, οἱ δὲ τὰ μεταξὺ πάντα μέχρις αὐτῆς

Komneniadai, the fairest scion of the root of the Komnenoi and a trunk well worthy of that root, altogether matching its sire, worthy of sovereignty and of the title of empire no more by birth than by character. Indeed, their lineage is wholly consonant with the majesty of empire, while their virtue and the splendor of their deeds befitted none save emperors and lords of men; thus their character is such as to command wonder, and their lineage has abundant power to adorn both themselves and those subject to them—by whom they were judged worthy of the throne and joyfully proclaimed by the Roman people, and once chosen, neither disappointed the hopes of those who elected them nor gave cause to regret that choice itself. For even before ascending the throne these men performed deeds worthy of empire; though not yet wearing the diadem, they differed in naught from those arrayed in imperial robe and purple so far as concerned care and solicitude for public affairs, military skill, wars, feats, and contests—nay rather, they managed all these matters themselves while the emperors slumbered and slept a deep sleep, making the labors their own and the prizes the emperors'. Thus they kindled the people with love for them, as men perceived who was the true emperor and to whom the prizes belonged, and deemed it right that they alone, as solely worthy, should reign over them and stand at their head; and they themselves accepted the supreme command on behalf of the race and lest the Roman state perish utterly.

For already the good fortune of our race had sunk to its knees and grown utterly exhausted, beginning to ebb away and yield to time and its vicissitudes, while the emperors lived a life of indolent ease and our enemies strove and kept sleepless watch. Indeed, the barbarians were overrunning all Asia and fearlessly shearing off her beauties with none to stand in their way, turning this whole region into a Scythian wilderness; setting no bound anywhere to their greed, they subjugated everything in succession right up to Chalcedon itself and the mainland opposite Byzantium, unchecked in their onward rush before descending to the very sea. For Saracens setting forth from Egypt, and Turks from Persia itself and the regions still further beyond, had through the absence of anyone to hinder them reduced to subjection and slavery—the former Syria, Palestine, and Pamphylia, and the latter all the lands between right up

Βιθυνίας ἐρημίᾳ τῇ τοῦ κωλύσοντος ὑποχείρια σφίσι καὶ δοῦλα πεποίηντο, ὡς καὶ αὐτὸν τὸν βασιλέα Ῥωμαίων ἀπαγαγεῖν δοριάλωτον Ῥωμανὸν τὸν καὶ Διογένην ἐπικληθέντα, τήν τε Εὐρώπην καὶ τὰ πρὸς ἥλιον δύνοντα πάντα λόγῳ μὲν εἶχον Ῥωμαῖοι, ἔργῳ δ' ἐκαρποῦντο Σκύθαι καὶ Οὖννοι καὶ Πατζινάκων τινῶν ἔθνος καὶ οὐκ οἶδ' εἴ τινες ἄλλοι πάντοθεν ἐπιόντες καὶ Μυσῶν λείαν πάντα τιθέμενοι. Ῥωμαῖοι δὲ καὶ Ῥωμαίων οἱ βασιλεῖς μέχρι τοῦ περιβαλέσθαι πορφύραν καὶ τὸ διάδημα ἀναδήσασθαι τῶν τε οἰκείων ἀπολαύειν ὀρέξεων τὴν βασιλείαν ὁρίζοντες τά τε χρήματα οὐκ εἰς δέον ἀνηλωκότες ἐν στενῷ κομιδῇ τὰ ταμιεῖα σφίσι συνήλασαν, ὧν πολλῶν δεῖ πολέμῳ καὶ τοῖς πολεμικοῖς πράγμασι. Τά τε τοῦ στρατοῦ καὶ λίαν αὐτοῖς εἶχε κακῶς, οὐδεμιᾶς ἀξιομάχου στρατιᾶς εὐποροῦσιν, οὔτε πλήθει νικώντων, οὔτε προὐχόντων ἀσκήσει. Εἵς τε γὰρ εὐαριθμήτους αὐτοῖς ὁ στρατὸς συνηλάθη, ἀσκήσεώς τε ἕνεκα καὶ τῆς κατὰ πόλεμον ἐμπειρίας οὐδὲν αὐτοὺς γηπόνων ἀνδρῶν διαφέρειν ἡ τῶν βασιλέων τρυφὴ καὶ ῥᾳστώνη καὶ ὁ ἀνειμένος εἰργάσατο βίος. Ἐλπίς τε οὖν ἀγαθῶν ἦν οὐδεμία τῷ γένει, ἀλλὰ τόν τε περὶ ψυχῆς ἔτρεχον ἤδη κἀπὶ ξυροῦ σφίσιν εἱστήκει τὰ πράγματα καὶ ἔδει καθῆσθαι, τὸν τελευταῖον ἀναμένοντας ὄλεθρον.

Ἀλλὰ θεός, ἄνωθεν ὑπερσχὼν χεῖρα καὶ λαβόμενος οἶκτον ἡμῶν, τούς τε Κομνηνιάδας ἡμῖν ἐβασίλευσε καὶ δι' αὐτῶν ἐπανήγαγεν αὖθις τῷ γένει τὴν εὐτυχίαν καὶ τὴν ἧτταν ἀνεμαχήσατο καὶ τὰ ἀπολωλότα πάλιν ἐπανεσώσατο, τότε μὲν εὐθὺς Ἀλέξιον προβαλόμενος τὸν πάντ' ἄριστον καὶ γενναῖον, ἆθλον ἀρετῆς καὶ ὧν στρατηγῶν κατωρθώκει τὴν βασιλείαν εὑράμενον, ἔπειτα δὲ τὴν ἐξ ἐκείνου χρυσῆν ὄντως σειρὰν ἐπιστήσας Ῥωμαίοις. Οἵ, τοῦτο δὴ τὸ τοῦ Δημοσθένους καλῶς εἰρῆσθαι νομίσαντες, πάντα δεῖν ἄνδρα καὶ πᾶσαν πόλιν τὴν αἰτίαν εὑρόντας ὅθεν ἥττους ἑαυτῶν ἐγεγόνεισαν εἶτα βαδίσαι τὴν ἐναντίαν ὡς οὕτως ἐπανακαλεσομένους τὴν ἧτταν, σκεψάμενοί τε τοὺς πρὸ αὐτῶν βασιλεύσαντας ἀντὶ τρυφῆς καὶ βλακείας ὀλίγης τὰ πάντα διειργασμένους, αὐτοὶ βίον ἐργατικὸν καὶ πιναρὸν ἀνελάβοντο καὶ σκηνήτην, ὀλίγα μὲν ταῖς πόλεσι, τὰ πλεῖστα δ' ἐπὶ στρατοπέδου καθεύδοντες καὶ τὸν πάντα βίον ἐπὶ πολέμου καὶ παρατάξεων διατετριφότες, ἐναγώνιόν τε ζωὴν ἔζησαν καὶ τὴν πολιτείαν ὤρθωσαν ἤδη Ῥωμαίοις, τὸ

to Bithynia itself, going so far as to lead off captive of the spear the very Emperor of the Romans, Romanos, surnamed Diogenes; meanwhile Europe and all the regions toward the setting sun belonged to the Romans in name, whereas in fact they were being plundered by Scythians, Huns, a nation of Pechenegs, and I know not what other peoples attacking from every side and making everything the proverbial prey of the Mysians. Yet the Romans and the Emperors of the Romans, defining imperial rule no further than donning the purple, binding on the diadem, and indulging their personal appetites, squandered their revenues to no good purpose and reduced to utter straits the treasuries, of which abundant store is needed for war and military operations. Their military affairs, too, were in a wretched plight, as they possessed no battle-worthy army of men either prevailing by numbers or excelling in training: for their host had shrunk to a handful easily counted, while in point of drill and experience in war the luxury, sloth, and dissolute life of the emperors had rendered them no different from tillers of the soil. Thus there remained no hope of good for the nation: already they were running the race for their very lives, their affairs balanced upon a razor's edge, and nothing seemed left save to sit idle awaiting final destruction.

But God, stretching forth His protecting hand from on high and taking pity upon us, raised the Komneniadai to reign over us, and through them restored good fortune once more to our race, retrieved its defeat, and recovered what had been lost—putting forward straightway at that time Alexios, noblest and best in all things, who won the throne as the prize of virtue and of the triumphs he had achieved as general, and thereafter setting over the Romans the truly golden chain sprung from him. Deeming that famous maxim of Demosthenes well spoken—that every man and every city must discover the cause whereby they fell short of themselves and then tread the opposite path, since thus they will reverse their defeat—and observing that those who had reigned before them had ruined the whole state for the sake of brief luxury and indolence, they themselves embraced a strenuous, weather-beaten, and tent-dwelling life. Sleeping seldom in the cities and mostly in camp, and spending their entire lives in war and pitched battles, they lived a life of unceasing struggle and set the commonwealth upright again for the Romans; purging

πολέμιον ἅπαν περικαθήραντες, ἔκ τε Ἀσίας ἔκ τε Εὐρώπης αὐτοὺς ἀπήλασαν ὡς πορρωτάτω καὶ πολλὴν ἀνακωχὴν καὶ βαθεῖαν γαλήνην ἡμῖν ἐπορίσαντο, ἀνασωσάμενοί τε τὰ πράγματα καὶ πνεῦμα ζωῆς ὥσπερ ἐμπεπνευκότες τοῖς πράγμασιν ἤδη νενεκρωμένοις καὶ τελέως ἀπεσβηκόσι.

away every hostile force, they drove the foe as far off as possible from both Asia and Europe, procuring for us a long respite and profound calm, rescuing the state and breathing, as it were, the breath of life into affairs already dead and utterly extinguished.

§ 22. [σ. 41–48] Ταύτης δὴ τῆς πάντ' ἀρίστης καὶ γενναίας μὲν ῥίζης, γενναιοτέρων δὲ πρέμνων καὶ οἱ τὴν ἡμετέραν κοσμοῦντες ἤρτηνται βασιλεῖς καὶ πρὸς τοιούτους ἔχουσιν ἀναφέρειν προγόνους, οὕτω μὲν τὴν πολιτικὴν ἐπιστήμην ἀρίστους, οὕτω δὲ τὰ πολεμικὰ πάντων κρατίστους, οὕτω δὲ διὰ πάντων διήκοντας καὶ καλῶν ἄγαλμα πάντων τὴν σφετέραν καταστησαμένους ψυχήν. Ἀλέξιος μέν γε καὶ ἡμῖν, ὁ πρῶτος τῆς γῆς ταυτησὶ βασιλεύσας, καὶ τοῦτο δὴ τὸ γλυκὺ πάντων ὄνομα καὶ ἡμῖν, ὡς τοῦ τῆς βασιλείας ὀνόματος, οὕτω δὴ καὶ πάντων κατῆρξε καλῶν. Οὗτος υἱωνὸς μὲν ὑπῆρχεν Ἀνδρονίκου τοῦ Κομνηνοῦ, βασιλεύσαντος μὲν καὶ αὐτοῦ τῶν Ῥωμαίων, τὸ δ' οἰκεῖον ἀναφέροντος γένος οὗ καὶ ὁ πρῶτος Ἀλέξιος· μέγας δὲ Κομνηνὸς κεκλημένος, οὐδὲν ἧττον καὶ τοῖς ἔργοις ἦν μέγας, οὐ μᾶλλον ὀνόματος ἢ τῆς τῶν Κομνηνῶν ἀρετῆς αὐτός τε κληρονόμος γενόμενος καὶ τοὺς ἐξ ἑαυτοῦ τοιούτους ἑτέρους ἡμῖν ἀναφήνας, ἀγαθοὺς ἐξ ἀγαθῶν καὶ ἐξ ἀρίστων ἀρίστους, πάντας βασιλικούς, πάντας τῷ γένει συμβαίνοντας, πάντας ἐκείνου τοῦ χαρακτῆρος καὶ τῆς ὁμοίας εἰκόνος, πάντας ἀλλήλοις ἐρίζοντας, ἀλλήλοις ἁμιλλωμένους ὅστις αὐτὸς φθάσει πλείω κατωρθωκὼς ἀγαθὰ καὶ μεταδώσει τοῖς ὑπὸ χεῖρα. Τήν τε γὰρ πόλιν ἡμῖν οὐ μικροῖς ὅροις ἐπηύξησαν, ἀντ' ἀρχομένης ἄρχουσαν καταστήσαντες καὶ ἀντὶ τοῦ δουλεύειν ἑτέρους πολλοὺς ἄλλους δουλώσασαν, σχῆμά τε μητροπόλεως πρὸς τὰ κύκλῳ πάντα καὶ τὴν σύμπασαν Λαζικὴν σχοῦσαν, τό τε ὑπήκοον ἐννόμου βασιλείας ἐπιστασίᾳ καὶ πλήθει καὶ πλούτῳ καὶ τῇ κατὰ πολέμους ἀνδρείᾳ καὶ γενναιότητι βέλτιον αὐτὸ ἑαυτοῦ ἀπειργάσαντο καὶ προήγαγον εἰς ἐπίδοσιν.

§ 22. [p. 41–48] From this root, peerless in all things and noble, and from trunks nobler still, depend the emperors who adorn our city as well, and to such ancestors can they trace back their lineage—men consummate in statesmanship, mightiest of all in warfare, accomplished in every sphere, who fashioned their own souls into an image of every excellence. Indeed, for us too it was an Alexios who first reigned as emperor over this land, and for us too that sweetest name of all inaugurated every blessing, even as it inaugurated the title of empire. He was the grandson of Andronikos Komnenos, who had himself reigned over the Romans and traced his lineage to the same stock as the first Alexios; styled Grand Komnenos, he was no less grand in his deeds, proving himself heir no more to the name than to the virtue of the Komnenoi, and raising up from his loins successors of the selfsame stamp for us—good men sprung from good, best from best, all kingly, all true to their lineage, all bearing that unmistakable die and like image, all vying and competing with one another as to who should be first to achieve more good works and impart them to his subjects. For they enlarged our city within no narrow bounds, transforming her from a subject into a sovereign state, from serving others into subjugating many other peoples, and into holding the rank of metropolis over all the surrounding lands and the entirety of Lazica; and under the stewardship of lawful monarchy they rendered their subject people better than its former self in numbers, wealth, and courage and gallantry in war, leading it ever onward in prosperity.

Φιλοῦσι μὲν γὰρ αὐτοὺς οἷα παῖδας πατήρ, οὐ μᾶλλον ἀρχόντων ἢ γονέων ἐπιδεικνύμενοι σπλάγχνα, φροντίζουσι δὲ τῆς αὐτῶν βελτιώσεως καὶ μᾶλλον ἢ παίδων γονεῖς, τὸ μὲν αὐτῶν τι κηδόμενοι, τὸ δὲ καὶ σφῶν αὐτῶν προνοούμενοι. Μᾶλλον γὰρ ἂν οἴονται καὶ καθαρώτερον βασιλεύσειν, ἂν ὡς ὅ τι βελτίστων κρατῶσι τῶν ἀρχομένων. Τοσοῦτο γοῦν

For they love their subjects as a father loves his children, showing the tender affection of parents rather than of rulers, and they care for their improvement even more than parents do for their children, partly out of solicitude for them and partly taking forethought for themselves as well; for they believe they will reign more truly and purely if the subjects over whom they rule are

εὐνοίας ὅ τε δῆμος εἰσφέρει τοῖς βασιλεῦσιν οἵ τε τῶν ἐν τέλει, μὴ καταψευδόμενοι τοῦ ὀνόματος, ὅσον οὐκ οἶδ' εἰ παῖδες πατράσιν, ἀνθ' ὧν οὔθ' ἡμῖν οἱ κρατοῦντες ἠλλάξαντο τὸ ὑπήκοον, ὡς ἂν ἡμῶν καταγνόντες, ὅτι μὴ μᾶλλον σφίσι προσαύξουσι τὴν ἀρχήν, ἐντεῦθεν τὰ βάρβαρα γένη φοβοῦντες, οὔθ' ἡμεῖς ἠλλαξάμεθα τοὺς δεσπότας, ἑτέρους ἐπιζητήσαντες ὡς ἂν ἀχθεσθέντες αὐτοῖς. Ἀλλὰ τὸ Κομνηνῶν γένος καὶ οἱ ἐξ αὐτῶν ἡμῶν ἄρχουσι χρόνον ἤδη τοσοῦτον καὶ τοσαύτης διαδοχῆς παρελθούσης, ὃ μόνον αὐτῶν ἴδιον καὶ οὐκ ἄλλῳ τῳ προσῆκον εὕροι τις ἂν ἐξετάζων. Τοὺς γὰρ ἐν ἁπάσῃ τῇ γῇ καὶ πάσαις πόλεσιν ἄρχοντας μέχρι τετάρτης ἢ πέμπτης γενεᾶς προϊόντας ἕτερον διαδέχεται γένος, καὶ τοῦτο πάλιν πάσχει ταὐτὰ καὶ πρὸς ἄλλους τὴν ἀρχὴν παραπέμπει καὶ οὕτως ἀεί, καὶ οὐκ ἔστιν εὑρεῖν γένος οὐδὲν οὐκ ἀρχόντων, οὐ τυράννων, οὐ βασιλέων μέχρι παντὸς ἐπὶ ταὐτοῦ παραμεῖναν. Οἱ δ' ἡμέτεροι δεσπόται καὶ βασιλεῖς κἀν τούτῳ καλῶς ποιοῦντες τῶν ἄλλων ἐκράτησαν, καὶ ἧς ἅπαξ ἐλάβοντο γῆς καὶ βασιλείας ἐπέβησαν, ταύτης οὐ χρόνος, οὐ τύχη, οὐ πραγμάτων μεταβολαὶ τούτους ἀπήγαγον, ἀλλ' ὥσπερ ἀθάνατοι ἄρχοντες διαιωνίζουσιν ἡμῖν οἱ αὐτοὶ καὶ ταὐτοῦ γένους ὄντες καὶ αἵματος, παῖς πατέρα διαδεχόμενοι καὶ τὴν οἰκείαν ἕκαστος ἡγεμονίαν κρατύνοντες. Εἴη δὲ δὴ καὶ τοῦ λοιποῦ τοῖς αὐτοῖς χρῆσθαι δεσπόταις καὶ ὑπὲρ τῶν αὐτῶν βασιλεύεσθαι, καὶ συνέχοις αὐτὸς ἄνωθεν, θεὲ ἡγεμόνιε, τὸ γένος τῶν βασιλέων καὶ ἰθύνοις μὲν τὴν βασιλείαν αὐτοῖς, εὖ δὲ τὰ ἡμέτερα διαθείης καὶ δι' ἀλλήλων ἀλλήλους κρατύνοις, τῇ τε πόλει τοὺς βασιλεῖς καὶ τοῖς βασιλεῦσι τὴν πόλιν τε καὶ τὸ γένος ἡμῖν.

Ὑπὸ δὴ τοιαύτῃ βασιλείᾳ καὶ τοιούτοις ἄρχουσιν ἡ πόλις ἡμῖν ὀρθουμένη ἑαυτῆς τε βελτίων γεγένηται καὶ συμφώνως τοῖς πρὶν εὐτυχήμασιν τούς τε τῆς ἀρχῆς ὅρους ηὔξηται τῇ τε περιβολῇ τῶν τειχῶν καὶ τῆς ἄλλης κατασκευῆς νεῶν τε καὶ οἰκημάτων καὶ ἀγορῶν καὶ πάσης τῆς τῇδε φιλοτιμίας, τῷ τε τῶν πολιτῶν πλήθει καὶ πλούτῳ καὶ εὐδαιμονίᾳ ὑπερεβάλετο ἑαυτήν, τοὐναντίον παθοῦσα ἢ τῶν πόλεων αἱ πολλαί. Αἱ μέν γ' εὐτυχήσασαι πρῶτα, εἶτα τῆς ἐναντίας τύχης πειρῶνται, καὶ παρακμάζει σφίσι

as excellent as possible. Consequently, both the common people and the magistrates—not belying that title—render to the emperors such devotion as I know not whether children ever render to fathers; wherefore neither have our rulers exchanged their subjects for others, as though finding fault with us—nay rather, they enlarge their realm for themselves all the more, striking terror from here into the barbarian nations—nor have we exchanged our sovereigns, seeking others out of discontent with them. On the contrary, the house of the Komnenoi and their descendants have ruled over us for so long a span of time now and through so many passing generations—a distinction which anyone who investigates will find peculiar to them alone and belonging to none other. For throughout the whole earth and in every city, rulers advance to the fourth or fifth generation and are then succeeded by another house, which in turn suffers the same lot and passes the sovereignty on to others, and so forever, nor can one find a single dynasty—whether of magistrates, tyrants, or kings—that has abided permanently upon the same throne. Yet our lords and emperors have happily surpassed all others in this respect as well: from the land they once grasped and the throne they once ascended, neither time, nor fortune, nor the revolutions of affairs have dislodged them; rather, like immortal rulers they endure through the ages for us, the selfsame line of the selfsame stock and blood, son succeeding father and each strengthening his inherited dominion. And for the future too may it be granted us to enjoy the same lords and be governed by the same dynasty; and mayest Thou Thyself from on high, O Sovereign God, sustain the house of our emperors, guide their reign aright, order our own affairs well, and strengthen each through the other—our emperors through the city, and our city and people through the emperors!

Guided aright under such an empire and such rulers, our city has grown better than her former self, and in keeping with her earlier good fortunes she has expanded the frontiers of her dominion; in the circuit of her walls and all her other appointments—temples, dwellings, marketplaces, and every sort of munificence herein—as well as in the multitude, wealth, and prosperity of her citizens, she has surpassed herself, experiencing the very opposite of most cities. For whereas others flourish at first and thereafter taste adverse fortune as their growth

τὰ τῆς αὐξήσεως, ἡ δ' ἀπὸ ταπεινοῦ καὶ σμικροῦ τὸ πρῶτον ἠργμένη οὐ κάμνει προκόπτουσα οὐδ' ἐπιδιδοῦσα. Ὄντος γοῦν αὐτῇ τὰ πρῶτα τοῦ περιβόλου στενοῦ, καὶ δεύτερος περιήχθη, καὶ προσεσκεύασται τρίτος, καὶ πρὸς μέγα μέτρον ἡμῖν τὰ τῶν τειχῶν παρατέτακται. Τὴν γὰρ νῦν μὲν ἀκρόπολιν, πάλαι δὲ πόλιν, εἰσόδους παρεχομένην διττάς, τὴν μὲν ἀπάγουσαν ἔξω τε καὶ ὡς πρὸς τὴν ἤπειρον, θατέραν δ' ἐκ τοῦ πρὸς θάλατταν αὐτῆς μέρους, προσαυξῆσαι θελήσαντες οἱ πατέρες ἡμῖν, οὐ κύκλῳ περιέλαβον ἅπασαν, ὡς εἴσω τοῦ δευτέρου τείχους ὅλην ποιήσασθαι· ἀλλ' ἐπεὶ κατιέναι μέχρις ἐς θάλασσαν ἦν αὐτοῖς προὔργου μετά γε τοῦ τὸν περίβολον παραυξῆσαι, τὴν μὲν ἐς μεσημβρίαν καὶ ἔξω βλέπουσαν πύλην ἀφεῖσαν ἔξω πάλιν αὐτῆς εἶναι, τὸ δέ γε πρὸς θάλασσαν αὐτῆς μέρος ἀπολαβόντες ἀπό τε τῶν γωνιῶν ἑκατέρας ἠργμένοι, τείχη τε παρέτειναν ἑκατέρωθεν ἕτερον πολλάκις τὸ μῆκος τοσοῦτον ὅσον τὸ τῆς ἀκροπόλεως ὅλης, εἶθ' ἑτέρᾳ πλευρᾷ ἐγκαρσίῳ ταῦτά τε συνῆψαν ἀλλήλοις καὶ τὸν ἐντὸς ἅπαντα τόπον τοῦ λοιποῦ καὶ πρὸς τῷ αἰγιαλῷ διωρίσαντο, καὶ πύλαις μὲν παρ' ἑκατέρᾳ μιᾷ ἀνεπέτασαν, ἐκ δὲ τοῦ πρὸς θάλατταν αὖθις ἑτέρᾳ, περὶ ἣν, ἐπείπερ ὁ τῇδε φέρων χῶρος ὁμαλὸς καὶ ἐπίπεδος, οὔτε περιειργάσαντο, οὔτ' ἐπολυπραγμόνησαν.

Περὶ δὲ τὰς παρ' ἑκατέρας πύλας καὶ πολὺν κατεβάλοντο πόνον καὶ οἷον ἂν ἄξιον διηγήσασθαι. Οἱ γὰρ ἄνωθεν κατιόντες παρ' ἑκάτερα φάραγγες, ἐνταῦθα βαθυνόμενοί τε καὶ τραχυνόμενοι μᾶλλον, οὔτ' ἀνθρώποις εὐζώνοις, οὔτε πολλῷ μᾶλλον βουσὶν ἢ ζεύγεσιν ἢ φορτηγοῖς ζῴοις ῥᾳδίαν παρεῖχον τὴν εἴσοδον. Ἔδει δὴ καθομαλισθῆναι τὴν φάραγγα καὶ τὸν κρημνώδη χῶρον ἴσον τε καὶ ἐπίπεδον γεγενῆσθαι καὶ τὴν ὁδὸν εὐθεῖαν ἀπ' αὐτῶν τῶν πυλῶν μέχρις ἐς γῆν τὴν ἀντιπέρας αὐτήν. Ἀπ' αὐτῶν γοῦν τῶν μυχαιτάτων ἠργμένοι τοῦ φάραγγος ἀνέστησαν πάχει διαφέροντα τείχη καὶ εἰς ὕψος ἀνήγαγον, μέχρις αὐτῶν τε τῶν πυλῶν φθάνοντα καὶ τῆς ἀντιπέρας τῶν ὀχθῶν ἑκατέρας. Καὶ τὰ τείχη διττὰ παρ' ἑκατέρᾳ, τὸ μὲν ἀπ' αὐτῶν πυλῶν ἐς αὐτὸ τὸ ποτάμιον ῥεῦμα, ὃ τοὺς φάραγγας δίεισι, τὸ δ' ἀφ' ἑκατέρας ὄχθης ἐς αὐτὸ τὸ ῥεῦμα, τὸ δὲ τούτοιν ἀμφοῖν μεταξὺ χάος τε καὶ κρημνὸς ὑπολέλειπται καὶ οὐκ ἔστι διελθεῖν οὔτ' ἐξιόντα τῆς πόλεως οὔτ' ἐσιόντα, ἀφαιρεθέντος τοῦ ζεύγματος καὶ τοῦ

wanes, she, having begun at first from humble and slender origins, never tires of advancing and increasing. Thus, whereas at first her circuit wall was narrow, a second was drawn around her, and a third has been added besides, so that our ramparts have been extended to vast proportions. For when our fathers wished to enlarge what is now the acropolis, though of old it was the city itself—which afforded twin entrances, one leading outside toward the mainland, the other on its seaward side—they did not encircle it all round so as to enclose the whole of it within the second wall; rather, since their object along with enlarging the circuit was to come down toward the sea, they left the south-facing outer gate once again on the outside, and cutting off its seaward side, starting from each of its two corners, they extended walls on either flank many times the length of the entire acropolis; then with another transverse side they joined these walls to one another and so marked off all the space within from the rest of the ground, along the shore. They opened each flank with a single gate, and the seaward side again with another, around which, inasmuch as the ground leading thither is smooth and level, they employed no elaborate artifice or special contrivance.

Around the gates on either flank, however, they expended immense labor well worthy of recounting. For the ravines descending from above on either side grow deeper and more rugged here, affording no easy passage even to unencumbered men on foot, much less to oxen, teams, or beasts of burden. It was therefore necessary to level the ravine, to make the precipitous ground even and flat, and to carry the road straight across from the gates themselves right to the opposite bank. Starting, accordingly, from the very bottommost depths of the ravine, they raised walls of extraordinary thickness and carried them up on high, reaching up both to the gates themselves and to the opposite bank on either side. These walls are double at either gate—one running from the gates themselves to the very stream of the river that courses through the ravines, the other from each outer bank to the stream itself—while the interval between the two is left a sheer chasm and precipice, impossible to cross whether going out of the city or entering it once the spanning beams and the wooden bridge-decking laid

ἐπικειμένου ξυλίνου γεφυρώματος. Τοῦ γὰρ ἀσφαλοῦς προνοούμενοι παρ' αὐταῖς τε ταῖς ὄχθαις πύργους ἀνήγειραν, ὅθεν ἂν τοῖς πολεμίοις τὰς εἰσόδους ἀποτειχίζοιεν, καὶ τὰ γεφυρώματ' αὐτὰ ὑπέθεσαν ξύλινα, ὡς ἄν, ἐν τῷ παρισταμένῳ τῆς χρείας ῥᾳδίως αἰρόμενα, ἄβατον τοῖς ἐναντίοις τὴν εἴσοδον καταλίποιεν. Ἐπεὶ δ' αὐξομένης ἀεὶ καὶ ἧς εἴληχε μοίρας ἐπὶ τὸ βέλτιόν τε καὶ μεῖζον ἀγούσης αὐτὴν ἔδει τόν τε περίβολον ἐκτετάσθαι καὶ ἀκριβῶς γενέσθαι θαλάττιον, τῶν κυμάτων αὐτῆς περικλυζόντων τὰ τείχη, ἐν ὑστέρῳ καιροῦ καὶ τοῦτο δὴ προσεγένετο. Ἐκ γοῦν τοῦ πρὸς δυσμὰς φέροντος ἠργμένοι, οὗ τὸν πύργον ἐπ' αὐτῇ δεδομῆσθαι τῇ εἰσόδῳ προέφημεν καὶ τὴν ἐνταῦθα φάραγγα εἴσω ποιησάμενοι πᾶσαν καὶ πολὺ παρεξιόντες μέχρι τὰ θαλάσσης κατῆλθον αὐτῆς, τῶν κυμάτων αὐτῶν ἐπιβάντες, καί, περιαγαγόντες τὸ τεῖχος, εἰς αὐτό γε τὸ πρὸς ἕω τῆς πόλεως μέρος προσενήρμοσαν φέροντες, τῆς τε προειρημένης ὀλίγῳ κάτωθεν πόλεως εἴσω τε τῆς ἐνταῦθα φάραγγος πάσης τοσούτῳ μεῖζον τοῦ δευτέρου περιβαλόμενοι τεῖχος, ὅσῳ τοῦτο διαφέρει τοῦ πρώτου, πύλαις τε καὶ πυλίσιν ἀναπεπταμένον παντοδαπαῖς καὶ πανταχοῦ φέρον πολλαῖς ταῖς αὐταῖς τοῦ τε μεγέθους πρὸς λόγον ὃ περιβέβληται καὶ τοῦ πλήθους τῶν ἐνοικούντων. Ἐς αὐτήν τε γὰρ θάλατταν δυσὶ καὶ τρισὶν ἀνέῳγε πύλαις καὶ αὖ παρ' ἑκάτερα ταῖς ἴσαις καὶ πλείοσιν εἰσιέναι παρέχεται, ὥστε διπλοῦν ἀνθ' ἁπλοῦ τὸν περίβολον ἡμῖν εἶναι καὶ τὰ ἴσα πολλαῖς ἄλλαις μεγέθους εἵνεκα δύνασθαι.

Τοσούτου δὲ παντὸς ὄντος τοῦ περιβόλου καὶ τοσοῦτον περιέχοντος χῶρον ἐντός, ὅμως οὐδὲν ἧττον τὸ τῆς πόλεως πλῆθος στενοχωρεῖται καὶ κρεῖττον ἢ κατὰ τὴν πόλιν ὑπάρχον εὑρίσκεται. Τό τε γοῦν πλεῖστον ἐκτὸς παρ' ἑκάτερα κέχυται καὶ οὐδ' ὀφθαλμοῖς ὁρίζει τὸ τῶν οἰκιῶν πλῆθος, ὅσαι πρός τε τὴν ἕω καὶ τὴν ἐς δυσμὰς φέρον δεδομημέναι προαστείων τε τῇ πόλει φέρουσι λόγον, καὶ οὓς ὁ περίβολος οὐ χωρεῖ δεχόμεναι ἀναπαύουσι λειμῶνές τε καὶ παράδεισοι καὶ δένδρα παντοδαπὰ καρποῖς βρίθοντα, τά τε ἄλλα καὶ ἐλαιῶν πλῆθος ὥσπερ τι συνηρεφὲς ἄλσος τὸν τῇδε πάντα χῶρον σκιάζοντα, προκεχυμένα τῆς πόλεως, τούς τ' ἐσιόντας μετὰ πολλῆς παραπέμπει τῆς ἡδονῆς καὶ πυκνὰ τοὺς τῶν ἐξιόντων ὀφθαλμοὺς ἐπιστρέφει τε πρὸς αὐτὰ καὶ οἷον ἐπιλαθέσθαι τῆς προκειμένης ὁδοῦ πείθοντα,

over them are removed. For taking forethought for security, they erected towers right upon the banks from which they might bar the approaches against enemies, and they laid the bridge-decks themselves of timber so that, being easily lifted whenever need arises, they might leave the entrance impassable to adversaries. Later in time, since the city kept ever growing and her allotted destiny led her onward to greater and fairer estate, her circuit wall had to be extended further and become truly maritime, with the waves of the sea washing round her ramparts; and this too was duly added. Starting, then, from the western side, where we previously mentioned that the tower was built right at the entrance, enclosing the entire ravine there within the circuit, and advancing well beyond it, they came down to the margin of the sea itself, stepping into the very waves; then, wheeling the wall round, they carried and joined it onto the eastern side of the city, slightly below the aforesaid city and wholly on the inner side of the ravine there, casting around a third wall as much larger than the second as the second exceeds the first, opened by gates and posterns of every sort leading in every direction, numerous in proportion both to the expanse it encompasses and to the multitude of inhabitants. Toward the sea itself it opens by two or three gates, and again on either flank it affords entrance by as many or more, so that we possess a double circuit instead of a single one, equal in size to many other cities.

Vast as this entire circuit is and spacious as is the ground it encloses within, the population of the city is nonetheless cramped for room and proves too great for the city to hold. The greater part, accordingly, has spilled outside on either flank, nor can the eye even take in the multitude of houses built toward both the east and the western quarter, serving as suburbs to the city and welcoming and giving repose to those whom the circuit cannot contain. Meadows, gardens, and trees of every kind heavy with fruit—and above all a wealth of olive trees shading the whole district hereabout like an overarching grove—spread forth before the city: they escort those entering with keen delight, and repeatedly turn back toward themselves the eyes of those departing; persuading them, as it were, to forget the journey before them, they draw everyone wholly into wonder at their

ὅλους πρός τε θαῦμα τοῦ ἑαυτῶν κάλλους ἀπάγει, καὶ πεδητῶν τρόπον αὐτοῦ πάντας κατέχει, ἐμπόριόν τε καὶ ἀγορὰ πᾶσα καὶ κάπηλοι πάντες ἔξω τῆς πόλεως, καὶ ταῦτα πάντα τὸ πρὸς ἕω μέρος αὐτῆς φέρει, ἀπ' αὐτῶν μὲν ἀρχόμενα τῶν τειχῶν, ἀπιόντα δ' ἐς μῆκος ὅσον ἐνῆν πλεῖστον οὐκ ἀπ' εὐθείας μόνον, ἀλλά πη καὶ κάμπτοντα πολλαχοῦ καὶ παρεκδρομὰς οὐκ ὀλίγας ποιούμενα.

Παρ' ἑκάτερα δὲ ἐργαστήριά τε δεδόμηται πάμπολλα καὶ γέρρα τῶν ἐργαστηρίων ἐξέχει καὶ ἄνδρες ἐργάται καθήμενοι ἐμπορεύονται τὰ τιμιώτατά τε καὶ κάλλιστα πιπράσκοντες καὶ ὠνούμενοι καὶ ὅσα ἡ πᾶσα γῆ φέρει. Ἔτι δ' ἐπιτηδεύματα πάντα καὶ τέχνας παντοίας, ὅσαι τε βάναυσοι ὅσαι τε ἄπυροι, καὶ ὅλως ὅσων ἀνθρώποις οὐ πρὸς ζωὴν μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ πρὸς διαγωγὴν δεῖ, πάσας ἂν εὕροις ἐνταῦθα καὶ οἵας οὐκ ἄλλοθι γῆς, ὥστε τὸ τῶν τεχνιτῶν ἡμῖν πλῆθος ἀντ' ἄλλης εἶναι πληρώματος πόλεως. Πλήθει γοῦν ἡμῖν ἡ ἀγορὰ καὶ αὐτὸ τὸ ἐμπόριον οὐ τῇδε ἢ τῇδε τῶν πασῶν ἡμερῶν, οὐδὲ τῷδε ἢ τῷδε μέρει ἡμέρας καὶ ὥρας ὁποιασοῦν, ἀλλὰ πάσαις μὲν ἡμέραις ἐνιαυτοῦ, πάσαις δὲ ὥραις ἡμέρας, σύμμικτον ἀεὶ φέρουσα πλῆθος καὶ μόλις χωροῦσα τοὺς διιόντας. Τό τε γὰρ ξενικὸν οὐκ ὀλίγον ἐνταῦθα καὶ ὅσον κατ' ἐμπορίαν τῇ ἡμετέρᾳ συμμίγνυσιν οἵ τε πολῖται τῷ τῆς πόλεως μεγέθει συμβαίνοντες καὶ οἱ αὐτὸ τοῦτο ἔμποροι, οὓς οὐκ ἔνι μὴ ἀγοράζειν ἀεί, ἀρκοῦντες τὴν ἀγορὰν πλήθειν ἀνθρώπων ποιεῖν, ὥστε τριχῇ τὸ πλῆθος ἐνταῦθα συρρεῖν, αὐτῶν τε τῶν ἐπηλύδων καὶ ὅσοι κατ' ἐμπορίαν ἴασιν ἐνταῦθα διατριβόντων ἀεί, τῶν τ' ἐγχωρίων, τῶν μὲν διὰ παντὸς ἐπιχωριαζόντων αὐτοῦ, ὡς ἂν τούτου τοῦ ἐπιτηδεύματος ὄντων, τῶν δ' οὐδ' αὐτῶν διὰ τὴν χρείαν ἀπόντων ἐκεῖθεν. Ὥστε τῷ τε πλήθει τῶν ἀγοραζόντων τῷ τε μέτρῳ τοῦ τόπου, ὃν ἡμῖν ἡ ἀγορὰ περιλαμβάνει καὶ ἐς ὅσον ἐκτέταται, κατ' οὐδὲν εὐθηνουμένης ὅλης λείπεται πόλεως.

Ἀλλὰ μὴν οἰκιῶν πλήθη καὶ κάλλη αἷς ἄμφω ταῦτα χορηγεῖ δαψιλῶς ἥ τε τῶν παρ' ἡμῖν τεκτόνων σοφία, οἷς μόνοις ἄν τις ἔφη προσήκειν τὸ Σοφὸς ἤραρε τέκτων, οὕτως ἐς τἀκριβὲς τουτουὶ τοῦ ἐπιτηδεύματος

beauty and hold all men fast on the spot like captives in fetters. Moreover, the emporium, the entire marketplace, and all the retail merchants lie outside the city, and her eastern quarter bears all of these, beginning right at the walls and stretching out to the greatest length possible—not in a straight line alone, but also winding in many places and branching off into no few side-streets.

On either side countless workshops have been built, the shops' stalls project into the street, and craftsmen sit plying their trade, selling and buying the most precious and exquisite wares and everything that the whole earth produces. Furthermore, every occupation and every manner of craft—both those of the forge and those wrought without fire, and in general whatever men require not merely for livelihood but for refined living as well—you will find them all here, and of a quality unmatched anywhere else on earth, so that the multitude of our artisans suffices in itself for the population of another city. Accordingly, our marketplace and the emporium itself teem with people not merely on this or that day among all the rest, nor during this or that part of the day or particular hour, but on every day of the year and at every hour of the day, ever carrying a mingled throng and scarcely able to contain those passing through. For the foreign element here is no small one—all who mingle with our city for commerce—while our citizens match the city's magnitude, and those who are merchants by profession, who cannot help frequenting the market continually, suffice by themselves to fill the marketplace with people. Thus the crowd streams together here from three sources: the strangers from abroad and all who come for trade lingering here continually, and among the natives, some spending all their time on the spot because this is their calling, while the rest too are never absent from there on account of their daily needs. Hence, both in the multitude of marketers and in the expanse of ground that our marketplace embraces and over which it stretches, it falls short in no respect of an entire flourishing city.

Now as for the multitude and beauty of private houses—lavishly supplied with both qualities alike by the skill of our builders, to whom alone one might say belongs Homer's phrase, "a skilled craftsman fitted it

ἦκον, ἥ τε παρὰ τῶν ὀρῶν φορά, παρεχομένων ὑλοτομεῖν δαψιλῶς ὕλην παντοίαν τε καὶ ποικίλην καὶ οἵαν οὐκ ἄλλοθι, ταῦτα μὲν οὖν ἐάσω· καὶ γὰρ ἔχοι τις ἂν τοῖς ὁμοίοις καυχήσασθαι· αὐτῶν γε μὴν τῶν βασιλείων πέρι, τρυφὴν ἀνακτορικὴν καὶ πολλὴν ἐνδεικνυμένων ἁβρότητα, κἂν μὴ δύναιτο λόγος ἱκανῶς παραστῆσαι, μικρὰ ἄττα διαληψόμεθα ὅμως καὶ ὅσον ἐνδείξασθαί φασιν ἐκ τοῦ κρασπέδου θοιμάτιον. Τὰ γὰρ δὴ τῶν βασιλέων οἰκήματα ἐν αὐτῇ μὲν ἵδρυται τῇ νῦν ἀκροπόλει, αὐτὰ δ' ἐστὶν οὐδὲν ἧττον ἀκρόπολις τοίχων τε ὀχυρότητι καὶ ποικιλίᾳ κατασκευῆς καὶ μεγέθει καὶ κάλλει τῶν ἁπανταχοῦ διαφέροντα. Τὸ μὲν γὰρ πρὸς δύνοντα ἥλιον τεῖχος αὐτῶν, αὐτῇ τε τῇ ἀκροπόλει καὶ τοῖς ἀρχείοις κοινὸν ὄν, ἐς τὴν αὐτὴν ἀμφοῖν ἓν καὶ ταὐτὸ χρείαν παρείληπται, ἀνιὸν μὲν ἐς πρῶτον καὶ δεύτερον ὄροφον τῆς τ' ἀκροπόλεως τῶν τε βασιλείων αὐτῶν εἵνεκα, τὸ δ' ὑπὲρ τοῦτο πᾶν ἤδη καθαρῶς ὑπὲρ αὐτῶν μόνον ἀνυψούμενον τῶν ἀρχείων, τοσούτῳ τοῦ τῆς ἀκροπόλεως ὑπερανιστάμενον τείχους, ὅσον ἐκεῖνο σχεδὸν ὑπερανέχει τῆς γῆς. Τὸ δέ γ' ἐπὶ θάτερα τεῖχος, ὕψους τε καὶ παχύτητος καὶ τῆς ἄλλης οἰκοδομῆς εὖ ἔχον, ἄνωθεν κάτω διηγμένον, ὑπὲρ τὸ ἥμισύ τε τῆς ἀκροπόλεως ἀφαιρεῖται, καὶ τῷ τῶν βασιλείων μέρει προστίθησιν, ὡς καὶ μόνον ἀρκεῖν ἐπιόντα τε πολέμιον ὑποστῆναι ἐν ἀσφαλεῖ τε φυλάττειν οὓς ἂν εἴσω ποιήσαιτο, διτταῖς δὲ τὴν εἴσοδον συγχωροῦν πύλαις καὶ πυλίδι μιᾷ, παντὶ τῷ λοιπῷ ἑαυτοῦ ἀσφαλῶς δεδόμηται καὶ τοὺς προσιόντας ἀποτειχίζει τε καὶ ἀπείργει. Τούτου παρ' ἑκάτερα μὲν ψιλός τις ὑπολέλειπται τόπος αἰθουσῶν τε εἵνεκα καὶ τοῦ δέχεσθαι τοὺς ὑπηρετουμένους τοῖς βασιλεῦσιν· ἐπ' αὐτοῦ δὲ τοῦ μέσου τὰ βασίλεια ἵδρυται, εἴσοδον μὲν παρεχόμενα μίαν, ἀναβαθμοῖς προσανεσπασμένην καὶ κλίμακι, καὶ ποιούμενα τὴν εἴσοδον ἄνοδον.

Εἰσιόντα δ' εὐθὺς ἔνθεν μὲν πρόδομοι καὶ δόμοι λαμπρῶς ὑποδέχονται, κάλλους τε καὶ μεγέθους ἱκανῶς ἔχοντες καὶ χωρεῖν οὐκ ὀλίγους δυνάμενοι, ἐξῶσταί τε κύκλῳ τοὺς δόμους περιειλήφασι, πανταχοῦ τετραμμένοι καὶ πᾶσιν ἐκκείμενοι πνεύμασιν· ἐκ δέ γ' ἐπὶ θάτερα μήκει τε μήκιστος οἶκος καὶ κάλλει κάλλιστος παρατέταται, τοὔδαφος μὲν λευκῷ λίθῳ σύμπας ὑπεστρωμένος, χρυσῷ δὲ τὴν ὀροφὴν καὶ ποικιλίᾳ χρωμάτων καὶ τοῖς τῆς γραφῆς

together," to such exact perfection have they come in this art, and by the bounty of our mountains, which yield for felling an abundant store of timber of every sort and variety, such as is found nowhere else—all these matters I shall pass over, since another city too might boast of the like. Concerning the imperial palace itself, however, which displays palatial splendor and rich refinement, even if speech cannot adequately set it forth, we shall nonetheless treat of a few particulars, enough at least, as the proverb says, to show the cloak from its fringe. The residences of the emperors stand within what is now the acropolis, yet they constitute an acropolis in their own right, surpassing palaces everywhere in strength of walls, variety of construction, magnitude, and beauty. Their wall facing the setting sun, being common both to the acropolis itself and to the imperial chambers, has been pressed into one and the same service for both alike, rising to a first and a second story on account of both the acropolis and the palace itself, while everything above that towers up purely for the palace chambers alone, rising above the wall of the acropolis by almost as much as that wall itself rises above the ground. The wall on the other side, amply endowed with height, thickness, and every other feature of masonry, drawn right across from top to bottom, cuts off more than half of the acropolis and annexes it to the precinct of the palace, so as to suffice even by itself both to withstand an attacking enemy and to keep in safety whomever it encloses within; granting entrance by twin gates and a single postern, throughout all the rest of its length it is securely built and walls off and bars those who approach. On either side of this precinct an open space has been left clear both for porticoes and for accommodating those who attend upon the emperors; and in the very center stands the palace itself, offering a single entrance drawn aloft by steps and a staircase, making the entrance an ascent.

As one enters, straightway on the one hand vestibules and halls give a splendid welcome, amply endowed with beauty and spaciousness and capable of holding no small company, while balconies encircle the halls round about, facing every quarter and open to every breeze; on the other side stretches a hall longest in length and fairest in beauty, paved throughout its floor with white marble, while in its ceiling it flashes with gold, manifold colors, and the blossoms of the painter's art—a ceiling

καταστραπτόμενος ἄνθεσιν ἄστρα τε προδεικνῦσαν ἐν τῷ ξύμπαντι ἑαυτῆς κύτει καὶ αὐγὰς ἀποπέμπουσαν ὡς ἂν οὐρανοῦ μίμημα καὶ πολλὴν ἐπιδεικνυμένην τῆς γραφῆς περιττότητα καὶ τρυφήν· τά τε κύκλῳ καὶ πρὸς τοῖς τοίχοις αὐτοῖς γέγραπται μὲν ὁ τῶν βασιλέων χορὸς ὅσοι τε τῆς ἡμετέρας ἦρξαν ὅσοις τε προγόνοις ἐχρήσαντο, γέγραπται δὲ καὶ εἴ τινα κίνδυνον ἡ πόλις ἡμῶν περιστάντα διήνεγκε καὶ ὅσοι κατ' αὐτῆς ἐπιόντες καθ' αὑτῶν ἔγνωσαν ἐγχειρίσαντες. Ἄνω δὲ αὐτοῦ καὶ πρός γε τῷ ἄκρῳ βῆμα κατηρεφὲς προφαίνει βασίλειον, ὀροφὴν μὲν ἀποτεῖνον ἐς πυραμίδα, τέτρασι δ' αὐτὴν κίοσιν ὑπανέχον, λευκῷ δὲ καὶ αὐτὸ λίθῳ κύκλῳ τε καὶ πρὸς τῷ ὀρόφῳ περισκεπόμενον τούς θ' ὑπηκόους ἀποτειχίζον τῶν βασιλέων ὥσπερ τισὶν ἄλλαις κιγκλίσιν, οὗ βασιλεὺς αὐτὸς μάλιστα προφαινόμενος χρηματίζει τε τοῖς ἐν τέλει καὶ πρέσβεσι διαλέγεται καὶ λόγον δίδωσι καὶ λαμβάνει. Προϊόντι δὲ βῆμά τε βασίλειον ἕτερον, εὖρει καὶ ὕψει πολλῷ προέχον, κατηρεφὲς καὶ περίστυλον· ἀναβαθμοί τ' ἐν τῷ βήματι ἀνιόντες τοὺς βασιλέας ἐς ὕψος ἀνάγοντες καὶ πεποικιλμένον γραφαῖς οἴκημα, ἔνθα τοὺς ἐν τέλει τε καὶ τὸ λοιπὸν ὑποχείριον λαμπρῶς ἑστιᾶν βασιλεὺς εἴθισται.

Ἐντεῦθεν ἐπὶ μὲν ἀριστερὰ ἄλλοις τε δωματίοις παμπόλλοις ἐστὶν ἐντυχεῖν καὶ τῶν ἄλλων ἑνὶ διαφέροντι, τέτρασι μὲν ἴσαις διῃρημένῳ πλευραῖς καὶ σχῆμα πλαίσιον σώζοντι ὑπομνήματά τε τῆς τῶν ὅλων γενέσεως φέροντι καὶ ὡς τὴν ἀρχὴν ἄνθρωπος γέγονε γενόμενός τε ὡς τὰ καθ' αὑτὸν ἐπολίτευσεν. Ἐπὶ δεξιὰ δὲ δόμοι καὶ πρόδομοι καὶ ἐξῶσται καὶ κοιτῶνες καὶ θάλαμοι, διαιρούμενοι μὲν στοαῖς, ἑκάστης πρὸς ἐγκαρσίαν τελευτώσης ἑτέραν, μέτρον δὲ φέροντες μεθ' ὃ πλέον οὐχ ὑπάρχει λαβεῖν, μεγέθει μὲν μείους τε καὶ μείζους ἀλλήλων, πάντες δὲ μετὰ κάλλους ἀρρήτου καὶ τῆς πρεπούσης ἁρμονίας ἐσκευασμένοι. Καὶ νεὼς ἐκεῖ ἱερὸς ἵδρυται, γραφῆς τ' ἀγλαϊζόμενος κάλλεσι καὶ ἱεροῖς ἀναθήμασιν οὐ μᾶλλον πλήθει πολλοῖς ἢ κάλλει καλλίστοις κοσμούμενος, ὅσῳ τοῦ μεγέθους λειπόμενος τοσοῦτον τοῦ κάλλους πλεονεκτῶν.

Οὕτω κάλλιόν τι ἢ εἰπεῖν ἐσκεύασται τὰ βασίλεια καὶ μόνη ταῦτ' ἂν ἀκριβῶς ὄψις κατανοήσαι, τά τε ἄλλα καὶ ὅσα ὑπό τε τὸν πρῶτον καὶ δεύτερον ὄροφον

that displays stars across its entire vault, sends forth gleams like an image of heaven, and exhibits extraordinary lavishness and delicacy of painting. Round about upon the walls themselves is painted the choir of the emperors, both all who have ruled our city and the ancestors from whom they sprang; and painted there too is every peril that ever beset our city and that she endured and overcame, together with all those who marched against her only to learn that they had raised their hands to their own undoing. High up at its upper extremity appears a canopied imperial dais, extending its roof into a pyramid and supporting it upon four columns; sheathed itself also in white marble both round about and toward the roof, it fences off the subjects from the emperors as though by lattices of another kind, and there the emperor himself especially appears in state, transacts business with the magistrates, converses with ambassadors, and grants and receives speech. As one advances further, there is a second imperial dais, far surpassing the former in breadth and height, roofed over and girt with columns, with steps ascending within the dais that lead the emperors up on high, and a hall richly adorned with paintings, wherein the emperor is accustomed to feast magnificently the magistrates and the rest of his subjects.

From here, on the left, one encounters countless other chambers, and one above all surpassing the rest, measured out with four equal sides so as to preserve a square plan, and bearing painted memorials of the creation of the universe, how man first came into being, and how after coming into being he conducted his life. On the right are halls, vestibules, balconies, bedchambers, and inner apartments, divided by colonnades each terminating at right angles into another, attaining a perfection beyond which nothing further can be conceived—some smaller and some larger than one another in size, yet all fashioned with ineffable beauty and fitting harmony. There too stands a sacred church, resplendent with the beauties of painting and adorned with sacred votive offerings no more numerous in multitude than peerless in beauty, excelling in loveliness by as much as it yields in size.

Thus the imperial palace is appointed more fairly than words can tell, and sight alone could apprehend it with precision; above all, the chambers beneath both the first

μηκικῶς τε διῃρημένα καὶ πλατικῶς καὶ πολλὴν ἐνδεικνύμενα ποικιλίαν τε καὶ τεκτόνων σοφίαν οὐδεὶς ἂν ἀξίως παραστήσειε λόγος πλὴν ὅσα γε πειραθῆναι. Οὐ μὴν ἀλλὰ τούτοις αὖ καὶ τὰ πανταχοῦ τῆς ἡμετέρας ἱερὰ συμβαίνει καὶ οἱ νεώ, ὥς γ' ἐν ὀλίγῳ τὸ πᾶν εἰπεῖν, οἵ τ' ἐν αὐτῇ τῇ πόλει οἵ τ' ἐκτὸς τῆς πόλεως, οἱ μὲν ἐγγύς τε ὄντες καὶ ἐπ' αὐτῶν ᾠκοδομημένοι τῶν περιβόλων, οἱ δὲ δὴ καὶ πορρωτέρω πᾶσαν κύκλῳ διαλαβόντες τὴν χώραν, ὡς μηδὲν αὐτῆς εἴη τοῦ τοιοῦδ' ἀγαθοῦ τε καὶ κόσμου καὶ τῆς ἐντεῦθεν χάριτος ἄμοιρον, μᾶλλον μὲν ὄντες καλοὶ ἢ πολλοί, μᾶλλον δὲ τῷ πλήθει προέχοντες ἢ διαφέροντες κάλλει, τοσοῦτοι μὲν ὄντες ὡς, εἰ καὶ μὴ κάλλους μετεῖχον, οὐδὲν ἧττον φέρειν εἰς δόξαν ἡμῖν, οὕτω δ' ἐσκευασμένοι καὶ περιττῶς ἔχοντες κάλλους ὡς, εἰ καὶ μὴ πλήθει προεῖχον, μέγα ἂν δύνασθαι μόνῃ τῇ διὰ πάντων εὐαρμοστίᾳ καὶ συμφωνίᾳ καὶ οἷς οὐδὲν ἄπεστι τῶν εἰς θαῦμα φερόντων, περὶ ὧν ἰδίας ἐδέησεν ἂν ὑποθέσεως βουληθέντι διαλαβεῖν καὶ πραγματείας ἑτέρας.

and the second story, partitioned lengthwise and breadthwise and displaying rich variety and the wisdom of master builders, no discourse could worthily portray save insofar as it might make the attempt. Nay more, in keeping with these are the sanctuaries and churches everywhere throughout our land—to sum up the whole in brief—both those within the city herself and those outside the city: some standing close by and built upon the circuit walls themselves, others farther afield studding the entire countryside round about, so that no part of it might be left without a share in such blessing, ornament, and the grace flowing therefrom. One might say they are fairer than they are numerous, yet again that they excel more in multitude than they surpass in beauty: so numerous that, even had they lacked beauty, they would nonetheless redound to our glory, yet so finely appointed and superabundantly endowed with beauty that, even had they not excelled in number, they would avail greatly by their pervasive proportion and harmony alone and because nothing that moves to wonder is wanting in them—matters which, were one to wish to treat of them, would require a dedicated theme and another treatise.

§ 23. [σ. 48–51] Οὕτω πάντοθεν ἥ τε φύσις ἥ τε τῶν πατέρων φιλοκαλία ἥ τε τῶν βασιλέων ἡμῖν ἐπιστασία πᾶν ἀγαθὸν ἠρανίσατο καὶ τῇ σφετέρᾳ προσεπορίσατο. Ἀλλὰ τὰ μὲν περὶ τὴν ὅλην τῆς πόλεως κατασκευήν τε καὶ θέσιν καὶ τὴν τῆς πολιτείας οἰκονομίαν καὶ διαχείρισιν εἴρηται. Τό γε μὲν αὐτῆς μάχιμον καὶ τὰ κατὰ στρατείας καὶ πόλεμον θαυμαστὴν ὅσην σοφίαν τε καὶ ἀνδρείαν αὐτῇ μαρτυρεῖ. Ἀποκέκριναι μὲν γὰρ τοῦ λοιποῦ πλήθους οἱ προβεβλημένοι τῆς πόλεως καὶ τεταγμένοι στρατεύεσθαι, μόνον ἔχοντες ἔργον καὶ ἓν ἐπιτήδευμα, τὴν τῶν τακτικῶν γυμνασίαν καὶ τὸ κατὰ πολέμους εὐδοκιμεῖν, οὐδὲν δ' ἧττον καὶ σύμπας ὁ δῆμος καὶ τὸ πᾶν τῆς πόλεως πλήρωμα οὐ μᾶλλον ὑφ' ἑτέρων φυλάττεσθαι ἢ φυλάκων ἀξιοῦντες αὐτοὶ σχῆμα σώζειν τοῖς ἄλλοις διαχειρίζονται μὲν καὶ ἣν ἕκαστος ἔτυχεν ἠσκηκὼς τέχνην καὶ ἐπιτήδευμα, γυμνάζονται δὲ καὶ τὰ ἐς πολέμους καὶ μάχας καὶ στρατιωτικὴν ἐμπειρίαν, ὡς ἂν ῥώμης τε ἱκανῶς ἔχοντες καὶ ἀνδρείας ἥκοντες ἐπὶ πλεῖστον, τῆς γῆς ὥσπερ ἐπιτηδεύεσθαι ἀνείσης καὶ τόλμαν τοῖς ἐξ αὐτῆς ἔμφρονα καὶ ῥώμην σωμάτων, ὥστ' οὐ μᾶλλον

§ 23. [p. 48–51] Thus from every quarter nature, our fathers' love of beauty, and the stewardship of our emperors have pooled every blessing together and bestowed it upon their city. Now all that pertains to the city's overall fabric and situation, and to the ordering and administration of her polity, has been told; yet her fighting spirit and her conduct in campaigns and war bear witness to a wondrous degree of wisdom and valor in her. For although those stationed to defend the city and enrolled for military service are set apart from the rest of the populace—having as their sole task and single vocation drill in tactics and winning renown in war—nonetheless the entire citizenry as well and the whole population of the city, thinking it right not so much to be guarded by others as to act themselves as guardians of the rest, carry on the particular craft and calling in which each happens to be trained, while also exercising themselves in the arts of war, battle, and military skill. For they are amply endowed with bodily might and have attained the highest pitch of courage, as though the very soil sent up for cultivation both prudent daring in her sons and physical strength, so that one could scarce

ἄν τις αὐτῶν τὴν καρτερίαν θαυμάσαι ἢ τὸ τοῦ σώματος ἐν τοῖς πόνοις ἀνάλωτον. Γενναιότητι μὲν γὰρ τοὺς ἀνδρείους, ῥώμῃ δὲ νικῶντες τοὺς ἰσχύι προέχοντας ἢ μᾶλλον τοὺς μὲν ῥωμαλέους ἀνδρείᾳ, ῥώμῃ δὲ τοὺς τὴν ψυχὴν ἀηττήτους, ἐν πᾶσι δι' ἀμφοῖν εὐδοκιμεῖν ἔχουσι καὶ τὸ κατὰ πάντων ἀποφέρεσθαι κράτος. Πρόσεστι δὲ καὶ ἡ ἄσκησις, πρᾶγμα τοσοῦτον οὐκ ἐν τοῖς κυνηγεσίοις γυμναζομένων μόνοις καὶ τῇ πρὸς τὰ τῶν θηρίων ἀνυπόστατα μάχῃ, ἃ τῶν πολεμικῶν ἀγώνων εἰσὶ πάντως προτέλειαι, ἀλλὰ μάλιστα μὲν αὐτοὶ κατὰ τῶν πολεμίων συνεχῶς καὶ τῆς ἐκείνων χώρας εἰσβάλλοντες καὶ τοὺς ἀληθινοὺς ἐν τούτοις μελετῶντες ἀγῶνας, σχολῆς δ' οὔσης ἐκεῖθεν καὶ εἰρήνης πολέμων αὐτοί τε ἐφ' ἑαυτῶν ἔν τισι συγκειμέναις ἡμέραις παμπληθεὶ τὰ τῶν πολεμούντων ἐπιδεικνύμενοι καὶ τὰ τακτικὰ γυμναζόμενοι καὶ ὅλως τοῦθ' ἕν τε καὶ προὔργου διὰ βίου μετιόντες ἐπιτήδευμα, εὖ τε καὶ καλῶς παρεσκευάσθαι πρὸς πόλεμον, ὡς ἐπιόντα τε πολέμιον ὑποστῆναι καί, δεῆσαν κατ' ἄλλων αὐτοὺς ἐπιέναι, δυνηθῆναι λυπῆσαι.

admire their steadfast endurance more than the inexhaustible vigor of their bodies amid toils. Surpassing the brave in gallantry and those preeminent in might by their strength—or rather, surpassing the strong in courage and those unconquerable of soul in bodily might—through both qualities together they are able to win distinction in every field and carry off supremacy over all. Added to this is training, so potent a factor: for they exercise themselves not merely in the chase and in combat against irresistible wild beasts—which are in every way the preliminary rites of warlike contests—but above all by making continual incursions themselves against the enemy and their territory, practicing true contests amid those engagements; and whenever there is respite from that quarter and peace from wars, assembling in full force among themselves on certain appointed days to perform martial exercises and drill in tactics, pursuing throughout life this one paramount calling: to stand thoroughly and nobly prepared for war, so as both to withstand an attacking foe and, should need arise to march against others themselves, to have the power to inflict harm.

Ὅπλοις τε γοῦν ἀγχεμάχοις κεχρῆσθαι καὶ συστάδην ἀγωνίζεσθαι τίνος οὐκ ἀκριβέστερον ἤσκηνται πάλλειν τε δόρυ καὶ τόξοις λυπεῖν τίς ἂν ἐς ἴσον αὐτοῖς ἔλθοι ποτέ; Τόξοις μὲν γὰρ Τεῦκρον νικῶσι καὶ Πάνδαρον, ἵππους δέ τε κοσμῆσαι καὶ ἀνέρας ἀσπιδιώτας Μενεσθέα ἀπέκρυψαν, παῖδα δὲ τὸν Ὀϊλέως ἀπέδειξαν ποδωκείᾳ τε καὶ τῷ εὐζώνῳ τοῦ σώματος καὶ ἄλλῳ ἄλλον τῶν ἀγωνισμάτων καὶ πᾶσι παρευδοκίμησαν ἅπαντας. Αὐτοί τε γὰρ καθ' αὑτοὺς πρὸς πᾶν εὐφυῶς ἔσχον, ἡγεμόνων τε καὶ κορυφαίων τοιούτων ἐτύχομεν, τῶν ἀρίστων ἡμῖν βασιλέων, ὡς, εἰ καὶ πρὸς μηδὲν ἐπεφύκειμεν, ἱκανοὺς ἂν αὐτοὺς εἶναι τῷ καθ' αὑτοὺς ὑποδείγματι παιδαγωγῆσαί τε καὶ ῥυθμίσαι πρὸς ἅπαν εἶδος ἀρετῆς ἐμβιβάσαι καὶ τῶν καλῶν ὀρεχθῆναι ποιῆσαι, ὥστε τὴν νῦν τῆς πολιτείας κατάστασιν καὶ ἣν ἔχουσι πεῖραν οἱ πολῖται καὶ γυμνασίαν ἐν τοῖς πολεμικοῖς οὐκ ἔξω τοῦ εἰκότος εἶναι λόγου, οὔτε τῆς τ' αὐτῶν εὐφυίας τῆς τε τῶν βασιλέων παιδαγωγίας. Οὔκουν θαυμαστόν, εἴ τινες καθ' ἡμῶν ἐπιόντες καθ' αὑτῶν ἔγνωσαν ὁρμηθέντες καὶ κακοὶ κακῶς ἀπήλλαξαν ἢ εἰ πρὸς τὴν τῶν ἐναντίων αὐτοὶ τὸν πόλεμον μετατιθέντες βλάψαι ἰσχύσαμεν, ἀλλὰ τοὐναντίον ἔδει θαυμάζειν, εἰ, οὕτως ἐφ' ἑαυτῶν ἄριστα προμεμελετηκότες τὰ τῶν

In wielding weapons of close combat and fighting hand to hand, than whom are they not more consummately trained, and in brandishing the spear and harassing with the bow, who could ever match them? With the bow they vanquish Teucer and Pandarus; in "marshaling steeds and shielded warriors" they have eclipsed Menestheus; they have made the son of Oileus look like a child in fleetness of foot and agility of body; and outstripping one hero in one contest and another in another, in all alike they have outshone them all. For both by themselves they possessed natural aptitude for everything, and we have been blessed with such leaders and chiefs in our peerless emperors that, even had we been born with no natural gift whatever, they would have sufficed by their own example to school and mold us, to set us on the path to every form of virtue, and to inspire us with longing for noble deeds; hence the present condition of our commonwealth and the experience and training our citizens possess in warfare are in no way out of keeping with probability, whether in view of their own native gifts or of the guidance of our emperors. It is no wonder, therefore, if any who marched against us learned that they had rushed upon their own ruin and came off miserably, evil as they were, or if,

ἐν πολέμοις ἀγώνων, ἔπειθ' ἥττους τῶν ἐπιόντων ἐφαινόμεθα γινόμενοι καὶ κατ' ἄλλων αὐτοὶ στρατευόμενοι μετὰ τῆς ἐλάττονος ἐπανήειμεν μοίρας.

Δύο γοῦν ὑπερφυῆ καθ' ἡμῶν εἰσελάσαι βαρβάρων καὶ μέγιστα τῶν πώποτε στρατεύματα μνημονεύεται, μυριάσι μὲν ἀνδρῶν δεδιττόμενα, τῇ πάσῃ δὲ παρασκευῇ φοβοῦντα καὶ ἐξιστῶντα τοὺς ἐναντίους, οὐδέτερον δὲ καθ' ἡμῶν ἴσχυσεν οὐ πλήθει στρατοῦ, οὐκ ἀνταγωνιστῶν ἐμπειρίᾳ, οὐκ ἄλλῳ τῳ τῶν ἐφ' οἷς μέγα φρονοῦσι πολέμιοι. Ἀλλὰ τὸ μέν, ὡς ἀνηνύτοις ἐπιχειρεῖν ἔγνω καὶ πλείω κακῶς ἔπασχεν ἢ ἡμᾶς ἔδρα, τοῖς πᾶσιν ἀηττήτοις ὀφθέντας, ὡς εἰς τελευταίαν κατέφυγον ἄγκυραν καὶ ὧν εἶχον τὸ βιαιότατον, ἐμπρῆσαι τὴν πόλιν, πρᾶγμα τῶν τε πειρωμένων πολλὴν ἀνανδρίαν μαρτυροῦν καὶ νίκης ἀπόγνωσιν καθ' ὧν τε ἐμηχανᾶτο ἡττηθεῖσι μὲν οὐδεμίαν ἐπιφέρον δικαίως κατηγορίαν, εἴπερ τῶν ὑπὲρ ἄνθρωπον πάντας ἑξῆς ἡττᾶσθαι πᾶσα ἀνάγκη, περιγενομένοις δὲ πάντα τὰ κάλλιστα καὶ περιουσίαν ἀνδρείας καὶ εὐτυχίας ἐπάγον. Πῦρ γοῦν ἀνῆκαν μὲν ταῖς οἰκίαις, οἱ δὲ πολῖται, καὶ πρὸς τὸ πῦρ καὶ τοὺς ἔξω πολεμίους ἀγωνιζόμενοι, οὐδὲν ἧττον καὶ τούτους ἐτρέψαντο καὶ τοῦ πυρὸς ἐγένοντο κρείττους οὐχ ὅσον ἐντεῦθεν βλαφθέντες οὐδέν, ἀλλὰ καὶ μᾶλλον ἀποφανθέντες λαμπρότεροι ὅσῳ πάσας τὰς τῶν ἐναντίων ἐλπίδας καὶ τὴν δυνατὴν αὐτοῖς πεῖραν ἀπήλεγξαν τὸ μηδὲν οὖσας καὶ παιδίων πρὸς ἄνδρας ἀθύρματα.

Τὸ δέ γε λοιπόν τε καὶ δεύτερον στράτευμα ὅσῳ δεινότερόν τε καὶ φοβερώτερον ἦν, τοσούτῳ καθ' ἑαυτοῦ δεινότερον ὤφθη γενόμενον καὶ τοὔνομα ἀπηνέγκατο καὶ περιβεβόηται πανταχοῦ οἷς πανωλεθρίᾳ παντελεῖ παραδέδοται κἀκ τῆς ἰδίας συμφορᾶς γέγονε γνώριμον. Ἅμα τε γὰρ εἰσήλασαν καὶ πέρα δεινῶν αὐτοῖς ἀπηντήκει τὰ πράγματα, οὐδὲ γνοῦσιν ὅθεν ὁ ὄλεθρος, ὥστε μηδ' ἀγγελιαφόρον ἤ, τοῦτο δὴ τὸ λεγόμενον, ὑπολελεῖφθαι πυρφόρον, ἀλλ' αὐτοῦ πεσεῖν μὲν ἅπαν τὸ στράτευμα καὶ τὸν ἐς Ἅιδην ὑπνῶσαι, τὸν δ' ἄρχοντ' αὐτοῖς καὶ ἡγεμόνα τῆς

carrying the war ourselves into the adversaries' land, we proved strong enough to strike them; on the contrary, one ought rather to have wondered if, after having practiced the contests of war beforehand so consummately among ourselves, we had then proved inferior to assailants, or on campaigning against others had returned home with the worse share.

Two prodigious armies of barbarians, the largest ever known, are recorded to have invaded us, spreading terror by their tens of thousands of men and striking fear and dismay into adversaries by all their panoply; yet neither prevailed against us—not by multitude of troops, not by the experience of its combatants, nor by anything else wherein enemies take pride. As for the one host, when it realized that it was attempting the impossible and was suffering more harm than it inflicted upon us, who proved invincible in every respect, its men fled as to a last anchor and the most violent expedient at their disposal—to set fire to the city: an act bearing witness to utter cowardice and despair of victory on the part of those who attempted it, while bringing no just reproach upon those against whom it was contrived had they succumbed, seeing that every mortal without exception must needs yield to forces beyond human power, yet conferring upon them, if they prevailed, all the fairest honors and a crowning proof of valor and good fortune. They set fire, accordingly, to the houses; yet our citizens, contending simultaneously against the flames and against the enemy outside, routed the foe nonetheless and mastered the fire as well—not only suffering no ruin therefrom, but emerging all the more glorious insofar as they exposed all the adversaries' hopes and the utmost effort in their power as sheer nothingness and the playthings of children matched against men.

As for the remaining second army, the more dreadful and terrifying it was, the more dreadful it proved to its own undoing, winning its notoriety and becoming celebrated everywhere through being delivered over to utter annihilation, made famous by its own disaster. For no sooner had they marched in than calamity beyond all horror met them, before they even knew whence destruction came: not even a messenger or, as the saying goes, a fire-bearer was left alive, but the entire host fell on the spot and slept the sleep of Hades, while their ruler and commander of the host was led away in chains,

στρατιᾶς δέσμιον ἀπαχθῆναι, τὴν προτέραν ἀλλαξάμενον τύχην καὶ ὧν ὠνειροπόλει κατὰ τῆς πόλεως ὕπαρ ἀποτίνοντα δίκας. Ὅπερ εἴθ' ἡ τῶν ἐνοικούντων ἀνδρεία κατώρθωσεν εἴτε τις δύναμις θειοτέρα· λέγεται γὰρ οὖν καὶ πιστεύεται· εἴτε καὶ ἄμφω ταυτὶ συνδραμόντα, θεοῦ συνεπιρρωννύντος τοὺς ἡμετέρους πολίτας, ποίαν οὐκ ἂν ὑπερβολὴν ἀγαθῶν παρενέγκοιεν;

Ὥσπερ δὲ πεπρωμένον ἡμῖν ὂν εὐδοκιμεῖν πανταχοῦ καὶ τοῖς πᾶσι νικᾶν, οὕτω μετὰ πολλοῦ τοῦ κρείττονος ἐπιόντων τε καθ' ἡμῶν ἀπαλλάττομεν τῶν ἐχθρῶν καὶ αὐτοὶ κατ' αὐτῶν ἐκστρατεύοντες διὰ πάντων κρατοῦμεν, καὶ ψυχὰς αὐτῶν δουλούμενοι καὶ τὰ σώματα, ἅτε μὴ μόνον εὖ παρεσκευασμένοι τοῖς πᾶσι καὶ ὅσων δεῖ πολέμῳ καὶ μάχῃ, ἀλλὰ καὶ μετὰ παντὸς τοῦ δικαίου πρὸς τοὺς πολεμικοὺς ἀγῶνας ἥκοντες καὶ παλαίσματα. Ἄρχομεν γὰρ μάχης οὐδ' ἅπαξ, ἀμυνόμενοι δὲ τὰ ὁμωμοσμένα παραβαίνοντας τοὺς ὁμόρους ἑκάστοτε, τόν τε τοῦ δικαίου λόγον ἡμῶν αὐτῶν προβαλλόμεθα, καὶ μετὰ τοιαύτης ὡρμημένοι τῆς συμμαχίας οὐκ ἀπεικότως περιγινόμεθα τῶν ἐχθρῶν καὶ τοῖς τῆς μάχης ἄθλοις κοσμούμεθα, ὥστ' ἐπ' ἀμφοτέρων ἡμῖν ἄριστα τῶν καιρῶν ἐξεῖναι πολιτεύεσθαι εἰρήνης τε ἀπολαύειν βαθείας, τὰ πλείω τῶν πολεμίων τρεμόντων καὶ ἡρεμούντων· εἰρηνεύει γὰρ μάλιστα ὃς μάλιστα πρὸς πόλεμον παρεσκεύασται καί, πολέμου δεῆσαν, κουφότατα περιγίνεσθαι καὶ τὴν νικῶσαν ἀποφέρεσθαι πανταχοῦ. Ὥστ' οὐχ ὧν ἡ ἡμετέρα κατὰ τῶν βαρβάρων, πεζῇ τε κατ' αὐτῶν ἐκστρατεύουσα καὶ τριήρεσι καὶ θαλάττῃ χρωμένη, κατώρθωκε μόνον, εἰς τὴν αὐτῶν ἀποβαίνουσα καὶ τὸν περὶ τῆς σφετέρας ἀναγκάζουσ' αὐτοὺς ἀγωνίζεσθαι, ἀλλὰ καὶ ὧν οὐ κατορθοῖ δικαίως ἂν θαυμασθείη, τὸ μὲν πολλῶν ὧν ἠρίστευσεν ὄντων καὶ πάντων ἀξίων αὐτῇ, τὸ δ' ὅτι καὶ μὴ κατορθοῦσα τὴν σφετέραν οὐδὲν ἧττον ἐπιδείκνυται γενναιότητα, ἅτε περιουσίᾳ δυνάμεως συνέχουσά τε τοὺς ἐχθροὺς καὶ ἄκοντας ἠρεμεῖν δέει τῷ ἐς αὐτὴν καὶ τῆς ἀνάγκης αὐτὴ τοῦ πολεμεῖν ἀφειμένη. Τοῦ γὰρ ἐν μάχαις εὐδοκιμεῖν, ἀνάγκης ἡκούσης, οὐδὲν ἧττον εἰς εὐφημίαν εἰρήνην ἑαυτῷ πορίσασθαι πάντοθεν, δεδιότων τῶν ἐχθρῶν συμβαλεῖν. Ὥστ' οὕτως ἄν τις μὴ κατορθῶν πολλῷ τῷ μέσῳ τοὺς κατορθοῦντας νικῴη καὶ τὰ τῶν ἀγωνιζομένων ἀποφέροιτ' ἂν ἔπαθλα, μὴ παλαίων, μηδὲ μαχόμενος. Οἷς γὰρ πρὸς πόλεμον

having exchanged his former fortune and paying the penalty in waking reality for the dreams he had indulged against the city. Whether the valor of the inhabitants achieved this feat, or some higher divine power—for so indeed it is told and believed—or both of these concurring together, as God lent strength to our citizens, what pitch of blessings could they fail to surpass?

And as though it were destined for us to win renown everywhere and conquer in all things, we both come off with decisive superiority when enemies attack us, and when we march out against them ourselves we prevail throughout, subjugating both their spirits and their bodies—inasmuch as we enter into the contests and grapplings of war not only thoroughly equipped with everything needed for war and battle, but also with full justice on our side. For never once do we initiate hostilities; rather, defending ourselves each time against neighbors who transgress their sworn treaties, we set the plea of justice as a shield before us, and sallying forth with such an ally it is with good reason that we overcome our enemies and are crowned with the prizes of battle. Thus we are enabled to conduct our civic life admirably in both seasons alike: enjoying profound peace while for the most part our enemies tremble and keep quiet—for he enjoys peace most of all who is best prepared for war—and, whenever war is required, prevailing with the greatest ease and carrying off the palm of victory everywhere. Wherefore our city may justly be admired not merely for the triumphs she has achieved against the barbarians—marching out against them by land and employing triremes and the sea as well, landing upon their shores and forcing them to fight for their own homeland—but even for the triumphs she refrains from winning: on the one hand because her feats of valor are already many and all worthy of her, and on the other because even when not winning victories in the field she displays her nobility nonetheless, constraining her enemies even against their will to keep quiet through sheer superiority of power and dread of her, while she herself is released from the necessity of waging war. For no less glorious than winning renown in battle when necessity comes is securing peace for oneself on every side because one's enemies fear to join battle. In this way, indeed, one who achieves no martial exploit may by a wide margin surpass those who do, winning the prizes

παρεσκεύασται καὶ κρατεῖν μεμελέτηκεν ἀφεῖται μὴ πολεμεῖν.

of combatants without wrestling or fighting; for by the very readiness wherewith she is prepared for war and trained to conquer, she is set free from having to fight.

§ 24. [σ. 51] Τὴν οὖν οὕτω μὲν δυνάμεως, οὕτω δ' ἀγαθῶν πάντων ἀσκήσει, οὕτω δὲ τῆς ἐν πολέμῳ δεινότητος καὶ τοῦ κατὰ πάντων ἔχουσαν κράτους καὶ κοσμουμένην μὲν ἀρχαιότητι, θέσει δ' ἀγαλλομένην καὶ ὡρῶν ἁρμονίᾳ καὶ κάλλει κατασκευῆς καὶ οἰκοδομίας παντοδαπῆς καὶ τῇ διὰ πάντων εὐαρμοστίᾳ καὶ συμφωνίᾳ τίς ἂν λόγος πρὸς ἀξίαν κοσμήσειεν ἢ ποία τῶν αὐτῇ προσηκόντων ἐφίκοιτ' ἂν γλῶττα;

§ 24. [p. 51] A city, then, so conditioned in power, through the practice of every good, in prowess in war, and in supremacy over all—adorned with antiquity, exulting in her site, in the harmony of her seasons, in the beauty of her appointments and architecture of every kind, and in the proportion and concord pervading all things—what discourse could adorn her according to her worth, or what tongue could attain to what befits her?

§ 25. [σ. 51–52] Ὃ γοῦν ἐν τοῖς ἄνω μέν ἐστι λόγοις, οὐδὲν δ' ἧττον καὶ νῦν ἁρμόζει ῥηθῆναι, ὅτι, τῶν ἄλλων ἁπάντων τῶν ὡς ἐγγυτάτω τε καὶ πόρρω τῆς Ῥωμαίων ἀρχῆς ὄντων δεδουλωμένων καὶ νῶτα τοῖς ἐχθροῖς δόντων, ἡ ἡμετέρα τούτου τε κρείττων ἐγεγόνει, καὶ πρός, ἄλλων ἄρχειν ἀξίωται, τοῦτ' αὖ ὑπειπὼν καὶ δὴ πεπαύσομαι. Εἰς κόσμον μὲν γὰρ ἡμῖν φέρει καὶ θαύματος λόγον καὶ τοῦτο δὴ τὸ κοινὸν καὶ κατὰ πάντων κρατῆσαν, μόνης αὐτῆς ἡττηθέν, ὅταν δὲ καὶ τὰς εὐδαιμονηκυίας τῶν πόλεων ἴδοι τις ἂν ἑαλωκυίας δεινῶς καὶ ταὐτὸ τοῦτο παθούσας ὃ κατὰ πάντων ἐνίκησεν αἷς καὶ μόνον ἀντιπαρεξετάζεσθαί τινα φέρει πρὸς ἔπαινον, τότ' αὔξεται καὶ μᾶλλον τῇ περιγενομένῃ τὸ θαῦμα, καὶ μείζων ὁ ἔπαινος αὐτῇ γίνεται. Εἰς ἃς οὖν ἀναφέρειν ἔχομεν πόλεις καὶ αἷς ὥσπερ πατρίσι κοσμούμεθα, ταύτας εἰς ἔσχατον ἐν τοῖς ἄνω χρόνοις ἡκούσας εὐκλείας ἀρχῆς τε εἵνεκα καὶ δυνάμεως καὶ πάντων τῶν ἄλλων, οὐδ' ὅσον εἰπεῖν ἡ ἡμετέρα πόλις ὑπερεβάλετο. Μιλήτου μὲν γὰρ καὶ Σινώπης αὐτῆς, τῆς μὲν οὐδὲ τοὔνομα λέλειπται, τὴν δὲ δακρύσαις ἂν ἰδὼν ὑφ' οἵων οἰκεῖται καὶ οὓς ἄρχοντας στέργει, ὑπὲρ δὲ Ἀθηνῶν καὶ τῆς ἀττικῆς χώρας ἁπάσης κἂν αἰσχυνθείη τις· οὕτω πονήρως πεπράγεσαν. Ἡμῖν δὲ χωρεῖ τὰ πράγματα κρεῖττον ἢ κατ' εὐχήν, καὶ ὁ πάντα μὲν γηράσκων χρόνος, αὐτὸς δ' ἀκμάζων καὶ νεάζων ἡμῖν μόνοις τῆς ἑαυτοῦ μετέδωκε φύσεως, ἐν ἀκμῇ τὰ τῆς εὐτυχίας τῇ πόλει συνέχων, καὶ ταῦτα πλείων παραρρυεὶς ἤδη σχεδὸν ἀφ' οὗ Μίλητον ὑφ' ἑαυτὸν ἐποιήσατο καὶ Ἀθήνας ἢ ὅσον ἔφθασαν ἐκεῖναι οἰκισθεῖσαι τὴν ἡμετέραν. Γένοιτο δὲ καὶ τὸν ἔπειτα χρόνον μετὰ τῆς ὁμοίας ἡμᾶς ὑποδέξασθαι τύχης καὶ τοῖς δυνατοῖς

§ 25. [p. 51–52] One point, at any rate, which stands in our earlier remarks, yet is no less fitting to be stated now as well—namely, that when all other peoples, both those nearest and those farthest within the Roman Empire, had been enslaved and had turned their backs to the enemy, our city not only proved superior to that fate, but has furthermore been deemed worthy to rule over others—adding this once more, I shall bring my speech to a close. For even this universal doom that prevailed over all others, yet was worsted by her alone, redounds to our glory and gives ground for wonder; when, however, one beholds even the most prosperous of cities—cities with which merely to be compared brings praise to anyone—grievously captured and suffering that very fate which triumphed over all, then wonder grows greater still for her who has survived, and loftier becomes her praise. Those cities, then, to which we can trace back our origin and in which we take pride as mother-cities, though in ancient times they reached the pinnacle of renown for empire, power, and all else, our city has surpassed beyond all telling. For of Miletus and Sinope herself, of the former not even the name remains, while over the latter you would weep on seeing by what sort of people she is inhabited and what rulers she endures; and for Athens and the whole land of Attica a man might even blush with shame, so wretchedly have they fared. For us, however, affairs proceed better than prayer could ask: Time, which ages all things while itself remaining in its prime and ever young, has imparted its own nature to us alone, preserving our city's good fortune at its height—and that too when almost more of it has already flowed past since it brought Miletus and Athens under its sway

ἅπασι κοσμῆσαι τὴν ἡμετέραν, ἀθάνατον αὐτῇ τὴν ἀγαθὴν συνέχοντα μοῖραν.

than the span by which those cities preceded ours in their foundation. May future time as well receive us with the like fortune and adorn our city with all possible blessings, keeping her good destiny immortal for her!

§ 26. [σ. 52] Ὁ μὲν οὖν πρὸς τὴν ἐνεγκοῦσαν ἐξείργασται λόγος, ἄνδρες πολῖται, καὶ τὸ χρέος ἐκτέτισταί μοι τὸ πρὸς αὐτήν, τῆς μὲν δυνάμεως ἴσως οὐδὲν ἧττον, τῆς δ' ἀξίας τε καὶ βουλήσεως οὐδ' ὅσον εἰπεῖν. Εἰ δὲ τῷ λέγοντι τὸν λόγον, οὐ τῇ πόλει παραμετρήσαντες, οὕτω τὴν ψῆφον ἐξοίσετε, κατ' ἀγαθούς τε κρινεῖτε κριτὰς καὶ δικαίους καὶ τοὺς ἐνταῦθα λόγους ὑπὲρ ὑμῶν ἔργοις αὐτοῖς βεβαιώσετε.

§ 26. [p. 52] My discourse for the land that bore me is now complete, fellow citizens, and my debt to her has been paid in full—no less, perhaps, than my ability allowed, yet in comparison with her worth and my own desire, falling short beyond all words. If, however, measuring the speech by the speaker rather than by the city, you cast your vote accordingly, you will judge like good and righteous judges, and by your very deeds you will confirm the words spoken here on your behalf.